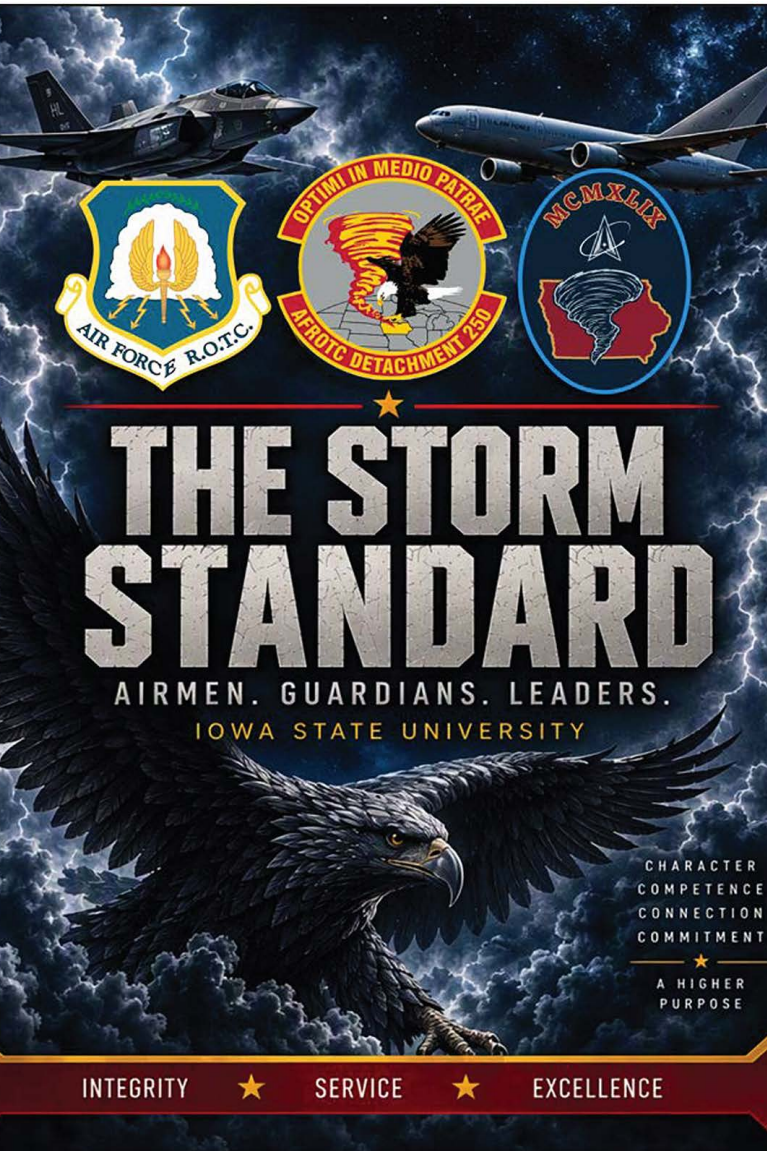

AIR FORCE R.O.T.C.
OPTIMI IN MEDIO PATRAE
AFROTC DETACHMENT 250
MCMXLIX
THE STORM STANDARD
AIRMEN. GUARDIANS. LEADERS.
IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY
CHARACTER
COMPETENCE
CONNECTION
COMMITMENT
A HIGHER PURPOSE
INTEGRITY ★ SERVICE ★ EXCELLENCE

Table of Contents

Edition, Purpose, Authority 2

Chapter 1: The Storm Legacy 3

Chapter 2: Officership 13

Chapter 3: History 59

Chapter 4: Military Strategy 81

Chapter 5: Military Resources 104

Appendix I: Constitution 129

Edition, Purpose, Authority

Edition: First Edition
Version: 1
Revision Date: Sep 2026
Owner: AFROTC Detachment 250
Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR): Education Officer
Approval Authority: Detachment Commander, AFROTC Detachment 250

Purpose
The Storm Standard provides AFROTC Detachment 250 cadets with a consolidated reference containing selected Air Force and Space Force doctrine, officership concepts, military heritage, Detachment 250 history, local procedures, and study materials.
This publication is intended to support cadet education, professional development, and preparation for leadership responsibilities within AFROTC.

Authority and Precedence
This publication is **not a substitute for official Department of the Air Force, Air Force ROTC, Air Force, Space Force, Department of War, or federal publications.**
In the event of any conflict, the following sources take precedence over this publication:

1. United States Code
2. Department of War directives and instructions
3. Department of the Air Force publications
4. Air Force and Space Force doctrine publications
5. AFROTC instructions and guidance
6. Detachment Commander policy memoranda

Cadets will comply with the most current controlling publication regardless of the content contained in this document.

Changes and Recommendations
Recommended changes should be submitted through the cadet chain of command to the publication owner for review.

Chapter 1

For Iowa

The Storm Legacy / Pioneers of the Storm 4–7

Significant Events of ISU & Det 250 8–11

Carry the Legacy Forward 12

The Storm Legacy: Iowa's Air and Space Heritage

Welcome to the Storm. By joining Detachment 250, you become part of a distinguished tradition that dates back to 1949, when Iowa State University established one of the nation's early Air Force ROTC detachments. Within the walls of the historic Armory, generations of cadets have learned to lead, serve, and excel before commissioning as officers in the United States Air and Space Forces. Today, the story of Detachment 250 is not simply a record of past achievements. It is a reminder that the standards, traditions, and leadership forged within these halls have shaped generations of officers who went on to influence the Air Force far beyond Iowa State. Their achievements demonstrate how the leadership developed here can influence the Air Force for decades to come. As we look forward to the future, it is fitting to first honor the pioneers whose determination, innovation, and service laid the foundation upon which we stand today.

Pioneers from the Storm

Brig. Gen. Boyd Hubbard Jr.

Degree: B.S. Mechanical Engineering, Iowa State College (1933)

Notable Accomplishments:

- Flew B-17 missions to the Philippines prior to U.S. entry into World War II and earned the Distinguished Flying Cross.
- Commanded the 501st Bomb Group (B-29) during operations against Japan.
- Led one of the first precision radar bombing campaigns against Japan.
- Accumulated nearly 6,000 flight hours during his career.
- Commanded Tactical Air Command's 4520th Combat Crew Training Wing at Nellis AFB, training fighter pilots during the Cold War.

Factoid: His B-29 group delivered six million pounds of TNT on primary targets in Japan without losing an aircraft.

Lt. Gen. Thomas J. Hickey

Degree: B.S. Electrical Engineering, Iowa State University (1956)

Notable Accomplishments:

- Flew 220 combat missions during the Vietnam War, including 63 over North Vietnam.
- Commanded the 27th Tactical Fighter Wing.
- Served as Commander of the Keesler Technical Training Center.
- Awards: Silver Star, Distinguished Flying Cross, Legion of Merit, and Air Medal with 13 oak leaf clusters.

Factoid: Rose to become Air Force Deputy Chief of Staff for Personnel.

Pioneers from the Storm (cont)

Brig. Gen. Wayne L. Schultz
Degree: B.S. Aerospace Engineering, Iowa State University (1966)
Notable Accomplishments:

- AFROTC graduate and recipient of the Governor's Trophy as outstanding graduate.
- Commanded the Colorado Air National Guard's 140th Wing.
- Served as Vice Commander of the 4404th Provisional Wing during operations in Saudi Arabia.
- Directed operations involving more than 2,500 personnel from 11 locations in four countries.
- Logged more than 5,000 flight hours.

Factoid: Won the Lt. Gen. Claire Lee Chennault USAF Aerial Tactician of the Year Award.

Brig. Gen. David A. Cotton
Degree: B.S. Computer Science, Iowa State University (1981)
Notable Accomplishments:

- -Native of Newton, Iowa.
- -Became the Air Force's Director of Cyberspace Operations and Senior Information Assurance Officer.
- -Oversaw transformation of a 44,000-person cyber workforce.
- -Served as Chief Information Officer for U.S. Joint Forces Command and U.S. European Command.
- -Directed command, control, communications and computer systems for Joint Task Force Southwest Asia during Operation Enduring Freedom.

Factoid: One of Iowa State's earliest distinguished Air Force cyber leaders, helping shape Air Force information warfare and cybersecurity policy.

Maj. Gen. Clinton E. Crosier
Degree: B.S. Aerospace Engineering, Iowa State University (1987)
Notable Accomplishments:

- Attended Iowa State on an AFROTC scholarship.
- Helped formulate and stand up the U.S. Space Force as Director of Space Force Planning.
- Commanded the 460th Space Wing and the 50th Operations Group.
- Served as U.S. Central Command Director of Space Forces in the Middle East.
- Winner of the National Reconnaissance Office Director's Gold Medal.

Factoid: Played a direct role in establishing the first new U.S. military service in 72 years, the U.S. Space Force.

Pioneers from the Storm (cont)

Maj. Gen. Patrick J. Doherty

Degree: B.S. Aerospace Engineering, Iowa State University (1987)
Notable Accomplishments:

- Began as a B-52 nav before transitioning to become an F-15E pilot.
- Distinguished graduate in both navigator and pilot training.
- Led the Air Force flying training enterprise, training more than 32,000 Airmen annually.
- Logged more than 4,000 flight hours and 339 combat hours.
- Awards: Distinguished Flying Cross with Valor, Distinguished Service Medal, Bronze Star Medal.

Factoid: Commanded the 4th Fighter Wing, 82nd Training Wing, and 19th Air Force.

Maj. Gen. Bret C. Larson

Degree: B.S., Iowa State University (1988)
Notable Accomplishments:

- Commander, 22nd Air Force.
- Former T-38 and C-130 instructor pilot.
- Deployed seven times in support of Operation Enduring Freedom.
- Accumulated more than 5,000 flying hours and more than 600 combat hours.

Factoid: In addition to his military service, he also flew commercially for a major airline.

Lt. Gen. Michael J. Schmidt

Degree: B.S. Industrial Engineering, Iowa State University (1990)
Notable Accomplishments:

- ROTC Distinguished Graduate at Iowa State.
- Served as Program Executive Officer and Director of the F-35 Lightning II Joint Program Office.
- Oversaw the world's largest fighter aircraft program involving the U.S. military, partner nations, and foreign military sales customers.
- Served as Program Executive Officer for Fighters and Bombers and for ISR and Special Operations Forces programs.
- Worked directly with Congress as both a Legislative Fellow and Air Force liaison.

Factoid: One of the most senior acquisition leaders in the Department of War and the top executive overseeing the F-35 enterprise.

Pioneers from the Storm (cont)

Brig Gen Bobbi J. Doorenbos
Degree: B.B.A. Finance, Iowa State University (1992)
Notable Accomplishments:

- Selected as a White House Fellow and served as Special Advisor to Vice President Joe Biden on defense and intelligence policy.
- Commanded the 188th Wing, leading MQ-9, ISR, and space-targeting operations.
- Senior Pilot with 1,200+ F-16 flight hours and recipient of the Defense Superior Service Medal and Legion of Merit.

Significance of Iowa State and Det 250

Military Heritage at Iowa State

Military training has existed at Iowa State since 1870, making it one of the nation's longest continuous military education institutions. Iowa State became one of only a handful of universities to host Army, Navy, and Air ROTC simultaneously. Gold Star Hall inside of the Memorial Union is perhaps the most significant military memorial on campus. It honors Iowa State students and alumni who died while serving in the U.S. military, including members of the U.S. Army Air Corps, U.S. Air Force, and other services. The hall contains the engraved names of hundreds of fallen Iowa Staters from World War I through the Global War on Terrorism.

Iowa State Gold Star Hall Air Force Heritage Roster

Name	Rank	Service	Conflict	Hometown
Marvin Adams	Major	US Air Force Reserve	Vietnam	Mason City, Iowa
Ramon Roderick Davis	Captain	US Air Force	Korea	Ames, Iowa
James Wayne Herrick, Jr.	Captain	US Air Force	Vietnam	Panora, Iowa
Charles Douglas King	Chief Master Sergeant	US Air Force (Pararescue)	Vietnam	Muscatine, Iowa
Richard Swift	Major	US Air Force	Vietnam	Des Moines, Iowa
Richard Welch	1st Lieutenant	US Air Force	Vietnam	Maxwell, Iowa
Don Beerbower	Major	Army Air Corps	World War II	Hill City, Minnesota
George Clarke	2nd Lieutenant	US Army Air Corps	World War II	Conrad, Iowa
Maurice Raskin	1st Lieutenant	Army Air Forces	World War II	Woodbury, Iowa
Robert Geoffroy	2nd Lieutenant	Army Air Forces (Navigator)	World War II	Sterling, Illinois

Significance of Iowa State and Det 250 (cont)

Birth of AFROTC at Iowa State

The first official Air Force ROTC detachment was established in 1949. During its first decade, the program commissioned 843 officers into the newly independent Air Force, with enrollment reaching nearly 2,000 cadets during the early Cold War. Since 1949, AFROTC Detachment 250 has carried that tradition forward, developing Airmen and Guardians whose service has spanned every era of modern military aviation, from the skies of Korea and Vietnam to the deserts of the Middle East and the limitless reaches of space.

This work tells the story of Iowa's airpower pioneers, notable graduates such as Brigadier General Boyd Hubbard Jr, the historic events that shaped American airpower, and the institutions that continue to prepare warrior leaders of character. Rooted in the traditions of Iowa State University and inspired by the Cyclone spirit of resilience, innovation, and service, Detachment 250's legacy continues to influence the defense of the United States and the future of the Department of the Air Force.

USAF Det 250 Patch Heraldry

Detachment 250's patch reflects both its heritage and mission. The tornado symbolizes Iowa State University's Cyclone tradition and the detachment's identity as "The Storm," while the bald eagle represents service to the United States and the ideals of Air and Space Force leadership. The map of the United States with Iowa highlighted signifies the detachment's roots in Ames and its commitment to developing officers who will serve across the nation and around the world. The motto, “Optimi in Medio Patriae”, translates to "The Best in the Heart of the Nation," reflecting Detachment 250's pursuit of excellence from the heartland of America.

Significance of Iowa State and Det 250 (cont)

USSF Det 250 Patch Heraldry



The Detachment 250 Space Force Patch honors the heritage of Iowa State University, AFROTC Detachment 250, and the United States Space Force. The colors are authorized for wear under Space Force uniform guidance and represent STAR Command, Iowa State University, and the space domain. The Roman numerals MCMXLIX commemorate 1949, the year Detachment 250 was established, while the outline of Iowa represents the detachment's home state. The tornado symbolizes both Iowa State University's Cyclone tradition and Detachment 250's identity as "The Storm." The delta and orbital path draw inspiration from the seal of the USSF and symbolize the close relationship between the USAF and the USSF. The delta represents military space operations, while the orbit signifies the global reach and operational domain of the Space Force, encouraging cadets to embrace their shared heritage and future service.

Detachment Commanders

-Unidentified founding commander, 1949 to 1951
-Col Alexander G. Evanoff, 1951 to 1955
-Col Lewis P. Ensign, by 1956 to 1958
-Col Elwyn F. Quinn, 1958 to 1961
-Lt Col Clarence “Roger” Anderson, 1961 to 1963
-Col/Lt Col Joseph Sage, 1963 to 1965
-Lt Col Paul Von Wiedenfeld, 1965 to 1968
-Col Ronald L. Brumbaugh, 1968 to 1971
-Col John F. “Jack” Loye Jr., 1971 to 1974
-Col Donald K. Mangels, 1974 to 1977
-Col Roger F. Strand, 1977 to 1980
-Col Graham P. Crow, 1980 to 1983
-Col Charles A. Malcom, 1983 to approximately 1986
-Col Ralph M. Spory Jr., approximately 1986 to 1989
-Lt Col Michael P. Welch, approximately 1989 to 1993
-Lt Col John K. Fraley, 1993 to 1995 or 1996
-Lt Col Irvin “Lon” Cakerice, 1995 to 1997
-Lt Col Jimmy E. Underwood, 1997 to 1999
-Col David R. Pierce, interim, 1999 to 2001
-Col Kenneth H. Schindele, 2001 to 2003
-Col Michael J. Artese, 2003 to 2006
-Col Robert King, 2006 to 2007
-Col James Cramp, 2007 to 2010
-Lt Col Michael C. Novy, 2010 to 2013
-Lt Col Ryan D. Hollman, 2013 to 2015
-Lt Col William “Bill” McTernan, 2015 to 2019
-Lt Col Michael Hanson, approximately 2019 to 2022
-Lt Col Eric Lopez, October 2022 to 2025
-Lt Col John D. Cacic, July 2025 to present

Carry the Legacy Forward

The Spirit of the Storm

A storm is not defined by calm skies. It is forged by powerful winds, relentless energy, and the determination to push forward when conditions are at their most demanding. The same can be said of the cadets of Det 250. Every early morning workout, challenging leadership laboratory, difficult academic course, and moment of personal growth strengthens the character required of future Air and Space Force officers.

As members of **The Storm**, you are called to do more than weather adversity; you are challenged to rise above it. Excellence is not achieved by avoiding hardship, but by embracing it with grit, discipline, and an unwavering commitment to something greater than yourself. Those who came before you built a legacy of service and leadership, and it is now your responsibility to carry that legacy forward.

Developing Leaders for Tomorrow's Air and Space Forces

Detachment 250 continues to emphasize rigorous leadership development, academic excellence, physical fitness, and character development to prepare officers capable of succeeding in increasingly complex operational environments.

Strengthening the Storm

The detachment remains committed to fostering a culture of professionalism, camaraderie, and mutual support, ensuring every cadet can grow as a leader while contributing to the enduring legacy of The Storm.

Serving the Community

Cadets regularly represent Iowa State University through volunteer service, color guard presentations, community partnerships, and events that strengthen the bond between the detachment, the university, and the state of Iowa.

Embracing Innovation

Drawing upon Iowa State University's tradition as a leader in science, technology, engineering, and innovation, Detachment 250 continues to prepare future officers for emerging challenges across the air, space, and cyber domains.

The Next Generation of the Storm

When the winds of challenge rise, lean into them. It is about moving forward with purpose, demanding excellence of yourself and those around you, and proving every day that you are worthy of the privilege and responsibility of serving your nation. When standards seem high, reach higher. When others seek comfort, choose growth. The challenge is before you. The standard is excellence. The future is yours to shape. Looking ahead, Det 250 remains dedicated to commissioning leaders of character who embody integrity, service, and excellence. As new cadets enter the historic Armory and join The Storm, they become part of a legacy more than seventy-five years in the making, entrusted with carrying that tradition forward while shaping the future.

Chapter 2

Officership

Air Force Vision 14
Air Force Mission 14
Air Force Core Functions 14
Space Force Mission 14
Chain of Command 15
Leadership Concept 15
Effective Followership 16
The Honor Code 17
A Leader of Character 18
Air Force Core Values 18
A Way of Life 23
Commissioning Education Program 23
Air Force and Space Force Oaths 24
Military Rank and Insignia 28
Military Customs and Courtesies 33
Respect for the Flag and Songs 36
High Flight 40
Cadet Prayer 40
Quotations 41
Airman's Creed 46
The Profession of Arms 47
Wingman Concept 47
Stress Management 48
Air Force Standards 51
Code of Conduct 52
Military Law, UCMJ Overview 54
Types of Courts-Martial 55
Social Media Guidance 56

Air Force Vision

AFI 1-1 (Aug 2023)

The United States Air Force will be a trusted and reliable Joint partner with our sister services known for integrity in all of our activities, including supporting the Joint mission first and foremost. We will provide compelling airpower capabilities for use by the combatant commanders. We will excel as stewards of all Air Force resources in service to the American people, while providing precise and reliable Global Vigilance, Reach, and Power for the Nation.

Air Force Mission

AFI 1-1 (Aug 2023)

The mission of the United States Air Force is to fly, fight and win - airpower anytime, anywhere.

In April 2021, General Charles Q. Brown, Air Force Chief of Staff, addressed the Air Force Mission. He stated "Delivering airpower for our nation requires more than just aircraft. It requires Total Force Airmen – active duty, Guard, Reserve, civilians – in all Air Force specialties working together as a seamless team to operate, maintain and enable our mission and bring the unique capabilities and effects of airpower to bear."

Air Force Core Functions

AFI 1-1 (Aug 2023)

Air Force Core Functions. The Air Force Core Functions articulate, to internal and external audiences, how the Air Force fulfills its statutory Title 10 role to organize, train and equip forces for combatant commanders to execute their assigned missions.

The Core Functions are Air Superiority; Global Strike; Rapid Global Mobility; Intelligence; Surveillance, and Reconnaissance; and Command and Control.

Space Force Mission

Secure our Nation's interest in, from and to space.

In Sept 2023, General Bradley Chance Saltzman, Space Force Chief of Staff addressed the Space Force Mission. Each portion of the statement was chosen to represent a key aspect of the Space Force mission that the president, Congress and the American people have charged Guardians with executing.

"Secure" refers to the Space Force's formative purpose to contest, and when directed, control the space domain on behalf of the nation and joint force.

"Our Nation's interests" represents Guardians' focus on protecting the security and prosperity the U.S. derives from space. It also serves as a reminder that space activities are essential to the American way of life.

"In, from, and to space" references the three core functions of the Space Force, which include securing the Nation's interests:

In space, through space superiority activities that protect the joint force and nation from space and counterspace threats.

From space, by delivering global mission operations like satellite communications, positioning, navigation and timing, and missile warning activities.

To space, by assured space access through the service's launch, range and control network infrastructure.

Chain of Command

AFI 1-1(Aug 2023)

The chain of command provides the command, control and communication necessary to accomplish the mission. Each level in the chain is responsible for all lower levels, and accountable to all higher levels. Loyalty up and down the chain makes a system efficient and effective. Everyone is a part of, and subject to, the chain of command and must use it properly. A key principle is to resolve problems and seek answers at the lowest possible level. If a problem is unresolved, you should continue up the chain, and if practicable, request assistance at each level before going to the higher level and advise that you are doing so.

President of the United States	
Secretary of War	
Secretary of the Department of the Air Force (DAF)	
Chief of Staff, US Air Force (USAF)	Chief of Space Operations, US Space Force (USSF)
Commander, Major Command (MAJCOM)	Commander, Field Command
Commander, Numbered Air Force (NAF)	Commander, Space Force Delta
Commander, Wing	
Commander, Group	
Commander, Squadron	Commander, Squadron
Commander, Flight	Commander, Flight

Leadership Concept

AFDD Vol II – Leadership

Leadership is the art and science of motivating, influencing, and directing Airmen to understand and accomplish the Air Force mission in joint warfare. This highlights two fundamental elements of leadership: (1) the mission, objective, or task to be accomplished, and (2) the Airmen who accomplish it. All facets of Air Force leadership should support these two fundamental elements. Effective leadership transforms human potential into effective performance in the present and prepares capable leaders for the future.

Leadership

"No man is fit to command another that cannot take care of himself."
- William Penn

"If you can't get them to salute when they should salute, and wear the clothes you tell them to wear, how are you going to get them to die for their country?"
- General George S. Patton Jr.

"The most important thing I learned is that soldiers watch what theirleaders do. You can give them classes and lecture them forever, but it is your personal example they will follow."
- General Colin L. Powell

"Remember that it is the actions, and not the commission that make the officer, and that there is more expected from him than his title."
- President George Washington

"The discipline which makes the soldiers of a free country reliable in battle is not to be gained by harsh or tyrannical treatment. On the contrary, such treatment is far more likely to destroy than to make an army."
- Major General John M. Schofield

Effective Followership

Everyone is a follower. Leaders must first master followership skills.

Importance of Followership

In many cases, the leader is not the most technically skilled person in the unit. He or she likely has personnel with advanced technological skills and capabilities. Effective followership ensures these skills and abilities are being utilized, rather than overlooked.

Leaders must tap into this resource by fostering communication, nurturing, and developing their Airmen and Guardians. Without effective followership, there can be no effective leadership.

10 Qualities of Followership

Organizational Understanding. Effective followers can see how their work contributes to the organization's big picture.

Decision-making. Effective followers must be able to make sound decisions using a team-first approach.

Communication Skills. Effective followers use good communication skills. These skills are crucial when working in a team environment, especially when providing feedback to team members.

Commitment. Effective followers have a strong level of commitment. They contribute to the organization first, while pursuing personal goals.

Problem Solving. To help identify and resolve problems requires followers to share their knowledge, skills, and experience.

Integrity. Effective followers must demonstrate loyalty and a willingness to act with integrity at all times.

Adaptability. Effective followers must be able to adapt to change without being paralyzed by the stress of not knowing all the answers.

Accountability. Effective followers must take responsibility for their own actions, words, growth, and development.

Courage. Effective followers must have the confidence and guts to do and say the right things at the right times.

Credibility. Effective followers demonstrate competency through words and deeds, earning trust among peers and leaders.

The Honor Code

"We will not lie, steal, or cheat, nor tolerate among us anyone who does."

Warrior Ethos

AFTTP Airman's Manual 3-4 (September 2022).

Warrior Ethos. Simply put, the warrior ethos is the absolute foundation of what it means to be an Airman. Ethos is defined as the disposition, character, or fundamental values peculiar to a specific person, people, culture, or movement. The warrior ethos is the professional attitudes and beliefs that characterize the American Airman and serves as the foundation for an Airman's total commitment to victory in peace and war. The warrior ethos demands a commitment on the part of all Airmen to stand prepared and confident to accomplish their assigned tasks and face all challenges, including enemy resistance—anytime, anywhere.

Common elements of the warrior ethos are:

• **Moral Courage**—The power and determination to follow what one believes to be right, regardless of cost to oneself.

• **Physical Courage**—The observable actions one takes when faced with fear, pain, uncertainty, or danger.

• **Resilience**—The ability to withstand, recover, and grow in the face of stressors and changing demands.

• **Hardiness of Spirit**—The stout internal force used to get through challenging times mentally or physically.

A Leader of Character

USAFA Manual 36-3526 (September 2022)

Leaders of character principles demonstrate moral excellence reflected in their values and behavior. They set a personal example for all, whether in their units, organizations, or society.

A Leader of Character, **Lives Honorably** by consistently practicing the Air Force Core Values; **Lifts others** to be their best possible selves; **Elevates performance** to a common and noble purpose.

Lives Honorably: The term "live honorably" has significant meaning to all Airmen and Guardians – indeed to all men and women who serve in the military. We are bound by a code of behavior that defines our chosen profession.

Lifts others to their best possible selves: There is growing recognition that the "best possible self" concept is integral to leadership development. One aspect of being a Leader of Character is lifting others to be their best possible selves and developing those around us; we refer to the person in this role as a "leader-developer."

Elevates performance towards a common and noble purpose: A leader of character goes beyond simply "getting things done," to finding ways -- large and small -- to enhance and transform how things are done.

Leader of Character

Live with Honor – consistently practicing the virtues embodied in our core values
Lift Others – to be their best possible selves
Elevate Performance – toward a common and noble purpose

Air Force Core Values

Air Force Doctrine Vol. 2, AFI 1-1, AFH1

In 1993, USAFA Superintendent Lieutenant General Bradley C. Hosmer ('59), adopted "Integrity First, Service Before Self, and Excellence in All We Do," as the Academy Core Values. Two years later, Air Force Chief of Staff General Ronald R. Fogleman ('63), adopted those same Core Values for the entire Air Force.

"True quality is embodied in the actions of Air Force people who take decisive steps to improve processes and products; who capitalize on quality as a leverage tool to enhance products, achieve savings, and improve customer service; and who exemplify our core values of integrity first, service before self, and excellence in all we do."
- General Ronald R. Fogleman, USAF

The core values are a statement of those institutional values and principles of conduct that provide the moral framework for military activities. Such values are closely intertwined since integrity provides the bedrock for our military endeavors

and is fortified by service to country. This, in turn, fuels the drive for excellence.

Integrity First

Integrity is simply doing the right thing, all the time, whether everyone is watching, or no one is watching. It is the compass that keeps us on the right path when we are confronted with ethical challenges and personal temptations, and it is the foundation upon which trust is built. An individual realizes integrity when thoughts and actions align with what he or she knows to be right. The virtues that demonstrate one truly values integrity include:

***Honesty*:**
Honesty is the hallmark of integrity. As public servants, we are trusted agents. Honesty requires us to evaluate our performance against standards, and to report findings conscientiously and accurately. It drives us to advance our skills and credentials through our own effort. The service member's word must be unquestionable. This is the only way to preserve the trust we hold so dear with each other and with the population we serve.

***Courage*:**
Courage is not the absence of fear but doing the right thing despite the fear. Courage empowers us to take necessary personal or professional risks, make decisions that may be unpopular, and admit to our mistakes; having the courage to take these actions is for the mission, the Air Force, Space Force, and the Nation.

***Accountability*:**
Accountability is responsibility with an audience. That audience may be the American people, our units, our supervisors, our fellow Airmen, our families, our loved ones, and even ourselves. Accountable individuals maintain transparency, seek honest and constructive feedback, and take ownership of the outcomes of their actions and decisions. They are responsible to themselves and others and refrain from actions which discredit themselves or our service.

Integrity First

"Integrity is the fundamental premise for military service in a free society. Without integrity, the moral pillars of our military strength, public trust, and self-respect are lost."
- General Charles A. Gabriel, Chief of Staff, USAF

"Give up money, give up fame, give up science, give up earth itself and all it contains, rather than do an immoral act. Whenever you are to do a thing, though it can never be known but to yourself, ask yourself how you would act were all the world looking at you, and act accordingly."
- President Thomas Jefferson

"He who permits himself to tell a lie once finds it easier to do it a second time and third time, till at length it becomes habitual; he tells a lie without attending to it, and truths without the world believing it."
- President Thomas Jefferson

"Duty, honor, country: Those three hallowed words reverently dictate what you ought to be, what you can be, what you will be."
- General of the Army Douglas MacArthur, USA

Service Before Self

Service Before Self tells us that professional duties take precedence over personal desires. The call to serve is a call to live according to a higher standard. It is not just a job; it is a commitment that takes energy, dedication, and sacrifice. We do not "work" in the Air Force and Space Force; we serve in the Air Force and Space Force. A heart and mindset for service allows us to embrace expectations and requirements not levied on the American public or other professions. The virtues that demonstrate one truly values service include:

Duty:
Duty is the obligation to perform what is required for the mission. While our responsibilities are determined by the law, the Department of War, and Air Force instructions, directives, and guidance, our sense of duty is a personal one and bound by the oath of service we took as individuals. Duty sometimes calls for sacrifice in ways no other profession has or will. Airmen and Guardians who truly embody Service Before Self consistently choose to make necessary sacrifices to accomplish the mission, and in doing so, we honor those who made the ultimate sacrifice.

Loyalty:
Loyalty is an internal commitment to the success and preservation of something bigger than ourselves. Our loyalty is to the Nation first, the values and commitments of our Air Force and Space Force second, and finally to the men and women with whom we serve. Loyalty to our leaders requires us to trust, follow, and execute their decisions, even when we disagree. We offer alternative solutions and innovative ideas most effectively through the chain of command. Ultimately, loyalty is demonstrated by helping each other act with honor.

Respect:
Respect is treating others with dignity and valuing them as individuals. We must always act knowing that all service members possess fundamental worth as human beings. We must treat others with the utmost dignity and respect, understanding that our greatest source of strength is our shared purpose.

"An officer's ultimate commanding loyalty at all times is to his country, and not to his service or to his superiors."
- General of the Army George C. Marshall

"Let every nation know, whether it wishes us well or ill, that we shall pay any price, bear any burden, meet any hardship, support any friend, oppose any foe, to assure the survival and success of liberty."
- President John F. Kennedy

"Without a word this uniform also whispers of freezing troops, injured bodies, and Americans left forever in foreign fields. It documents the courage of all military personnel, who by accepting this uniform, promise the one gift they truly have to give: their lives."
- Colonel Karen D. Kimmel, USAF

"We toast our faithful comrades, Now fallen from the sky, And gently caught by God's own hand, To be with Him on high. To dwell among the soaring clouds, They knew so well before, From dawn patrol and victory roll, At heaven's very door. And as we fly among them there, We're sure to hear their plea, "Take care, my friend; watch your six, And do one more roll… just for me."
- CAPT Gerald Coffee, USN

Excellence In All We Do

Excellence In All We Do does not mean that we demand perfection in everything from everyone. Instead, this value directs us to continuously advance our craft and increase our knowledge as Airmen and Guardians. We must have a passion for continuous improvement and innovation that propels America's Air Force and Space Force in quantum leaps towards accomplishment and performance.

Mission:
Mission focus encompasses operations, product and resources excellence. The complex undertaking of the Air Force and Space Force mission requires us to harness the ingenuity, expertise, and elbow grease of all Airmen. We approach it with the mindset of stewardship, initiative, improvement, pride, and a continued commitment to anticipate and embrace change. Our work areas, our processes, and our interpersonal interactions must be undeniably professional and positive. Our people are the platform for delivering innovative ideas, strategies, and technologies to the fight.

Discipline:
Discipline is an individual commitment to uphold the highest of personal and professional standards. Airmen and Guardians commit to a life of discipline and self-control. We demonstrate it in attitude, work ethic, and effort directed at continuous improvement, whether it be pursuing professional military education or nurturing ourselves physically, intellectually, emotionally, or spiritually. Each Airman and Guardian represents the entire Air Force and Space Force. Our appearance, actions, and words shape the culture and the reputation of the entire military profession.

Teamwork:
Teamwork is essential to triumph at every level. Airmen and Guardians recognize the interdependency of every member's contribution towards the mission and strive for organizational excellence. We not only give our personal best, but also challenge and motivate each other. We carry our own weight, and whenever necessary, help our wingmen carry theirs. We serve in the greatest Air Force and Space Force in the world, and we embrace the idea that our part of the Air Force and Space Force meets that world-class standard.

A Way of Life

AFI 1-1

The mission must be accomplished, even at great risk and personal sacrifice. Airmen and Guardians are always subject to duty, including weekends, holidays, and while on leave. If ordered, you must report for duty at any hour, at any location and remain as long as necessary to get the job done. For the mission to succeed, you must always give your best. You must strive to be resilient: physically, mentally, emotionally, and spiritually prepared to meet the challenges inherent to being a member of a fighting force, both in the deployed environment and at home station.

You must live by rules and standards that are often more restrictive than those found in civilian life. For example, general orders are often published to provide clear and concise guidance specifically tailored to maintaining good order and discipline in the deployed setting. Our current operations place us in areas where local laws and customs or mission requirements prohibit or restrict certain activities that are generally permissible in our society.

Airmen and Guardians must respect and abide by these restrictions to preserve relations with our host nation and to support military operations with friendly forces. No mission, particularly a combat mission, can succeed without the discipline and resilience produced by strict compliance with these rules. Consequently, members who will not do their best to meet these high standards detract from the mission and, in compliance with the UCMJ and Air Force instructions, will not be retained in the Air Force.

Commissioning Education Program

DAFI 36-2614

Commissioning education and training conducted at the United States Air Force Academy, Air Force Reserve Officer Training Corps and Officer Training School provide the same basic and essential knowledge, skills and abilities needed to ensure success for all new Air Force officers upon entry to commissioned service. The education, training and experiences provided at the accession sources are the foundation upon which the Air Force's lifelong Continuum of Learning is built.

The purpose of commissioning education is to develop and provide to the Air Force newly commissioned officers who:

Have internalized the Air Force's core values, live by a high moral code, treat others with mutual respect and demonstrate a strong sense of ethics (Leader of Character).

Embody the warrior spirit: tough mindedness, tireless motivation, an unceasing vigilance, a willingness to sacrifice one's life for the country, if necessary, and a commitment to be the world's premier air, space and cyberspace force (Warrior Ethos).

Have the expectation that every Airman must be prepared to support military operations, whether deployed or at home station (Expeditionary Mindset).

Possesses a foundation of knowledge and a commitment to mastering technical skills and a proactive, enthusiastic approach to everyday activities (Motivated Professional).

Air Force and Space Force Oaths

AFI 1-1, 32 U.S.C. §901.26,
AFI 36-2606, AFI 36-2501

Upon entering the Air Force and Space Force, all Airmen and Guardians voluntarily take an oath. Each time one accepts continued service or reenlists, you reaffirm your belief in and commitment to that oath. You promise to protect and defend our American freedoms and agree to live by a set of military rules and standards. Your oath is consistent with and encompasses our core values…Integrity First, Service Before Self, and Excellence in all We Do.

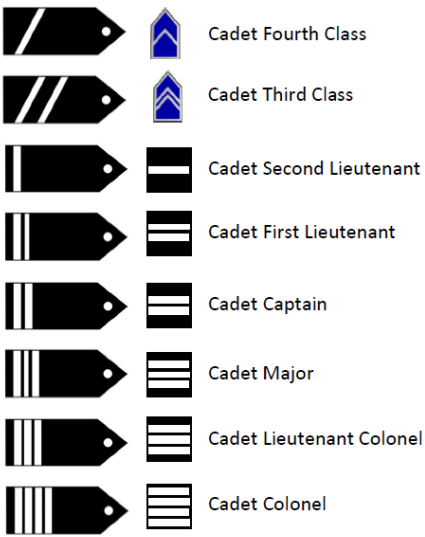
Oath of Office
"I, [name], having been appointed the rank of [state rank] in the United States Air Force or Space Force, do solemnly swear (or affirm) that I will support and defend the Constitution of the United States against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; that I take this obligation freely, without any mental reservation or purpose of evasion; and that I will well and faithfully discharge the duties of the office on which I am about to enter. (So help me God.)"

State Oath of Office
"I, [name], do solemnly swear (or affirm) that I will support and defend the Constitution of the United States and the Constitution of the State (Commonwealth, District, Territory) of [ ] against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; that I take this obligation freely, without any mental reservations or purpose of evasion, and that I will well and faithfully discharge the duties of the Office of [grade] in the Air National Guard of the State (Commonwealth, District, Territory) of [ ] on which I am about to enter, so help me God"

Oath of Enlistment
"I, [name], do solemnly swear (or affirm) that I will support and defend the Constitution of the United States against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; and that I will obey the orders of the President of the United States and the orders of the officers appointed over me, according to regulations and the Uniform Code of Military Justice. (So help me God.)"

We must not promise what we ought not, lest we be called on to perform what we cannot.
–Abraham Lincoln

Cadet Rank and Insignia



Cadet Uniform Wear

AFROTC Insignia

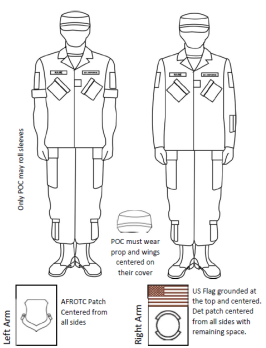


AFROTC Service Uniform Women

Only POC wear silver nametags. GMC do not wear a nametag in service coat.
Nametag parallel & centered horizontally, above a line drawn horizontally from the top of the left pocket.
All accoutrements are worn placed with ½" intervals
The Pershing Rifles rank shield worn 4" below the bottom of the ribbons
Long sleeve blues with tie is to be worn under the service coat
US pins are placed halfway up the seam with the bottom horizontal to the ground. Pins are to touch, not cover the seam.
Cords are worn on the left shoulder. No more than one cord is worn at a time.



AFROTC OCP Uniform



AFROTC Outergarmets

Coyote Brown Fleece Jacket



Wear the Velcro nametapes and rank from the OCPs

Lightweight Blues Jacket



Cadet Uniform Wear

AFROTC Service Uniform Men

Only POC wear silver nametags. GMC do not wear a nametag in service coat.
Nametag parallel & centered horizontally, above a line drawn horizontally from the top of the left pocket.
All accoutrements are worn placed with ½" intervals
The Pershing Rifles rank shield worn 4" below the bottom of the ribbons
Long sleeve blues with tie is to be worn under the service coat
US pins are placed halfway up the seam with the bottom horizontal to the ground. Pins are to touch, not cover the seam.
Cords are worn on the left shoulder. No more than one cord is worn at a time.

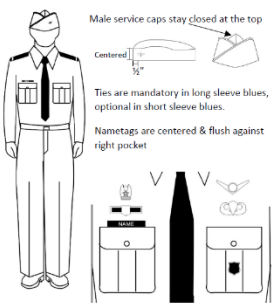


AFROTC Service Uniform Women

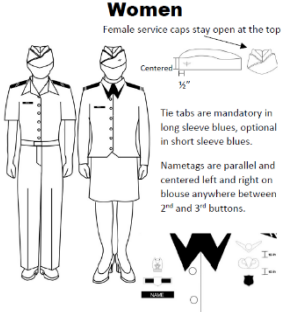
Only POC wear silver nametags. GMC do not wear a nametag in service coat.
Nametag parallel & centered horizontally, above a line drawn horizontally from the top of the left pocket.
All accoutrements are worn placed with ½" intervals
The Pershing Rifles rank shield worn 4" below the bottom of the ribbons
Long sleeve blues with tie is to be worn under the service coat
US pins are placed halfway up the seam with the bottom horizontal to the ground. Pins are to touch, not cover the seam.
Cords are worn on the left shoulder. No more than one cord is worn at a time.



AFROTC Blues Uniform Men



AFROTC Blues Uniform Women



Military Rank and Insignia

DAFI90-1201

Enlisted Insignia						
Grade	**Air Force**	**Space Force**	**Army**	**Navy**	**Marines**	**Coast Guard**
E-1	Airman Basic (AB) [No Insignia]	Specialist 1 (SPC1) 	Private (PVT) [No Insignia]	Seaman Recruit (SR) [No Insignia]	Private (PVT) [No Insignia]	Seaman Recruit (SR) 
E-2	Airman (Amn) 	Specialist 2 (SPC2) 	Private (PV2) 	Seaman Apprentice (SA) 	Private First Class (PFC) 	Seaman Apprentice (SA) 
E-3	Airman First Class (A1C) 	Specialist 3 (SPC3) 	Private First Class (PFC) 	Seaman (SN) 	Lance Corporal (LCpl) 	Seaman (SN) 
E-4	Senior Airman (SrA) 	Specialist 4 (SPC4) 	Corporal (CPL) / Specialist (SPC) 	Petty Officer Third Class (PO3) 	Corporal (Cpl) 	Petty Officer Third Class (PO3) 
E-5	Staff Sergeant (SSgt) 	Sergeant (Sgt) 	Sergeant (SGT) 	Petty Officer Second Class (PO2) 	Sergeant (Sgt) 	Petty Officer Second Class (PO2) 
E-6	Technical Sergeant (TSgt)	Technical Sergeant (TSgt) 	Staff Sergeant (SSG) 	Petty Officer First Class (PO1) 	Staff Sergeant (SSgt) 	Petty Officer First Class (PO1) 
E-7	Master Sergeant (MSgt) 	Master Sergeant (MSgt) 	Sergeant First Class (SFC) 	Chief Petty Officer (CPO) 	Gunnery Sergeant (GySgt) 	Chief Petty Officer (CPO) 
E-8	Senior Master Sergeant (SMSgt) 	Senior Master Sergeant (SMSgt) 	Master Sergeant (MSgt) 	Senior Chief Petty Officer (SCPO) 	Master Sergeant (MSgt) 	Senior Chief Petty Officer (SCPO) 

E-9	Chief Master Sergeant (CMSgt) 	Chief Master Sergeant (CMSgt) 	Sergeant Major (SGM) 	Master Chief Petty Officer (MCPO) 	Sergeant Major (SgtMaj) 	Master Chief Petty Officer (MCPO) 
Special Enlisted Insignia						
E-7	First Sergeant (1st Sgt) 	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
E-8	First Sergeant (1st Sgt) 	N/A	First Sergeant (1SG) 	N/A	First Sergeant 	N/A
E-9	First Sergeant (1st Sgt) 	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
E-9	Command Chief Master Sergeant 	N/A	Command Sergeant Major 	Fleet/Command Master Chief Petty Officer 	Master Gunnery Sergeant (MGySgt) 	Fleet/Command Master Chief Petty Officer (CMC) 
E-9	Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force (CMSAF) 	Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force (CMSSF) 	Sergeant Major of the Army (SMA) 	Master Chief Petty Officer of the Navy (MCPON) 	Sergeant Major of the Marines (SgtMajMC) 	Master Chief Petty Officer of the Coast Guard (MCPOCG) 

Warrant Officer Insignia					
Grade	**Air Force**	**Army**	**Navy**	**Marines**	**Coast Guard**
W-1	Warrant Officer 1 (WO1) 	Warrant Officer 1 (WO1) 	Warrant Officer One (WO-1) 	Warrant Officer 1 (WO) 	N/A
W-2	Chief Warrant Officer 2 (CW2) 	Chief Warrant Officer 2 (CW2) 	Chief Warrant Officer Two (CWO-2) 	Chief Warrant Officer 2 (CWO2) 	Chief Warrant Officer Two (CWO-2) 
W-3	Chief Warrant Officer 3 (CW3)	Chief Warrant Officer 3 (CW3) 	Chief Warrant Officer Three (CWO-3) 	Chief Warrant Officer 3 (CWO3) 	Chief Warrant Officer Three (CWO-3) 
W-4	Chief Warrant Officer 4 (CW4)	Chief Warrant Officer 4 (CW4) 	Chief Warrant Officer Four (CWO-4) 	Chief Warrant Officer 4 (CWO4) 	Chief Warrant Officer Four (CWO-4) 
W-5	Chief Warrant Officer 5 (CW5) 	Chief Warrant Officer 5 (CW5) 	Chief Warrant Officer Five (CWO-5) 	Chief Warrant Officer 5 (CWO5) 	N/A
In Feb 2024, 24 key decisions were announced introducing the intent to expand technical tracks for officers and to create technical tracks for enlisted Airmen by reintroducing warrant officers in IT and Cyber fields.					

Officer Ranks						
Grade	**Air Force**	**Space Force**	**Army**	**Navy**	**Marines**	**Coast Guard**
O-1	Second Lieutenant (2d Lt) 	Second Lieutenant (2d Lt) 	Second Lieutenant (2LT) 	Ensign (ENS) 	Second Lieutenant (2ndLt) 	Ensign (ENS) 
O-2	First Lieutenant (1st Lt) 	First Lieutenant (1st Lt) 	First Lieutenant (1LT) 	Lieutenant Jr Grade (LTJG) 	First Lieutenant (1stLt) 	Lieutenant Jr Grade (LTJG) 
O-3	Captain (Capt) 	Captain (Capt) 	Captain (CPT) 	Lieutenant (LT) 	Captain (Capt) 	Lieutenant (LT) 
O-4	Major (Maj) 	Major (Maj) 	Major (MAJ) 	Lieutenant Commander (LCDR) 	Major (Maj) 	Lieutenant Commander (LCDR) 
O-5	Lieutenant Colonel (Lt Col) 	Lieutenant Colonel (Lt Col) 	Lieutenant Colonel (LTC) 	Commander (CDR) 	Lieutenant Colonel (LtCol) 	Commander (CDR) 
O-6	Colonel (Col) 	Colonel (Col) 	Colonel (COL) 	Captain (CAPT) 	Colonel (Col) 	Captain (CAPT) 
O-7	Brigadier General (Brig Gen) 	Brigadier General (Brig Gen) 	Brigadier General (BG) 	Rear Admiral Lower Half (RDML) 	Brigadier General (BGen) 	Rear Admiral Lower Half (RDML) 

O-8	Major General (Maj Gen) 	Major General (Maj Gen) 	Major General (MG) 	Rear Admiral (RADM) 	Major General (MajGen) 	Rear Admiral Upper Half (RADM) 
O-9	Lieutenant General (Lt Gen) 	Lieutenant General (Lt Gen) 	Lieutenant General (LTG) 	Vice Admiral (VADM) 	Lieutenant General (LtGen) 	Vice Admiral (VADM) 
O-10	General (Gen) 	General (Gen)	General (GEN) 	Admiral (ADM) 	General (Gen) 	Admiral (ADM)
War Time Only	General of the Air Force (GAF) 	N/A	General of the Army (GA) 	Fleet Admiral (FADM) 	N/A	N/A

Military Customs and Courtesies

AFH1 (Feb 25)

Military customs and courtesies are proven traditions, deep-rooted in culture that reflect pride in military service to our Nation. Expectations for acts of respect and courtesy have evolved from the need for order and discipline, to generating an environment of respect and sense of fraternity that exists among military personnel. While not all- inclusive, [Chapter 23 in the AFH 1] highlights many of the customs and courtesies that play an extremely important role in building morale, esprit de corps, discipline, and mission effectiveness. As stated in AFI 1-1, our customs and courtesies reflect the unique nature of our profession and guide significant aspects of our behavior. Customs and courtesies emphasize our strong bond with other military members as well as our mutual respect for one another and our civilian leadership.

General Courtesies

Render verbal greeting when passing personnel. For example, say "Good morning, Sir/Ma'am."

When practical, say, "please," and "thank you."

Highest ranking individual will walk on the right-hand side.

Military personnel enter automobiles in reverse order of rank. Junior personnel enter a vehicle first and take the appropriate seat on the senior person's left. The senior person will be the last to enter and first to leave.

Rise and stand at the position of attention when a senior officer enters a room. The first person to see an officer calls the group to attention.

Do not call to attention if an officer of equal or higher rank is already in the room. When the highest officer departs, call the room to a position of attention. If you are alone stand at attention.

When answering telephones, tell the person your rank, name, unit and ask them, "May I help you?"

Note: Enlisted Air Force members are referred to as: Airman, Sergeant, or Chief. Enlisted Space Force members are referred to as: Specialist, Sergeant, or Chief. Civilians are referred to appropriately as Dr. (where applicable), Mr., Mrs., Miss, or Ms. and their last name.

Reporting In/Out Statements *DAFI 90-1201 (Oct 24)*

When reporting to a senior officer, secure permission to enter, walk to within two paces of the officer or desk, halt, salute, and report. Hold the salute until it is returned. Prior to departing, take one step back, render salute, execute an about face and leave in a military manner.

Saluting

The salute is a courteous exchange of greetings, with the junior member always saluting the senior member first. A salute is also rendered to the flag as a sign of respect. Any Airman, Specialist, NCO, or officer recognizing a need to salute or a need to return a salute may do so anywhere at any time. When returning or rendering an individual salute, the head and eyes are turned toward the flag or person saluted. When the salute is rendered to another person, the junior member initiates the salute accompanied with an appropriate verbal greeting (e.g. "Good Morning, Sir/Ma'am"). The salute and a verbal greeting should be extended at a distance at which recognition is easy and audible. The salute should be offered early enough to allow the senior time to return it and extend a verbal greeting before passing. All salutes received when in uniform shall be returned; at other times, salutes received shall be appropriately acknowledged. Guidance when exchanging salutes includes:

Saluting Indoors

Except for formal reporting and ceremonies, salutes are not rendered.

Saluting Outdoors

Salutes are exchanged upon recognition between officers or warrant officers and enlisted members of the Armed Forces when they are in uniform. Saluting outdoors means salutes are exchanged when the persons involved are outside of a building. For example, if a person is on a porch, a covered sidewalk, a bus stop, a covered or open entryway, or a reviewing stand, the salute will be exchanged with a person on the sidewalk outside of the structure or with a person approaching or in the same structure. This applies both on and off military installations. The junior member should initiate the salute in time to allow the senior officer to return it. To prescribe an exact distance for all circumstances is not practical; however, good judgment should dictate when salutes are exchanged. Superiors carrying articles in both hands need not return the salute but should nod in return or verbally acknowledge the salute. If the junior member is carrying articles in both hands, verbal greetings should be exchanged. Also, use the same procedures when greeting an officer of a foreign nation.

Use these procedures in:
Formation. Members do not salute or return a salute unless given the command to do so. The person in charge salutes and acknowledges salutes for the whole formation.

Groups, But Not in Formation. When a senior officer approaches, the first individual to notice calls the group to attention. All members face the officer and salute. If the officer addresses an individual or the group, all remain at attention (unless otherwise ordered) until the end of the conversation, at which time they salute the officer.

Public Gatherings. Salutes between individuals are not required in public gatherings, such as sporting events, meetings, or when a salute would be inappropriate or impractical.

Moving Military Vehicles. Exchange of salutes between military pedestrians (including gate sentries) and officers in moving military vehicles is not mandatory. However, when officer passengers are readily identifiable (for example, officers in appropriately marked staff vehicles), the salute must be rendered.

The Presence of Civilians. Persons in uniform may salute civilians. The President of the U.S., as Commander in Chief of the Armed Forces, is always accorded the honor of a salute. Other civilians that warrant a salute include: The Vice President, Secretary of War, and Service Secretaries. DAFI90-1201 provides additional guidance. In addition, if the exchange of salutes is otherwise appropriate, customs encourage military members in civilian clothes to exchange salutes upon recognition.

Work Detail. In a work detail, individual workers do not salute. The person in charge salutes on behalf of the entire detail.

Military Funeral. When at a military funeral in uniform, salute the caisson or hearse as it passes and the casket as it is carried by your position. You also salute during the firing of volleys and the playing of "Taps."

Respect for the Flag and Songs

DAFI90-1201 PROTOCOL (Oct 2024)

The procedures to use when showing respect to the flag and the national anthem include:

When outdoors, all personnel in uniform, except those in formation must face the flag and salute during the raising and lowering of the flag. Upon the first note of the national anthem or "To the Colors," all personnel in uniform who are not in formation will stand at attention, face the flag (or the sound of the music, if the flag is not visible), and salute. Hold the salute until the last note of the national anthem or "To the Colors" is played.

All vehicles in motion will pull to the side of the road and stop. All occupants sit quietly until the last note of the national anthem or "To the Colors" has played.

When in civilian clothes, face the flag (or the sound of the music if the flag is not visible) and stand at attention with the right hand placed over the heart or render a salute.

If indoors during retreat or reveille, there is no need to stand or salute. However, everyone must stand during the playing of the national anthem before a showing of a movie while in the base theater. When listening to a radio or watching television, no specific action is necessary. A salute is not necessary for a folded flag (cased).

National Anthem

During the War of 1812, invading British forces burned Washington, D.C., setting fire to the U.S. Capitol, White House, and other federal buildings. Their attempt to destroy Baltimore met with failure following the gallant defense of Fort McHenry. Francis Scott Key, a Washington lawyer who witnessed the event was inspired and jotted down a poem that eventually became "The Star-Spangled Banner," our national anthem.

National Anthem

O say can you see, by the dawn's early light,
What so proudly we hailed at the twilight's last gleaming,
Whose broad stripes and bright stars, through the perilous fight
O'er the ramparts we watched were so gallantly streaming
And the rockets' red glare, the bombs bursting in air,
Gave proof through the night that our flag was still there!
O say does that Star-Spangled banner yet wave?
O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave!

Ruffles and Flourishes

This is a musical selection that is played for general officers and American Dignitaries. During the presentation of honors, military spectators come to attention and face the person receiving the honors, and all personnel salute.

Reveille and Retreat

When "Reveille" or "Retreat" is played simply as a bugle call to signal the beginning or end of the duty day, no courtesies are required. If "Reveille" or "Retreat" is played as a prelude to the national anthem or "To The Colors," or if the flag is being lowered or raised, render courtesies as appropriate for in or outdoors.

Taps

Taps began as a signal to extinguish lights (lights out) at the end of the day. Many Air Force installations play Taps to signify lights out or to begin quiet hours. For these purposes, saluting is not required.

However, upon hearing Taps at a military ceremony (i.e., military funeral, memorial ceremony, wreath laying etc.), individuals in uniform and outdoors will salute at the first note of Taps and maintain that position until the last note. If indoors and uncovered, individuals in uniform will stand at attention. Civilians should remove their headgear and place their hand over their heart.

Air and Space Force Songs

When the Air Force and Space Force Songs are played, Airmen and Guardians will stand at attention but are allowed to sing the lyrics of the their service song. Airmen and Guardians will not salute or clap. The Official Party may move after the playing of the first verse of the Air Force Song. Proper respect and courtesy is always rendered to all Service songs.

Air Force Song

The only official history of the Air Force Song can be found in a copy of a script which was used on radio station WRC broadcast on 23 Feb 1944. Captain Alf Heiburg, leader of the Army Air Corps Band, interviewed Captain Robert Crawford, composer of the "Army Air Corps Song," during this broadcast. Captain Crawford related the story: In 1939, when he was a civilian pilot, Robert Crawford was asked by a friend to enter a song contest. While flying his plane to Philadelphia, he composed a simple tune. The next day he wrote lyrics that, when combined with the tune, became what was known as the "Army Air Corps Song." The United States Army Band made the first recordings of the song in 1939. It was later renamed the Army Air Forces Song, and eventually the Air Force Song.

Off we go into the wild blue yonder,
Climbing high into the sun
Here they come zooming to meet our thunder At 'em
now, Give 'er the gun!
Down we dive, spouting our flame from under Off with
one helluva roar!
We live in fame or go down in flame. Hey!
Nothing can stop the U.S. Air Force!

II

Brilliant minds fashioned a crate of thunder Sent it
high into the blue
Valiant hands blasted the world a-sunder How
they lived God only knew!
Boundless souls dreaming of skies to conquer Gave
us wings, ever to soar!
With scouts before and bombers galore.
Nothing can stop the U.S. Air Force!

III

Here's a toast to the host
Of those who love the vastness of the sky,
To a friend we send a message of the brave who serve on high.
We drink to those who gave their all of old
Then down we roar to score the rainbow's pot of gold. A toast
to the host of those we boast, the U.S. Air Force!

IV

Off we go into the wild sky yonder,
Keep the wings level and true
If you'd live to be a grey-haired wonder Keep
the nose out of the blue!
Fly to fight, guarding the nation's border, We'll
be there followed by more!
In echelon we carry on, Hey!
Nothing'll stop the U.S. Air Force!

Space Force Song

Semper Supra Music and Lyrics by James Teachenor and Sean Nelson

As every branch of the armed forces has an official song, each song is part of the services' foundation and represents its values, traditions and culture. The U.S. Space Force, the newest military branch established in 2019, has officially adopted its own song titled "Semper Supra" that was unveiled during the 2022 Air & Space Forces Association Air, Space and Cyber Conference in National Harbor, Maryland, Sept. 20. “Semper Supra" was named after the USSF motto, which is Latin for "Always Above." It was created to capture the esprit de corps of both current and future Guardians, and intends to bring together service members by giving them a sense of pride. Two former service members, Teachenor and Nelson, collaborated to create the song, a process that took years of research and revisions to make sure the song was ready for release. They wanted it to encompass all the capabilities that the Space Force offers and its vision. Teachenor, a prior member of the U.S. Air Force band at the Air Force Academy, worked with Chief of Space Operations Gen. John "Jay" Raymond to begin the songwriting process when the Space Force was formed in 2019. After many months of development, revisions and variations in coordination with the USCG band, the Space Force picked the final version of "Semper Supra," to capture what it means to be a Guardian.

Space Force Song Lyrics

We’re the mighty watchful eye,
Guardians beyond the blue.
The invisible front line, Warfighters
brave and true. Boldly reaching into
space, There's no limit to our sky.
Standing guard both night and day,
We’re the Space Force from on high!

High Flight

By John Gillespie Magee Jr.

Oh! I have slipped the surly bonds of Earth
And danced the skies on laughter-silvered wings; Sunward
I've climbed, and joined the tumbling mirth
of sun-split clouds,—and done a hundred things
You have not dreamed of—wheeled and soared and swung
High in the sunlit silence. Hov'ring there,
I've chased the shouting wind along, and flung
My eager craft through footless halls of air ....
Up, up the long, delirious, burning blue
I've topped the wind-swept heights with easy grace
Where never lark, or even eagle flew—
And, while with silent lifting mind I've trod
The high untrespassed sanctity of space,
Put out my hand, and touched the face of God.

Cadet Prayer

Lord, God of hosts, my life is a stewardship in Your sight.
Grant the light of Your wisdom to the path of my cadet days.
Instill within me an abiding awareness of my responsibility toward You, my country and my fellowman.
I ask true humility that, knowing self, I may rise above human frailty.
I ask courage that I may prove faithful to duty beyond self.
I ask unfailing devotion to personal integrity that I may ever remain honorable without compromise.
Make me an effective instrument of Your peace in the defense of the skies that canopy free nations.
So guide me daily in each thought, word and deed, that I may fulfill Your will.
May these graces abide with me, my loved ones, and all who share my country's trust.

Amen

QUOTATIONS:

Airpower/Doctrine

"Victory smiles upon those who anticipate the character of war, not upon those who wait to adapt themselves after the changes occur."
- Italian Air Marshall Giulio Douhet

"A good plan executed now is better than a perfect plan next week.."
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"Offense is the essence of airpower."
- General of the Air Force Henry H. "Hap" Arnold

"War makes extremely heavy demands on the soldier's strength and nerves. For this reason, make heavy demands on your men in peacetime exercises."
- German Field Marshall Erwin Rommel

"In every battle, there comes a time when both sides consider themselves beaten; then he who continues the attack wins."
- General Ulysses S. Grant

"War, once declared, must be waged offensively, aggressively. The enemy must not be fended off; but smitten down. You may then spare him every exaction, relinquish every gain, but 'til then he must be struck incessantly and remorselessly."
- Alfred Thayer Mahan

"Upon the fields of friendly strife are sown the seeds that upon other days and other fields will bear the fruits of victory."
- General Douglas MacArthur, USA

Leadership

"When a man has strong qualities of leadership, but has low moral character, there is always the danger that his subordinates will be influenced by his bad characteristics, to the detriment of the leader and of the group. But if the leader is a man of strong qualities of leadership and high moral character, he will endure and he will achieve better results."
- Edgar F. Puryear Jr.

"The discipline which makes the soldiers of a free country reliable in battle is not to be gained by harsh or tyrannical treatment. On the contrary, such treatment is far more likely to destroy than to make an army. It is possible to impart instruction and give commands in such a manner and such a tone of voice as to inspire in the soldier no feeling but an intense desire to obey, while the opposite manner and tone of voice cannot fail to excite strong resentment and a desire to disobey. The one mode or the other of dealing with subordinates springs from a corresponding spirit in the breast of the commander. He who feels the respect which is due to others cannot fail to inspire in them respect for himself, while he who feels, and hence manifests disrespect towards others, especially his subordinates, cannot fail to inspire hatred against himself."
-MG John M. Schofield's address to the graduating class of 1879 at West Point

"The power of excellence is overwhelming. It is always in demand, and nobody cares about its color."
- General Daniel S. "Chappie" James, USAF

"The most important thing I learned is that soldiers watch what their leaders do. You can give them classes and lecture them forever, but it is your personal example they will follow."
- General Colin L. Powell, USA

"The day soldiers stop brining you their problems is the day you have stopped leading them. They have either lost confidence you can help them or concluded that you do not care. Either case is a failure of leadership."
- General Colin L. Powell, USA

"Officers must be made to care for their men. The sole duty of all officers."
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"You are always on parade."
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"I don't mind being called tough, because in this racket, it's tough guys who lead the survivors."
- General Curtis E. LeMay Chief of Staff, USAF

"Be an example to your men, in your duty and in private life. Never spare yourself and let your troops see that you don't in your endurance of fatigue and privation. Always be tactful and well-mannered. Avoid excessive sharpness or harshness of voice, which usually indicates the man who has shortcomings of his own to hide."
- German Field Marshall Erwin Rommel

"Require nothing unreasonable of your officers and men but see that whatever is required be punctually complied with. Reward and punish every man according to his merit, without partiality or prejudice; hear his complaints; if well founded, redress them; if otherwise, discourage them in order to discourage frivolous ones. Discourage vice in every shape, and impress upon the mind of every man, from the first to the lowest, the importance of cause, and what it is they are contending forlorn."
- President George Washington

"No man is fit to command another who cannot take care of himself."
- William Penn

"An ounce of loyalty is worth a pound of cleverness. If you must vilify, condemn, and eternally disparage - resign your position, and when you are outside damn to your heart's content; but as long as you are part of the institution, do not condemn it. If you do that, you are loosening the tendrils that are holding you to that institution, and at the first high wind that comes along, you will be uprooted and blown away, and you probably never know the reason why."
- Elbert Hubbard

Duty

"Duty, then, is the sublimest word in the English language. You should do your duty in all things. You can never do more. You should never wish to do less."
- General Robert E. Lee

"Duty, Honor, Country — those three hallowed words reverently dictate what you ought to be, what you can be, what you will be. They are your rallying point to build courage when courage seems to fail, to regain faith when there seems to be little cause for faith, to create hope when hope becomes forlorn."
- General Douglas MacArthur

"There is only one sort of discipline - PERFECT DISCIPLINE. Men cannot have good battle discipline and poor administrative discipline."
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"If you can't get them to salute when they should salute and wear the clothes you tell them to wear, how are you going to get them to die for their country?"
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"If I do my full duty, the rest will take care of itself."
- General George S. Patton Jr., USA

"Hold yourself responsible for a higher standard than anybody else expects of you. Never excuse yourself."
- Henry Ward Beecher

"It is not the critic who counts: not the man who points out how the strong man stumbles or where the doer of deeds could have done better. The credit belongs to the man who is actually in the arena, whose face is marred by dust and sweat and blood, who strives valiantly, who errs and comes up short again and again, because there is no effort without error or shortcoming, but who knows the great enthusiasms, the great devotions, who spends himself in a worthy cause; who, at the best, knows, in the end, the triumph of high achievement, and who, at the worst, if he fails, at least he fails while daring greatly, so that his place shall never be with those cold and timid souls who knew neither victory nor defeat."
- Theodore Roosevelt

"There is no limit to the good you can do if you don't care who gets the credit."
- General George C. Marshall, USA

Honor

"He who permits himself to tell a lie once, finds it much easier to do it a second and third time, till at length it becomes habitual; he tells lies without attending to it, and truths without the world's believing him."
- President Thomas Jefferson

"In matters of principle, stand like a rock; In matters of taste, swim with the current. Give up money, give up fame, give up science give up earth itself and all it contains, rather than do an immoral act. And never suppose that in any situation, or under any circumstances, it is best for you to do a dishonorable thing. Whenever you are to do a thing, though it can never be known but to yourself, ask yourself how you would act were all the world looking at you, and act accordingly."
- President Thomas Jefferson

"Integrity is the fundamental premise for military service in a free society. Without integrity, the moral pillars of our military strength, public trust, and self-respect are lost."
- General Charles A. Gabriel, Chief of Staff, USAF

"If I can't go back with my self-respect, I won't go back at all."
- Captain Theodore Harris USAF (After 14 months in solitary confinement as POW in Korea)

"A man has integrity if his interest in the good of the service is at all times greater that his own personal pride, and when he holds himself to the same line of duty when unobserved as he would follow if his superiors were present."
- Brig General S.L.A Marshall

Country

"Let every nation know, whether it wishes us well or ill, that we shall pay any price, bear any burden, meet any hardship, support any friend, oppose any foe, in order to assure the survival and the success of liberty."
- President John F. Kennedy

"What you have chosen to do for your country, by devoting your life to the service of our country, is the greatest contribution that any man could make."
- President John F. Kennedy

"Where there is a visible enemy to fight in open combat, the answer is not so difficult. Many serve, all applaud, and the tide of patriotism runs high. But when there is a long, slow struggle, with no immediately visible foe, your choice will seem hard indeed."
- President John F. Kennedy

"An officer's ultimate commanding loyalty at all times is to his country, and not to his service or to his superiors."
- General of the Army George C. Marshal

"War is an ugly thing, but not the ugliest of things. The decayed and degraded state of moral and patriotic feeling, which thinks that nothing is worth war, is much worse. The person, who has nothing for which he is willing to fight, nothing which is more important than his own personal safety, is a miserable creature and has no chance of being free unless made and kept so by the exertions of better men than himself."
- John Stuart Mill

"It is the soldier, not the reporter, who has given us the freedom of the press. It is the soldier, not the poet, who has given us the freedom of speech. It is the soldier, not the campus organizer, who has given us the freedom to demonstrate. It is the soldier who salutes the flag, who serves beneath the flag, and whose coffin is draped by the flag, who allows the protestor to burn the flag."

- Father Denis Edward O'Brien, Sergeant, USMC

Coaches:

"If what you did yesterday seems big, you haven't done anything today."
- Lou Holtz

"To defeat a weak opponent is not the problem: The problem is to win when he is as good or better than you."
- Robert Neyland

"Good fellows are a dime a dozen, but an aggressive leader is priceless."
- Red Blaik

"Treat a person as he is, and he will remain as he is. Treat him as he could be, and he will become what he should be."
- Jimmy Johnson

"It's not whether you get knocked down, it's whether you get up."
- Vince Lombardi

"What you do speaks a lot louder than what you say."
- Brent Venables

"Success is peace of mind, which is a direct result of self-satisfaction in knowing you made the effort to become the best of which you are capable."
- John Wooden

"Leaders aren't born, they are made. They are made by hard effort, which is the price which all of us must pay to achieve any goal which is worthwhile."
- Vince Lombardi

"The difference between a successful person and others is not a lack of strength, not a lack of knowledge, but rather a lack in will."
-Vince Lombardi

Airman's Creed

AFH1 (Feb 25)

The Airman's Creed was introduced in 2007 by General T. Michael Moseley, Chief of Staff of the U.S. Air Force. It is intended to remind all Airmen that we are not just a conglomeration of specialties, skill sets, or jobs, but we are brothers and sisters in the Profession of Arms. It allows Airmen to think and act with one mind, and with a commitment to fundamental war fighting beliefs. Airmen are warriors, and are dedicated to flying, fighting, and winning. For you, your understanding of the Airman's Creed begins at Officer Training School. Every person will stand at the position of attention and recite the Airman's Creed, to include bystanders.

Airman's Creed

I am an American Airman.
I am a Warrior.
I have answered my Nation's call.
I am an American Airman.
My mission is to Fly, Fight, and Win.
I am faithful to a Proud Heritage,
A Tradition of Honor, And a Legacy of Valor.
I am an American Airman.
Guardian of Freedom and Justice,
My Nation's Sword and Shield,
Its Sentry and Avenger.
I defend my Country with my Life.
I am an American Airman.
Wingman, Leader, Warrior.
I will never leave an Airman behind,
I will never falter,
And I will not fail.

The Profession of Arms

AFH1 (Feb 25)

Air Force Profession of Arms: (the Context

A vocation comprised of experts in the design, generation, support and application of global vigilance, global reach and global power serving under civilian authority, entrusted to defend the Constitution and accountable to the American people.

Air Force Professional: (the Identity

An Airman (Regular Air Force, Reserve, Guard or civilian is a trusted servant to our Nation who demonstrates unquestionable competence, adheres to the highest ethical standards and is a steward of the future of the Air Force profession. Air Force professionals are distinguished by a willing commitment and loyalty to the Air Force Core Values.

Air Force Professionalism: (the Spirit)

A personal commitment and loyalty to Air Force standards and expectations framed within an environment of shared trust, guided by Air Force Core Values.

Wingman Concept

AFI 1-1 (August 2023)

Airmen at all levels of command and supervision, have a role as wingmen. The Air Force culture is centered on the idea that a wingman will always safeguard their lead, and it adheres to the belief that a lead never lets his or her wingman stray into danger. All Airmen are encouraged to be good wingmen. Being a good wingman means taking care of fellow Airmen and taking action when signs of trouble or distress are observed, especially in situations where Airmen appear as if they are about to make a poor decision, are in despair, or show signs of hurting themselves or others. Commanders also need to recognize when their people need help and know where to send them to get it. Supervisors are the first line of defense for the well-being of the people they supervise. And as leaders, supervisors are often in a position to spot the first signs of trouble and are in the best position to listen and provide, or arrange for, needed assistance.

Comprehensive Airman Fitness Domains and Tenets

Fitness Domain	Domain Tenets
Mental	Awareness – Adaptability – Decision Making – Positive Thinking
Physical	Endurance – Recovery – Nutrition - Strength
Social	Communication – Connectedness – Social Support - Teamwork
Spiritual	Core Values – Perseverance – Perspective - Purpose
More tools available at www.resilience.af.mil.	

Stress Management

AFH1 (Feb 25)

For Airmen [Guardians] today, stressors occur within the work environment as well as outside the work environment, often involving family, relationship, and financial issues. We know when we feel stressed, but recognizing some of the key signs of stress can help deal with issues before they evolve into bigger problems. Stress reactions typically appear in four different categories: cognitive, emotional, behavioral, and physical. Reactions associated with these categories are provided here so they may be recognized and addressed early by minimizing, adjusting, or successfully coping with the cause.

Types of Stress

Cognitive Stress. Cognitive stress can manifest as memory problems, an inability to concentrate, poor judgment, seeing only the negative, anxious or racing thoughts, or constant worrying.

Emotional Stress. Emotional stress can manifest as apathy, anxiety, depression, irritability, job dissatisfaction, memory problems, or mental fatigue.

Behavioral Stress. Behavioral stress can manifest as appetite changes, increased arguments, increased smoking, neglecting self-care, social withdrawal, substance abuse, or violence.

Physical Stress. Physical stress can manifest as frequent illness, headaches, high blood pressure, increased heart rate, physical exhaustion, sleep disturbances, or weight gain or loss.

Common symptoms of stress:	
Cognitive	**Emotional**
Memory Problems	Apathy
Inability to concentrate	Anxiety
Poor Judgement	Depression
Seeing only the negative	Irritability
Anxious or racing thoughts	Job dissatisfaction
Constant worrying	Memory problems
Behavioral	**Physical**
Appetite changes	Frequent Illness
Increased argument	Headaches
Increased smoking	High blood pressure
Neglecting self care	Increased heart rate
Social withdrawal	Physical Exhaustion
Substance abuse	Sleep disturbances
Violence	Weight loss/gain

Stress Management Practices

Make Adjustments. Reduce stress by identifying potential stressors before they arise. For example, if you are stressed by crowds and long lines, adjust your plans so that you may minimize the exposure to crowded environments. While planning can't prevent all stress, it is extremely valuable in minimizing or preparing for exposure to stress before a stressor occurs.

Time Management. Not having enough time to complete a task can be a significant stressor for some people. If time management is an issue, reduce stress by using effective time management skills and tools, like developing a task list and prioritizing tasks.

Overload Avoidance. For most people to eliminate or reduce the effects of overload-related stressors is relatively simple. For a start, identify and avoid busy work, delegate or empower others when possible, learn to say no, and attempt to negotiate unreasonable deadlines.

Relaxation. Relaxation can help manage stress and help you stay alert, energetic, and productive. Relaxation techniques, such as meditation, reading, and listening to music can improve your heart rate, regulate your blood pressure, and decrease your respiratory rate. By incorporating relaxation skills into your daily routines, you can train your body to respond differently to stress.

Exercise and Nutrition. Regular exercise combined with a healthy diet is an effective stress management technique. Exercise can provide an outlet for excess energy and tension caused by stress.

Eating nutritious foods ensures your body has the nutrients needed to manage stress and helps prevent overeating. Exercising and eating a balanced diet help your body become more resistant to the negative results of stress, such as high blood pressure, heart attacks, and frequent illness.

Social Support. Having a strong social support network, such as family, friends, social groups, and peers, can help manage stress. Being able to discuss problems with people who care about you and your well-being can help reduce stress by providing a more positive outlook, suggesting solutions to your problems, or just listening.

Prioritize. On the job, identify potential sources of stress, determine the importance of each task, and eliminate tasks that are not necessary or productive. If a job requires long hours, consider using elements of job enrichment, like adequate time off or periodic breaks to help reduce potential stress. If possible, restructure the job to accommodate individual needs to help reduce stress and enhance productivity.

Organizational Stress Management Methods.

As an Airman [Guardian], and a supervisor, your approach to dealing with stress can help reduce your and your subordinates' stress levels. You can begin by identifying potential stressors in the work environment and developing strategies to remove or reduce them. Here are a few examples of organizational stress management methods you can use:

Job Design. Tasks can induce stress; ask yourself if there is a need for each task and if the task is feasible. Eliminate the task if not needed. Ask yourself how important job design is and prioritize tasks. If your subordinates work long hours, try using elements of job enrichment, like giving time off or periodic breaks to reduce potential stress. If within your power restructure the job to better accommodate the needs and the abilities of your Airmen to help reduce stress.

Improving the Work Environment. Physical factors within a work environment can be stressors. Some of these stressors cannot be eliminated, but you may reduce them. Examine environmental factors like temperature, noise, light levels, to make improvements.

Workplace Conflict. Conflict with co-workers can create stress in the workplace. Resolve issues by discussing them with the person involved, listening to their perspective, and communicating calmly and professionally. Strive to find a compromise or agreement. If resolution is difficult, consider involving a mediator.

Improving Organizational Communication. A lack of information can be a significant stressor. As a supervisor, you should do your best to keep your subordinates informed about anything that could impact their lives. Practice good communication skills, like active listening, being open minded and avoiding prejudging, and humility. These skills not only will help reduce stress, but also promote trust, cooperation, and teamwork within the work center.

Personnel Selection and Job Placement. Matching individuals to suitable positions based on their skills, experience, and rank can prevent stress for both the individual and their colleagues. Although it may be challenging in the military, prioritizing the placement of the right person in the right position can yield significant stress-related advantages.

Substance Abuse Programs. Sometimes stress can cause people to resort to dependency which can have a dramatically negative effect on mission, morale, and readiness. All supervisors are responsible for managing substance abusers in accordance with applicable directives.

Air Force Standards

AFI 1-1 (August 2023)

Free Exercise of Religion and Religious Accommodation. Airmen should confidently practice their own beliefs while respecting others whose viewpoints differ from their own. Every Airman is free to practice the religion of their choice or subscribe to no religious belief at all. Every Airman also has the right to individual expressions of sincerely held beliefs, to include conscience, moral principles, or religious beliefs, unless those expressions would have an adverse impact on military readiness, unit cohesion, good order, discipline, health and safety, or mission accomplishment.

Sexual Assault Prevention and Response. SAPR victim advocacy to DAF military is members who experience sexual harassment. Sexual harassment reporting and victim advocacy via the SAPR program do not replace the MEO complaint processes available to military members. Unrestricted reports of sexual harassment will be reported to MEO. SAPR prevention initiatives and response services reinforce DAF standards and are designed to empower Airmen to serve as catalysts for attitude and behavior changes, fostering an environment that cultivates a culture of dignity, mutual respect, and trust. See DAFI 90-6001, *Sexual Assault Prevention and Response (SAPR) Program.*

Drug Abuse. The illegal use of drugs, or improper use of legal drugs, is not just against federal law, but is also completely inconsistent with Air Force Core Values and DAF standards of behavior, performance, and discipline necessary to accomplish the Air Force missions.

Political Activities. Generally, as individuals, Airmen enjoy the same rights and have the same responsibilities as other citizens. However, because they are Airmen in the United States Air Force, the manner in which they exercise their rights is limited in some cases. Under our democratic system, the military, as a group, must remain politically neutral and divorced from partisan politics per AFI 51-508, *Political Activities, Free Speech, and Freedom of Assembly of Air Force Personnel.* There are some general rules that Airmen should remember:

1. Airmen have the right as American citizens to vote and to voice their opinions concerning political matters; however, they must be careful that their personal opinions and activities are not directly, or by implication, represented as those of the Air Force.

2. Airmen may attend partisan political rallies or speeches when not in uniform, not on duty, and when solely acting as a spectator.

3. Airmen may make a monetary contribution to a political organization, party, or committee favoring a political candidate or slate of candidates, subject to the limitations of 52 USC § 30116.

4. Airmen may support or endorse a particular political candidate, party, cause, or issue through displaying a single standard-sized bumper sticker on personally owned vehicles. No larger vehicle signs are permitted. Airmen may not display any type of political sign, banner, poster, or similar device in their office or work area or at their on-base residence, even if that residence is part of a privatized housing development.

5. Federal installations and workplaces are not traditional public forums for free speech and political discussions are generally not appropriate. Airmen may not attempt to influence the view, position, or vote of any subordinate except to generally encourage participation in the voting process.



The Code of Conduct is a moral code designed to provide U.S. military personnel with a standard of conduct that all members are expected to measure up to. The six articles of the Code of Conduct were designed to address situations that any member could encounter to some degree. It includes basic information useful to prisoners of war to help them survive honorably while resisting captors' efforts to exploit them. It is also applicable to service members subject to other hostile detention, such as hostage scenarios. Survival and resistance in hostile situations requires knowledge and understanding of the six articles. Violations of the Code of Conduct are not criminally punishable per se, but actions that also violate the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ) may subject members to disciplinary action.

President Dwight D. Eisenhower first published the Code of Conduct for members of the U.S. Armed Forces on 17 August 1955. In March 1988, President Ronald W. Reagan amended the code with gender-neutral language. The six articles of the Code of Conduct are listed below, followed by an explanation of each article and significant aspects of that article.

ARTICLE I

I am an American, fighting in the forces which guard my country and our way of life. I am prepared to give my life in their defense.

ARTICLE II

I will never surrender of my own free will. If in command, I will never surrender the members of my command while they still have the means to resist.

ARTICLE III

If I am captured, I will continue to resist by all means available. I will make every effort to escape and to aid others to escape. I will accept neither parole nor special favors from the enemy.

ARTICLE IV

If I become a prisoner of war, I will keep faith with my fellow prisoners. I will give no information or take part in any action which might be harmful to my comrades. If I am senior, I will take command. If not, I will obey the lawful orders of those appointed over me and will back them up in every way.

ARTICLE V

When questioned, should I become a prisoner of war, I am required to give name, rank, service number, and date of birth. I will evade answering further questions to the utmost of my ability. I will make no oral or written statements disloyal to my country and its allies or harmful to their cause.

ARTICLE VI

I will never forget that I am an American, fighting for freedom, responsible for my actions, and dedicated to the principles which made my country free. I will trust in my God and in the United States of America.

The importance of the Code was reiterated by Army Chief Warrant Officer Dave Williams, who credited it with helping him lead and endure captivity during the Iraq invasion in 2003. Despite the Korean War being termed the "Forgotten War," the enduring legacy of the Code of Conduct remains a unifying element across all ranks and services of the U.S. military, emphasizing duty, honor, and the principles of freedom.

Military Law, UCMJ Overview

AFH1 (Feb 25)

Military Law is a Separate Judicial System. Effective leadership is the most desirable means of maintaining standards. Military law provides commanders the tools, including court-martial and nonjudicial punishment, to deal with criminal conduct. The purpose of military law is to promote justice, to assist in maintaining good order and discipline in the Armed Forces, to promote efficiency and effectiveness in the military establishment, and to thereby strengthen the national security of the United States.

The Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ). In 1950, Congress enacted the UCMJ, and President Harry S. Truman signed it into law. In 1951, President Truman created the Manual for Courts-Martial by executive order. The Manual for Courts-Martial sets out rules for evidence, procedure, maximum punishments, and provides standardized forms. The Manual for Courts-Martial is intended to provide military law guidance to commanders and judge advocates and is revised annually. It contains a wide range of materials, including the U.S. Constitution, the UCMJ, rules for courts- martial, and military rules of evidence.

Article 15 (Nonjudicial punishment). Article 15 provides commanders with an essential and prompt means of maintaining good order and discipline without the stigma of a court-martial conviction. An Article 15 may be imposed for minor offenses. Any Air Force member can be punished by Article 15. c

Commanders are encouraged to take nonpunitive disciplinary actions, such as counseling and administrative reprimand, before resorting to Article 15. An Article 15 cannot be imposed upon a member who demands trial by court-martial. The type and permissible extent of punishment are limited by both the imposing commander's grade and the offender's grade and may include reduction in grade, forfeiture of pay, restrictions, extra duties, and/or correctional custody.

Types of Courts-Martial

Summary Court-Martial. Summary courts-martial have jurisdiction to try enlisted members subject to the UCMJ accused of any noncapital offense made punishable by the UCMJ. No person with respect to whom summary courts-martial have jurisdiction may be brought to trial before a summary court-martial if he or she objects. If objection to trial by summary court-martial is made, trial may be ordered by special or general court-martial, as appropriate. Summary courts-martial may, under such limitations as the U.S. President may prescribe, adjudge any punishment not forbidden by the UCMJ except death, dismissal, dishonorable or bad-conduct discharge, confinement for more than one month, hard-labor without confinement for more than 45 days, restriction to specified limits for more than two months, or forfeiture of more than two-thirds of one month's pay. A summary court-martial consists of one commissioned officer and is a noncriminal forum. A finding of guilty at a summary court-martial does not constitute a criminal conviction.

Special Court-Martial. Special courts-martial have jurisdiction to try members subject to the UCMJ for any noncapital offense made punishable by the UCMJ, and under such regulations as the U.S. President may prescribe, for capital offenses. Special courts-martial may, under such limitations as the President may prescribe, adjudge any punishment not forbidden by the UCMJ except death, dishonorable discharge, dismissal, confinement for more than one year, hard labor without confinement for more than three months, forfeiture of pay exceeding two-thirds pay per month, or forfeiture of pay for more than one year. A special court-martial may consist of a military judge with a panel of four members (plus alternate members if authorized by the convening authority), a military judge alone, or in some cases, with the consent of the parties involved, a military magistrate.

General Court-Martial. General courts-martial have jurisdiction to try persons subject to the UCMJ for any offense made punishable by the UCMJ and may, under such limitations as the U.S. President may prescribe, adjudge any punishment not forbidden by the UCMJ, including the penalty of death when specifically authorized by the UCMJ. General courts-martial also have jurisdiction to try any person who, by the law of war, is subject to trial by a military tribunal, and may adjudge any punishment permitted by the law of war. However, in certain circumstances, general courts-martial shall not have jurisdiction to try any person for any offense for which the death penalty may be adjudged unless the case has been previously referred to trial as a noncapital case. A general court- martial may consist of a military judge with a panel of eight or more members, a military judge alone, or in capital cases, a military judge with a panel of twelve members.

Legal Rights. Members of the Armed Forces retain virtually all the legal rights they held as civilians before entering the military, including protection against involuntary self-incrimination and the right to counsel.

Involuntary Self-incrimination. The Fifth Amendment to the Constitution states that no person shall be compelled to be a witness against him or herself. Article 31, UCMJ, and military rules of evidence 304 reflect this right and prohibit involuntary statements from being used against an accused.

Statements. Once properly advised of his or her rights, a person may waive these rights and choose to make a statement. Assuming this waiver is made freely, knowingly, and intelligently, any subsequent statement can be used as evidence in a court-martial or other judicial or administrative proceedings.

Right to Counsel. The UCMJ provides an accused the right to be represented by a military attorney before summary, special, and general courts-martial; Article 32 preliminary hearings; and in the Article 15 process free of charge. The Area Defense Counsel program provides Air Force members independent legal representation.

Social Media Guidance

AFI 1-1 (August 2023)

General Social Media Guidance

The Air Force and Space Force views personal web sites, weblogs, and other social media accounts positively, and it respects the right of Airmen and Guardians to use them as a medium of self- expression. However, all Airman and Guardians have limitations of free speech. The following guidance, while not all inclusive, will help you use social media responsibly. Members are free to repost publicly released information on their personal social media accounts.

Members should use their best judgment, remembering that there are always consequences to what is written. If they're about to post something that is questionable and may reflect negatively on the Air Force and Space Force, they should review Air Force and Space Force guidance thoroughly. If still unsure, and the post is about the Air Force and Space Force, they should discuss the proposed post with their supervisor or the Public Affairs office. Members are solely responsible for what they post. Members cannot use their service affiliation for fundraising purposes on personal social media accounts except for OPM approved fundraisers such as CFC and the Air Force Associations.

Members should not use government email accounts to establish personal accounts. Members cannot invite other government employees to participate in social media accounts via a government email address. Members should not use their official position on personal accounts unless it's a biographical detailed accompanied by biographical facts including official photos. All political activity on personal pages must follow the guidance provided by the Office of Special Counsel.

Social Media Restrictions

Do not post any defamatory, libelous, vulgar, obscene, abusive, profane, threatening, hateful, racially, ethnically, or otherwise offensive or illegal information or material.

Do not post any information or other material protected by copyright without the permission of the copyright owner.

Do not use any words, logos or other marks that would infringe upon the trademark, service mark, certification mark, or other intellectual property rights of the owners of such marks without the permission of owners. Do not post any information that would infringe upon the proprietary, privacy, or personal rights of others.

Do not post any non-public information to include classified or sensitive information (unclassified operational information).

Do not forge or otherwise manipulate identifiers in posts in an attempt to disguise, impersonate, or otherwise misrepresent their identity or affiliation with any other person or entity.

Social Media and Department of the Air Force Standards (AFI 1-1, para 2.20)

As a member of the Department of the Air Force, you are entrusted with the responsibility to ensure that your communication adheres to the highest standards of professionalism, integrity, and security. This applies to all forms of communication, including face-to-face interactions, telephone conversations, written correspondence, email exchanges, text messages, and engagement on social media platforms.

When engaging in online communication, such as commenting on internet blogs or participating in social media discussions, it is crucial to exercise caution and consider the potential impact of your statements. Degrading morale or discrediting the service is strictly prohibited and can lead to disciplinary action. It is important to remember that your online presence reflects upon the Air Force and can influence public perception. When expressing personal opinions on social media or online platforms, it is essential to clarify that you are speaking for yourself and not on behalf of the Air Force. This helps to avoid any confusion or misrepresentation of the organization's official stance. It is important to maintain a clear distinction between personal views and official positions, ensuring that your statements do not create any misconceptions or misinterpretations.

Finally, it is imperative to understand that violating laws, regulations, or policies through online activity can result in disciplinary action. The Air Force expects its members to uphold the highest standards of conduct and compliance, both in their professional and personal lives. Any illegal or inappropriate behavior online can have serious repercussions, both within the military justice system and in civil law.

In summary, as an Air Force member, you have a responsibility to maintain proper communication and conduct in all forms of interaction. This includes adhering to Department of the Air Force standards and guidelines, avoiding the sharing of classified or official DoD information without proper authorization, maintaining professionalism and respect in all interactions, being cautious of the impact of your statements on morale and public perception, clarifying personal opinions as separate from official Air Force positions, being mindful of online relationships and their impact on security clearances, and avoiding any illegal or inappropriate behavior that could lead to disciplinary action. By adhering to these principles, you contribute to the reputation, integrity, and success of the Air Force.

Chapter 3

History

Prop and Wings 60

History of ROTC 62

Air and Space Leaders 62

Air and Space Force Events 66

United States Air Force Heritage 68

Prop and Wings



The Prop and Wings (propeller and wings) is a military insignia used to identify various aviation-related units in the United States military. The Prop and Wings originated as branch insignia of the United States Army Air Service in 1920, and remained such from 1926 to 1947 for the successor United States Army Air Corps. It is now worn after successful completion of program requirements. The Prop & Wings is the symbol of the American Airman. First worn by Aviation Cadets in 1917, the tradition continued in other commissioning programs. The Prop & Wings symbol is now worn by all Air Force Academy, Reserve Officer Training Corps (ROTC) cadets, and Officer Training School (OTS) trainees who have met the challenges of the first phase of officer training. Through completion of this common experience, they have earned the right to be accepted as full members of the Long Blue Line of the U.S. Air Force. As future leaders of the Air Force, all graduates of OTS and ROTC lay their hands on this historic plaque. *Descendants of Air Force, Army Air Corps, or WASP members are authorized gold.*

Inscription:

Established here in 1931, was the birthplace and nurturing ground of American air doctrine. In the ferment of a decade of thought and debate, the Air Corps Tactical School gave rise to concepts for the strategic and operational deployment of U.S. air power against two formidable aggressor nations separated by half a world. Validation of this revolutionary approach to warfare came with victory over the Axis with fewer casualties than in advancing a few hundred miles in World War I.

Most of America's senior air officers of World War II – including the legendary Claire Chennault, Ira Eaker, Harold George, Haywood S. Hansell, Laurence Kuter and Curtis LeMay – were instructors or graduates of the school. This memorial honors their visionary achievements and stands in tribute to the intellectual energy which fashioned the air power concepts so crucial to victory.

Air University, born of the Air Corps Tactical School, continues the legacy – generating ideas needed for the rapid advance of the air and space power so vital to our nation and its future.

Erected in 1994 by the Citizens of Montgomery and the Montgomery Chapter of the Air Force Association.



Photographs By Mark Hilton, November 22, 2014



History of Air Force Reserve Officers' Training Corps

Air Force Reserve Officers' Training Corps (AFROTC) is the largest and oldest source of commissioned officers for the Air Force. AFROTC is designed to recruit, educate, and commission officer candidates through academic education, Field Training and Officer Development programs based on Air Force and Space Force requirements. Students can attend classes through host or cross-town enrollment programs. Cadet enrollments have ranged from a high of 23,605 in 1986 to a low of 10,231 in 1993.

AFROTC was established with the passage of the National Defense Act of 1916, which established program guidelines that remained in effect until 1964. The Army Reorganization Act of 1920 created ROTC units specifically designed to train rated officers for the Air Corps. By 1926, seven such units existed, but a lack of funds to support flight training forced three to close in 1928 and the remainder units only trained non-rated officers. Since the Air Corps had virtually no requirement for non- rated officers, it closed the remaining units in 1933.

After World War II, Gen Dwight D. Eisenhower, Chief of Staff of the War Department, signed General Order No. 124, establishing AFROTC units at 78 colleges and universities throughout the nation. Eligible Air Force enlisted men and women pursuing a college degree who were interested in becoming commissioned officers were given that opportunity through competition in the AFROTC Airman Scholarship and Commissioning Program, established in 1973.

In 1978, Air Training Command (ATC) assumed responsibility for AFROTC programs. On 1 July 1993, ATC merged with Air University to form Air Education and Training Command. Air University became a direct reporting unit under Air Education and Training Command and AFROTC realigned under Air Force Accessions Center.

In February 1997, AFROTC and Officer Training School merged under the newly created parent organization, HQ Air Force Officer Accession and Training Schools (AFOATS). This restructuring placed oversight for three-quarters of Air Force officer production under one command and facilitated the sharing of manpower and expertise with minimum effect on the day-to-day operations of either organization. In June 2008, HQ AFOATS was re-designated as the Jeanne M. Holm Center for Officer Accessions and Citizen Development. In 2020, USSF officers began commissioning through the AFROTC program. The Air Force Accession Center activated on 1 Dec, 2024 and consolidates the Holm Center and AFROTC.

The following Airmen are representative of the whose exceptional contributions shaped and influenced our Air Force and continue to inspire today's Airmen.

"Air power is indivisible. If you split it up into compartments, you merely pull it to pieces and destroy its greatest asset— its flexibility."
- Field Marshal Viscount Bernard L. Montgomery

General Curtis E. LeMay

General LeMay started his career as a cadet in the Army Air Corps flying school in 1928 after graduating from the ROTC program at Ohio State University. On 12 May 1938, LeMay led three B-17's on a mission to intercept the Italian liner *Rex*. With this success, LeMay confirmed air power had the potential for defending our nation from sea attack as well as affirming the navigational capabilities of long-range bombers. Regarded as one of the greatest combat commanders in Air Force history, LeMay led the Schweinfurt-Regensburg raid of 1943 and commanded the 20th and 21st Bomber Commands in 1945. Over the years, LeMay earned the reputation as an extraordinary pilot and navigator. "We will always need manned systems—manned planes, manned spacecraft. Missiles are spectacular and they play their role, but they have no sense of loyalty; they can't think; they can't be recalled." LeMay continued to lead by example and became Commander of the United States Air Forces in Europe (USAFE from 1947–1948, Commander-in-Chief, Strategic Air Command from 1948–1957, and USAF Chief of Staff from 1961–1965.

General James H. "Jimmy" Doolittle

General Doolittle enlisted in the Army Signal Corps Reserve in October 1917 as a flying cadet. Doolittle resigned from the Army Air Corps in 1930; but ten years later in July 1940, he returned to active duty. In April of 1942, he led 16 B-25 medium bombers on the first American bombing attack against the homeland of Japan from the deck of the *USS Hornet*. As a result of this bombing run on Tokyo, he received the Medal of Honor. In his career, he was the commander of the Twelfth Air Force in North Africa, the Fifteenth Air Force in Italy, and the Eighth Air Force in England. Doolittle advocated the creation of an independent Air Force. "The first lesson is that you cannot lose a war if you have command of the air and you cannot win a war if you haven't." Doolittle, nicknamed the "Renaissance Man of Aviation," was a test pilot as well as a daredevil and risk taker who made deliberate decisions. Doolittle died in California on 27 September 1993.

Brigadier General William "Billy" Mitchell

Brig General Mitchell was a prominent crusader for air power. His career started when he became a second lieutenant in the volunteer signal company. Mitchell became the driving force for advocating the strength and power that aeronautics would play in the future as an equal partner to the Army and Navy. He proposed the Department of Aeronautics should be in charge of the training and personnel used by the other services. Mitchell proposed that the airplane was superior to the battleship, which he tried to demonstrate by sinking the *Ostfriesland* on 22 July 1921. In many ways, his ideas and methods sparked controversy and disapproval, which led to his

court-martial. Mitchell attempted to gain support with his first book, *Our Air Force*. Mitchell contributed to the doctrinal and tactical growth of the Air Service despite the opposition that he struggled against.

General Carl. A "Tooey" Spaatz

General Spaatz graduated from West Point in 1914. He began flight training in 1915 at Rockwell Field, San Diego. "Tooey" was a man of few words but always in control. He brought public attention to the Army Air Service as commander of the Far West Flying Circus putting on stunting and dogfighting exhibitions. General Carl Spaatz was named by President Truman as the **first Chief of Staff of the Air Force** on 25 Sep 1947 and was sworn in on 26 Sep 1947. Spaatz, like Eaker, realized the importance of a separate Air Force. His commands included Commander of the Eighth Air Force, Commander of the North African Air Force, and Commander of U.S. Strategic Air Forces in Europe. "Spaatz was mission commander for the 'Question Mark' crew that flew for 150 hours, 40 minutes, and 15 seconds on 7 January 1929.

General Ira C. Eaker

General Eaker began his flying career in 1918 when he was placed on detached service to receive flying instruction at Austin and Kelly fields in Texas. Eaker understood the necessity of popular support in order for air power to be established once the U.S. began arming for the war in Europe in 1938. Eaker was a primary USAAF representative establishing the British–U.S. combined bomber offensive of WWII, and he led bombing raids on German-occupied Europe as commander of the Eighth Air Force.

General Bernard A. Schriever

General Schriever was what many consider to be the Founding Father of the U.S. Space program. He followed the Army Air Corps to what is now the U.S. Air Force. Schriever is credited for overcoming the technical challenges that presented themselves during the development of the ICBM. His tremendous effort to get the missiles developed and deployed, especially in the light of the space race that began as a result of his efforts, directly affected America's ability to compete for control of space. His tremendous achievements were reflected and rewarded by the re-designation of Falcon AFB in Colorado Springs to Schriever AFB in 1998 and later Schriever Space Force Base in 2021.

First Lieutenant Karl W. Richter

First Lt. Karl Richter's story is one of remarkable courage and perseverance. An Air Force Academy graduate, Richter flew F-105Ds in the 421st TFS, 388th TFW, Korat RTAFB. He flew aggressively and volunteered for the most hazardous missions. In September 1966, he shot down a MiG-17. As he neared the end of his 100-mission tour, Richter asked for and received permission to fly 100 more missions back-to-back. On his second tour, he was awarded an Air Force Cross for a mission on April 20, 1967, in which he vigorously suppressed heavy AAA and SAM defenses. In July 1967, on his 198th mission, Lt. Richter was hit by enemy fire and ejected over sharp limestone rocks known as karst. He was mortally injured when he hit the rocks.

Captain Lance P. Sijan

Captain Lance P. Sijan was an American Air Force pilot during the Vietnam War. Born in 1942, he grew up in a patriotic family and graduated the Air Force Academy in 1965. Sijan was assigned to the 480th Tactical Fighter Squadron in Vietnam. On November 9, 1967, Sijan's aircraft was hit by enemy fire, and he ejected but was severely injured. Despite his injuries, he survived for 46 days in the Vietnamese jungle, evading capture. Sijan endured starvation, dehydration, and infections before being captured on Christmas Day. Throughout his captivity, he never divulged sensitive information to his captors.

Sijan's health rapidly declined, but he continued to resist his captors and inspire fellow POWs. Tragically, he died on January 22, 1968, at the age of 25. Sijan' remarkable bravery and commitment earned him numerous accolades. In 1976, Sijan posthumously received the Medal of Honor, the highest US military decoration. He was the first Air Force Academy graduate to receive this honor. Lance Sijan's story remains an inspiration to military personnel. His unwavering courage and resilience in the face of adversity have solidified his status as a true American hero.

Air and Space Force Events

March 16, 1926 - Dr. Robert H. Goddard launched the first liquid fueled rocket in history. It flew 184 feet and started the age of Modern Rocketry.

April 12, 1981 - The first Space Shuttle Orbiter, OV-102 Columbia, manned by John Young (commander) and Robert Crippen (pilot) was successfully launched by NASA from Cape Canaveral.

April 18, 1942 - Led by Lt Colonel James H. Doolittle, 16 B-25s took off from the carrier *USS Hornet* in the first raid on Tokyo.

Although all 16 planes were lost, 14 crews came through alive. Lt Colonel Doolittle was awarded the Medal of Honor, and the other flyers received the Distinguished Flying Cross.

May 5, 1961 - Commander Alan B. Shepard, Jr., USN, became the first U.S. astronaut to enter space. His Project Mercury capsule, "Freedom 7,'' was boosted from Cape Canaveral, Florida, by a Mercury Redstone (MR-3) rocket to a height of 115 miles. The flight lasted 15 min 28 sec, traveled 302 miles, and reached a maximum speed of 5,000 mph.

May 12, 1949 - The Soviet blockade of Berlin was lifted, ending the Berlin Airlift and signifying a great moral victory for the Western Powers. During the 462 days of "Operation Vittles'' that preceded the end of the airlift on September 30, 1949, U.S. planes had officially carried 1,783,826 tons of supplies in 277,262 flights. The airlift demonstrated the importance of air power as an instrument of national policy.

June 3–7, 1965 - During the 4-day flight of the Gemini 4 capsule, Major Edward H. White, USAF, was the first American to walk in space. Major James A. McDivitt, USAF, was the mission commander. Astronaut White spent 22 minutes outside the capsule, connected by a 25-foot tether and oxygen cord.

June 27, 1923 - Lt Lowell H. Smith and Lt John P. Richter, flying a DH-4 together with Lt Virgil Hine and Lt Frank W. Seifert performed the first pipeline aerial refueling over San Diego, California.

July 20, 1969 - Fulfilling President Kennedy's statement of national objective, the U.S. landed the first manned space vehicle on the moon at 4:17:41 (EDT. The Lunar Module, named Eagle, carried NASA Commander Neil A. Armstrong and LM pilot Colonel Edwin E. Aldrin, Jr., USAF, to the surface while Lt Colonel Michael Collins, USAF, orbited in the Command and Service Module, named Columbia. At 10:56:20 (EDT Astronaut Armstrong became the first man to step on the moon.

July 26, 1947 - The National Security Act became law. The law provided for the establishment of the third military department, the Air Force, and the National Military Establishment, headed by a civilian Secretary of War, for unified direction of the Services.

August 6, 1945 - The first atomic bomb was dropped on Hiroshima, Japan. The bomb, nicknamed "Little Boy,'' was delivered by the B-29 "Enola Gay," under the command of Colonel Paul W. Tibbets, Jr.

August 29, 2019 - United States Space Command was re-established, becoming the 11th Combatant Command which reemphasized focus on space as a war-fighting domain.

September 1, 1975 - One of the original Tuskegee Airmen, Daniel "Chappie'' James pinned on his fourth star and became commander of North American Aerospace Defense Command (NORAD). General James became the first African-American officer to achieve the rank of four-star general.

September 18, 1947 - The initiation of Executive Order 9877 defined the roles and mission of the Air Force. Although the National Security Act was passed on July 26, its effective date was September 18 when W. Stuart Symington was sworn in as the first Secretary of the Air Force. On September 26, General Carl A. Spaatz was sworn in as the first Air Force Chief of Staff.

September 28, 1924 - Completion of the first around-the world flight in aviation history. Four Douglas biplanes, under the command of Major Frederick L. Martin, left on the 26,350-mile journey on April 6. After 175 days, 363 hours flying time, two planes returned under command of Lieutenant Lowell H. Smith.

October 2, 1942 - The first jet flight by an American aircraft. The plane was the XP-59A built by Bell Aircraft Corporation with two General Electric I-1A turbojets mounted beneath the wings close to the fuselage. During its first flight of 30 minutes, the plane approached 400 mph.

October 14, 1947 - On this date, the Bell X-1 became the first piloted plane to break the speed of sound. It was launched from a B-29. With Captain Charles E. Yeager as pilot, the plane reached a height of approx. 43,000 feet in 2 minutes and 30 seconds of powered flight. Captain Yeager named the plane Glamorous Glennis after his wife.

November 8, 1950 - First all jet aerial combat in history. Lieutenant Russell J. Brown in an F-80 shot down a Russian MiG-15 over North Korea.

December 17, 1903 - The Wright brothers, Orville and Wilbur, made the first sustained, controlled, powered flights from Kill Devil Hill, Kitty Hawk, North Carolina. The fourth and longest flight covered a distance of 852 feet in 59 seconds. Three days earlier, on the 14th they had made the first powered flight lasting 3.5 seconds for a distance of 105 feet.

December 20, 2019 - The 2020 National Defense Authorization Act was signed into law establishing the Space Force as the sixth armed service branch under the Department of the Air Force. On January 14, 2020, General John "Jay" Raymond was sworn in as the first Chief of Space Operations.

United States Air Force Heritage

The Wright Brothers

Drawing upon a systematic study of aeronautical literature, practical experience from their bicycle shop, and supreme confidence, Orville and Wilbur Wright developed the first successful heavier-than-air, powered aircraft. With the assistance of American glider pioneer Octave Chanute, the Wrights made over a thousand glider flights from Kill Devil Hills, near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina from 1900 to 1902, perfecting wing warping, elevators, rudders, and a small four- cylinder engine.

On December 14, 1903, they attempted the first flight of a powered aircraft. Stalling the aircraft upon take off and crashing three seconds later. At 10:35 on December 17, 1903, Orville Wright made the first flight of 120 feet in 12 seconds. Alternating pilot duties, the brothers flew three more flights with Wilbur flying 852 feet and staying aloft 59 seconds on their fourth attempt. By 1905, Wright Flyer No. 3 constituted the first practical airplane with one flight lasting 39 minutes and covering 24 miles.

The Introduction of Military Air Power

On Aug 1, 1907, the U.S. Army established an Aeronautical Division within the Signal Corps. By Dec 1907, the Division established specs for bidding on a military aircraft. The Wright brothers submitted a flyable aircraft, the Wright Type A Military Flyer. In September 1908, the Flyer carried the first military observer, but crashed, resulting in one death and injuries to Orville Wright. Nonetheless, the Army accepted the plane as the first in its inventory in August 1909. In October 1909, Wilbur Wright trained two pilots, who later crashed the plane. Lt Benjamin Foulois became the Signal Corps' chief pilot in March 1910. By October 1912, the Aeronautical Division had 11 aircraft and 14 flying officers. In July 1914, the Aviation Section within the Signal Corps was established with 60 officers and 260 enlisted men. In March 1916, the Army's 1st Aero Squadron joined the Punitive Expedition in Mexico, but all eight aircraft were destroyed by the end of April.

World War I, The First Expeditionary Air Force

Less than eight months after the Punitive Expedition, the US entered WWI. The Signal Corps Aviation Section had officers, enlisted men, and airplanes. Aircraft evolved from observation craft to weapons of war, with observation, artillery spotting, and reconnaissance being their main contributions. Pursuit aircraft sought control of the skies, with French pilot Roland Garros attaching steel plates to his plane's propeller to fire a machine gun. The Germans created the Fokker Eindecker, the first true fighter plane. The "Fokker scourge" threatened Allied forces until they developed their own interrupter gear. The Escadrille Américaine, later renamed Lafayette Escadrille, was established for American volunteers. Pilots such as Raoul Lufbery, Edward Rickenbacker, and Frank Luke gained fame. Colonel William Mitchell became the outstanding air combat commander. Mitchell emphasized mass attacks during the St. Mihiel offensive, which contributed to the Allied victory. The Air Service grew exponentially during the war, with 195,024 personnel and 7,900 aircraft by the end.

Gen Billy Mitchell, the *Ostfriesland* and the Inter-War Air Corps

After World War I, two themes emerged in American air power: Billy Mitchell's push for Air Force independence and a focus on aviation records. Mitchell believed in the potential of air power as a revolutionary weapon and challenged the Navy's battleships by sinking the Ostfriesland and two other ships with bombers. Although he failed to convince the War or Navy Departments, the bombing tests led to the development of carrier-based aviation. Mitchell's frustration led to public statements and a court martial, resulting in a five-year suspension. He resigned to continue fighting for an independent Air Force. The Air Corps Act of 1926 improved aviation's status in the Army, transforming the Air Service into the Air Corps. Throughout the next decade, the Air Corps made advancements in delivering mail, coastal defense, and instrument flying. In 1935, all air combat units were organized into the General Headquarters (GHQ) Air Force.

WWII, The Doolittle Raid

In 1939, the GHQ Air Force began an expansion program that would become the largest air organization in history. President Roosevelt requested $300 million for military aviation. The Air Corps planned for 24 combat-ready groups by 1941, requiring more manpower, training, and equipment. On December 7, 1941, Japan attacked the US Pacific fleet at Pearl Harbor, causing significant damage. President Roosevelt wanted to boost morale with an offensive strike against Japan. Navy Captain Low suggested using Army bombers from a Navy carrier. The B-25 was chosen for its size and capabilities. Modifications were made to the bombers to increase their effectiveness. On April 18, 1942, Lt Col James Doolittle led a successful raid on Tokyo, Kobe, and Nagoya. Although the raid caused minimal damage, it shocked Japanese leaders and boosted American morale. Doolittle received the Medal of Honor and a promotion to Brigadier General.

Air Corps Innovation in the Pacific

George C. Kenney was a pioneering airman whose career spanned both World Wars. After enlisting in the Aviation Section of the U.S. Signal Corps in 1917, he served with the 91st Aero Squadron in France during World War I. During the interwar years, Kenney attended the Air Corps Tactical School and the Army War College, while also contributing to aviation development by refining techniques for mounting machine guns on aircraft wings and experimenting with low-level attack tactics. In 1940, as Assistant Air Attaché in France, he observed German and Allied air operations and recommended improvements to U.S. aircraft and combat tactics. His expertise led to senior assignments at Wright Field and promotion to brigadier general in 1941. In July 1942, General Douglas MacArthur selected Kenney to command Allied Air Forces and the Fifth Air Force in the Southwest Pacific. There, Kenney pioneered innovative tactics such as low-level attacks, skip bombing, parafrag weapons, and the modification of B-25 bombers into heavily armed anti-shipping aircraft. These innovations contributed significantly to the Allied victory in the Battle of the Bismarck Sea in 1943. Later commanding the Far East Air Forces, which included the Fifth, Thirteenth, and Seventh Air Forces, Kenney demonstrated the decisive impact of adaptive airpower on the Pacific War and became one of the most influential air commanders in U.S. military history.

Over Hitler's Europe with "The Mighty Eighth"

The Air Corps Tactical School (ACTS) played a crucial role in the development of air warfare doctrine, focusing on strategic bombardment and the use of heavy bombers. The theory, known as the "industrial web" or HAPDB, emphasized the destruction of enemy vital centers to collapse their economy and will to fight. The B-17 "Flying Fortress" and the Norden bombsight were seen as the perfect combination to fulfill this doctrine. The Eighth Air Force, based in England, became the symbol of the American air war against Germany. Their first operational bombing mission in August 1942 showed promise, even though it faced significant challenges. However, a mission in October 1943 against Schweinfurt resulted in severe losses for the Eighth Air Force, leading to a change in strategy.

The introduction of the P-51 Mustang revolutionized the air war over Europe. Its superior speed, maneuverability, and range allowed it to outperform German fighters. With the support of both the Eighth and Fifteenth Air Forces, Operation ARGUMENT, also known as "Big Week," aimed to achieve air superiority and cripple Germany's aircraft industry. The operation, conducted in February 1944, successfully destroyed a significant number of German fighters and turned the tide in favor of the U.S. Strategic Air Force. By June 1944, allied air forces dominated the skies over Europe during the D-Day invasion. The Luftwaffe was unable to mount a significant defense, with only a handful of sorties and minimal damage inflicted on the invasion beaches.

Overall, the development of air power doctrine, the use of heavy bombers, and the introduction of superior aircraft like the P-51 Mustang played a crucial role in achieving air superiority and contributing to the success of the Allied forces in World War II.

An Emerging Tactical Support Mission

American Airmen, led by Major Elwood "Pete" Quesada, pioneered the concept of close air support even before the Allies invaded Europe. Inspired by the Royal Air Force's efforts, Quesada moved beyond the strategic bombing doctrine taught at the Air Corps Tactical School. During the invasion of Italy, fighter aircraft proved their value in close air support missions, flying over sixty percent of them. The P-47 Thunderbolt, with field modifications made by Airmen on the ground, became the most effective tactical air support platform of the war.

Under Quesada's command, the Ninth Fighter Command enhanced communication between planes and ground troops. Air Support Parties, equipped with radios and colored ground panels, helped minimize friendly-fire incidents. However, the use of B-17s in a tactical role resulted in tragic consequences during Operation COBRA, claiming the life of Lieutenant General Leslie McNair.

Despite this setback, tactical air support continued to evolve and improve throughout the war. Pilots embedded in armored columns communicated with planes to provide cover and support during the Normandy breakout. The Nineteenth Tactical Air Command, led by General Otto P. Weyland, effectively guarded General George Patton's flanks during his rapid advance across Southern France.

By the end of the war, communication and effectiveness in tactical air support had significantly improved. The efforts of Airmen on the ground and in the air played a crucial role in supporting ground troops and ensuring their success against the enemy.

General Benjamin O. Davis, Jr. And The Tuskegee Airmen

The Tuskegee Airmen, led by General Benjamin O. Davis, Jr., played a significant role in changing racial attitudes in the military during World War II. Despite facing institutional racism and segregation, they demonstrated resilience and valor in combat. The creation of a separate flight school for black aviation candidates at the Tuskegee Institute in Alabama paved the way for blacks to be trained for the Army Air Force service.

Under the leadership of Captain Benjamin O. Davis, Jr., the 99th Pursuit Squadron became the first-ever black combat unit in the Air Corps. They trained tirelessly, facing racism and poor command support. In April 1943, the squadron received orders to the Mediterranean Theatre of Operations, where they provided air support to ground troops. Despite being segregated and receiving little training or supplies, they flew numerous missions, including escorting bombers and engaging in combat with Nazi fighters.

Colonel Davis later assumed command of the all-black 332d Fighter Group, rebuilding morale, which included the 99th Fighter Squadron. The 332d Fighter Group, known as the "Red Tails" due to their distinctive aircraft markings, excelled in bomber escort missions. They developed effective tactics, such as the "Top Cover" tactic, to protect bombers from Nazi fighters.

Throughout the war, the Tuskegee Airmen demonstrated exceptional skill and professionalism, earning praise and respect from bomber crews. They shot down enemy aircraft, destroyed ground targets, and saved the lives of countless bomber crews. The Tuskegee Program became a model for the integration of the United States Air Force, with officers and enlisted personnel from diverse backgrounds working together.

After the war, Colonel Davis continued to make significant contributions to the Air Force. He led the 332d Fighter Group to victory in the first USAF Gunnery Meet, and later played a key role in the creation of the Thunderbirds precision flying team.

General Benjamin O. Davis, Jr.'s achievements as a leader, officer, and aviator are a testament to his strength and determination to serve his nation in the United States Air Force. His leadership, along with the bravery and skill of the Tuskegee Airmen, paved the way for racial integration in the military and inspired future generations.

The WASPs

The formation of the Women Airforce Service Pilots (WASPs) in 1943 marked a significant milestone in the increased opportunities for women in the Air Corps during World War II. The WASPs were formed by combining the Women's Auxiliary Ferrying Squadron (WAFS) and the Women's Flying Training Detachment (WFTD).

Jacqueline "Jackie" Cochran, a renowned aviator and businesswoman, played a crucial

role in advocating for women pilots in the war effort. Cochran, who had already achieved numerous aviation records and accolades, convinced Eleanor Roosevelt to support the idea of employing women pilots. Cochran herself became the first female pilot to fly a bomber across the Atlantic.

Becoming a WASP was highly competitive, and applicants had to possess a pilot's license. Out of the 25,000 women who applied, only 1,830 were accepted, and just 1,074 successfully completed the training. Once accepted, the women learned to fly military aircraft.

Between 1942 and 1944, the WASPs delivered over 12,650 aircraft of various types, making up more than half of the ferrying of combat aircraft within the United States during the war. Their contributions were vital to the war effort, but for many years, the WASPs were not considered military personnel.

It was not until 1977, after years of lobbying, that the WASPs were granted full military status for their service by President Jimmy Carter. In 1984, each WASP received the World War II Victory Medal in recognition of their contributions.

The establishment of the WASPs paved the way for greater opportunities for women in the United States Air Force. In 1969, Air Force ROTC opened to women, and in 1971, Jeanne M. Holm became the first woman in the Air Force to be promoted to brigadier general. Additionally, women were admitted for the first time to all U.S. service academies.

The Air War in China

After the Japanese bombed Pearl Harbor, American volunteers in the Pacific sided with the Chinese in a war against Japan. The American Volunteer Group, also known as the "Flying Tigers," began attacking the Japanese with innovative tactics and destroyed 296 enemy aircraft. The AVG inspired American fliers and provided valuable combat experience and tactics. The group was disbanded in 1942, and Colonel Claire Lee Chennault was promoted to brigadier general and tasked with defending the aerial supply route between India and China. The Fourteenth Air Force and Tenth Air Force conducted operations in support of Chinese forces and achieved air superiority over China by the end of the war. They also destroyed significant resources and infrastructure belonging to the Japanese ground forces in the China-Burma-India theater.

Dropping the Atomic Bomb

The U.S. Army Air Forces, the predecessor to today's U.S. Air Force, played a central role in the final stages of World War II through the delivery of the atomic bombs on Japan. On August 6, 1945, a B-29 Superfortress bomber named Enola Gay dropped the first atomic bomb on Hiroshima, followed by a second B-29, Bockscar, which dropped another atomic bomb on Nagasaki on August 9, 1945. These missions were conducted by specially trained aircrews of the 509th Composite Group and remain among the most significant and controversial operations in military history. The bombings, combined with other wartime factors, contributed to Japan's decision to surrender, leading to the end of World War II on September 2, 1945.

Creating the United States Air Force

After World War II, the United States went through a transition from a wartime to a peacetime military. The air forces significantly reduced in size, with a decrease in aircraft and personnel. The USAAF was reorganized into three commands: the Strategic Air Command (SAC), which focused on delivering air power to distant lands; the continental Air Defense Command (ADC), which defended the U.S. homeland; and the Tactical Air Command (TAC), which initially had no planes or operational units. In 1947, President Truman signed the National Security Act, which established a separate Department of the Air Force. W. Stuart Symington became the first Secretary of the Air Force, and the United States Air Force became an independent branch of the military under the leadership of General Carl A. Spaatz.

The Berlin Airlift

The Berlin Airlift was a response to the Soviet blockade of West Berlin in 1948. The United States organized an airlift operation to provide food, medicine, and coal to the residents of West Berlin. The operation involved American and British aircraft flying supplies into the city. The airlift lasted for fifteen months and was successful in delivering over 2 million tons of supplies. It demonstrated the strategic capabilities of American airlift and its ability to influence conflicts without resorting to violence. The Soviets eventually lifted the blockade in 1949.

Space and the Planes

The X-planes were experimental aircraft and rockets used by the United States to test new technologies and aerodynamic concepts after World War II. They made significant advancements in aviation, including breaking the sound barrier and demonstrating supersonic travel. The X-5, X-18, X-19, and X-22 explored features like variable geometry wings and vertical take-off and landing, which are now used in aircraft like the F-111 Aardvark and V-22 Osprey. The X-22, X-23, and X-24 tested technologies that contributed to the development of the Space Shuttle. The X-15 program produced eight pilots who qualified as astronauts, with Major Robert M. White being the first to reach an altitude of fifty miles and fly at six times the speed of sound. The X-planes also produced astronauts who were not part of NASA's Mercury, Gemini, and Apollo programs. While some technologies from the X-planes were successfully integrated, others, like the nuclear-powered X-6 bomber, never flew.

The Strategic Air Command and The Cold War

The Strategic Air Command (SAC) was created in 1946 to manage the United States' nuclear weapons and delivery systems. It was established after the 1946 Berlin Crisis and the Soviet Union's atomic bomb test in 1949 highlighted the need for better war readiness. Under the leadership of General Curtis E. LeMay, SAC focused on rigorous training, high performance standards, and immediate readiness. They incorporated more powerful bombers like the B-50 and the Convair B-36 Peacemaker, which had intercontinental range. In the 1950s, they upgraded to all-jet bombers like the B-47 Stratojet, B-58 Hustler, and the iconic B-52 Stratofortress. SAC also conducted secret electronic reconnaissance and occasional covert overflights of Soviet territory to assess air defenses. They remained on continuous alert with nuclear-armed bombers ready for immediate action. SAC's capabilities expanded with the development of intermediate range missiles, intercontinental

ballistic missiles, and cruise missiles. They also had advanced surveillance and reconnaissance aircraft like the U-2, SR-71, and early unmanned aerial vehicles. While SAC is best known for its role in preparing for and deterring nuclear war, it also achieved significant results in conventional combat.

The Korean War

During the initial phase of the Korean War, American Airmen faced challenges due to their lack of preparedness and outdated equipment. The limited range of F-80 jets hindered their ability to provide close air support and interdiction. However, FEAF Bomber Command B- 29s conducted strategic operations to weaken the enemy's fighting capabilities.

Although United Nations air forces achieved air superiority and destroyed North Korea's industrial base, they faced technological, political, and operational limitations that prevented a decisive victory. The entry of half a million Chinese troops and the appearance of advanced Soviet-made MiG-15 fighters changed the nature of the war.

The F-86 Sabre, a beloved and classic fighter, was rushed into action to counter the MiG-15. The F-86 proved to be equal in speed and a more stable gun platform than the MiG-15. In the battles over "MiG Alley," USAF pilots with superior training and experience achieved an alleged 10:1 kill ratio, with F-86 pilots destroying 792 MiGs and 18 other enemy aircraft.

Although the F-86 pilots did not match the kill counts of World War II aces, they established themselves as a new group of fighter aces. Captain Joseph C. McConnell and Captain James Jabara were among the top scorers, with 16 and 15 kills respectively. These pilots devised new tactics based on small flights of four F-86s, deviating from the mass squadron formations of World War II.

Despite the stalemate on the ground, Air Force pilots continued their successful heritage in air-to-air combat during the Korean War.

The Space Race

The launch of Sputnik I by the Soviets in 1957 showed their potential to launch nuclear-armed missiles at the United States. In response, President Eisenhower approved the Corona program, a joint effort by the Air Force and CIA to develop reconnaissance satellites. The program faced challenges in getting the satellite over the Soviet Union, taking useful pictures, and transmitting them back to the US. It took two years and twelve failed attempts before Corona successfully launched a satellite in 1960. This marked the first US military operations in space. Many early astronauts, such as Cooper, Grissom, and Slayton, were former military pilots who made significant contributions to space exploration. Borman and Anders were part of Apollo 8, the first mission to orbit the moon, and Aldrin became the second person to walk on the moon during Apollo 11.

The Vietnam Conflict

The United States Air Force played a crucial role in the Vietnam War, with its operations

spanning from the early stages of the conflict to its eventual conclusion. Operation FARMGATE, initiated in 1961, saw American pilots training the South Vietnamese Air Force, providing them with the necessary skills and support to combat growing Communist influence in the region. However, it was the Gulf of Tonkin incident in 1964 that triggered a significant escalation of American involvement.

In response to the alleged attacks on the USS Maddox and USS Turner Joy by North Vietnamese torpedo boats, President Lyndon B. Johnson authorized Operation BARREL ROLL and Operation ROLLING THUNDER. These operations aimed to target Communist forces in Laos and North Vietnam, respectively, and demonstrate American resolve to support South Vietnam. However, the United States underestimated the resilience and determination of the enemy.

Operation ROLLING THUNDER went down in history as one of the most ineffective air campaigns conducted by the USAF. It disregarded established air doctrine, had questionable targeting strategies, and suffered from high losses. The stringent rules of engagement imposed on American pilots negated the speed, surprise, and flexibility that massed air power could provide. Furthermore, periodic "bombing pauses" intended to signal diplomatic intentions allowed the enemy to recover and regroup.

Recognizing the deteriorating political and military situation in South Vietnam, President Richard Nixon took office in 1969 and implemented a new strategy known as "Vietnamization." This policy aimed to gradually shift the burden of combat onto the South Vietnamese forces while reducing US troop presence. Nixon began a phased withdrawal of American troops, which saw their numbers dwindle from a peak of 536,000 in 1968 to less than 100,000 by 1972. However, the North Vietnamese launched the Easter Offensive in 1972, prompting Nixon to respond with Operation LINEBACKER. In contrast to the ineffective ROLLING THUNDER, Operation LINEBACKER saw Nixon significantly reduce the restrictions on war fighting. The introduction of new television-and laser-guided "smart" bombs greatly improved strike accuracy, enabling American aircraft to target previously elusive enemy positions. Notably, on May 13, 1972, sixteen F-4 Phantoms successfully destroyed the Than Hoa Bridge using these advanced munitions. Operation LINEBACKER also produced the first aces of the war, with Captain Steve Ritchie, Captain Charles DeBellevue, and Captain Jeffrey S. Feinstein achieving notable kills.

Despite the tactical successes of Operation LINEBACKER, the Vietnam War would ultimately end in a disappointing manner for the United States. In December 1972, North Vietnamese intransigence over the final peace agreement prompted President Nixon to authorize Operation LINEBACKER II, an intense 11-day air campaign aimed at pressuring enemy compliance. B-52 bombers conducted strikes near Hanoi for the first time, dropping thousands of tons of bombs. Though the campaign broke the impasse and led to the resumption of peace talks, it was not enough to prevent the ultimate fall of South Vietnam.

In April 1975, North Vietnamese forces overran Saigon, marking the end of the Vietnam War and the reunification of Vietnam under Communist rule. The extensive efforts made by the US Air Force, which included over five million sorties, eight million tons of bombs dropped, and the loss of 1,459 aircraft, could not prevent the

ultimate outcome. The war highlighted the versatility and wide- ranging impact of air power, but it also demonstrated its limitations in achieving decisive victory on its own.

The Hollow Force and the Resurgence of Airpower

Exhaustion from over a decade of fighting in Vietnam and the growing budgetary problems resulting from oil prices in the mid-1970s resulted in dramatic defense cuts. The draft ended in 1973, with the All-Volunteer Force becoming the sole basis for recruiting.

Recruit quality in the early years was low, in part due to the low public support of the military during the later years of the Vietnam conflict and in part due to gaps in pay and benefits. The pay gap between military and civilian employment grew, peaking at 7.5% in 1979. Budgetary and recruiting strife notwithstanding, the USAF continued fielding new weapons systems. The challenge of sustaining new, technologically advanced aircraft like the F-15, F-16 and A-10 was difficult. Overall mission capable rates dropped to 68% due to a mix of shortages of spare parts and the lack of quality recruits to replace Airmen separating. With the "Reagan Revolution" and ensuing economic recovery, a growing defense budget allowed the USAF to focus on improving sustainment of aircraft and Airmen.

New leadership in the USAF promoted cultures of quality and process improvement. As commander of Tactical Air Command (the predecessor of Air Combat Command) from 1978 to 1984, General Wilbur "Bill" Creech was the pioneer in this effort. Creech instituted policies based on W. Edwards Deming's philosophy of Total Quality Management into the command's daily practices, creating a culture of continuous examination and process improvement throughout the USAF that persists to this day in the Continuous Improvement and Innovation program. General Creech also led a transformation of the application of tactical airpower. He led the expansion of Red Flag into a total force concept, introducing night operations, command and control and combat air support activities. The complexity of the exercises expanded from 55 aircraft in 1978 to over 250 in 1984. This reemphasis on the science of tactics, training and multiple components of airpower would bear fruit a few short years later over the sands of Kuwait and Iraq.

Operation Desert Shield/Desert Storm

In August 1990, Iraqi dictator Saddam Hussein ordered an invasion of Kuwait, leading to international condemnation and an economic embargo authorized by the United Nations. In response, President George H.W. Bush initiated Operation DESERT SHIELD, deploying U.S. air and ground units to defend Saudi Arabia and the Persian Gulf states. This marked the largest air deployment in history, surpassing the Berlin Airlift.

From August to November 1990, Military Airlift Command (MAC) cargo planes delivered defensive forces, and from November 1990 to January 1991, they brought materials for a counteroffensive. The air bridge covered 7,000 miles and involved 20,500 strategic airlift missions. The operation validated the effectiveness of large-capacity, heavy carriers like the Lockheed C-5A Galaxy and the Lockheed C-141A Starlifter.

For the air campaign against Iraq, a planning group known as "Checkmate" developed the plan called INSTANT THUNDER. This four-phase campaign aimed to destroy Iraqi centers of gravity by targeting strategic centers, air defense networks, and ground combat forces. Coalition air forces had to neutralize Iraq's integrated air defense network, which included a large number of combat aircraft, SAMs, and AAA guns.

On January 17, 1991, Operation DESERT STORM began with strikes led by Air Force Special Operations MH-53J PAVE LOW helicopters and Army Apaches. The world witnessed the extensive AAA fire in Iraqi skies, but the stealth capabilities of Lockheed F-117A Nighthawks allowed them to strike heavily defended targets with precision. Under the command of Lt Gen Chuck Horner, 2,700 aircraft executed the master attack plan.

During the first week of DESERT STORM, the USAF achieved air supremacy, destroyed the enemy's command and control system, and shot down numerous Iraqi aircraft. The air campaign also involved A-10 Thunderbolt IIs and F-111s targeting armored forces, as well as EF-111A electronic warfare aircraft and intelligence aircraft providing vital support.

The DESERT STORM air campaign showcased the dominance of air power on a modern battlefield. Over 44 days, the coalition flew 118,661 sorties, with the U.S. Air Force conducting 60% of them. Precision-guided munitions (PGMs) played a significant role, achieving 80% of known targets destroyed despite accounting for only 8% of the bombs dropped.

The effectiveness of the air campaign was not just measured by the destruction of enemy assets but also by its impact on the organizational structure, cohesion of enemy forces, and the psychology of the Iraqi soldier.

The Air Force and Global Positioning

In response to the launch of the Soviet spacecraft Sputnik in 1957, the Air Force began developing a global positioning system (GPS) using satellites. The Navy initially tested satellite systems in the 1960s, but the Air Force had the resources to continue the research. They launched the first NAVSTAR GPS satellite in 1978 and added ten more by 1985. After the Soviet Union shot down Korean Airlines Flight 007 in 1983, the Reagan Administration made GPS technology available to the private sector. The Challenger disaster delayed GPS upgrades until 1989, when operational satellites began deployment. By 1993, the modern GPS constellation was complete with 24 satellites. The system achieved initial operational capability in 1993 and was declared fully operational in 1995 by the Air Force.

In the 1990s, the breakup of Yugoslavia presented a significant challenge for NATO. The region faced a long history of conflict, political complexities, and ethnic tensions. As the possibility of a genocidal civil war and destabilization loomed, NATO turned to air power to address the humanitarian crisis and influence events.

In 1999, President Bill Clinton initiated Operation Allied Force, with the primary objectives of demonstrating NATO's opposition to aggression, deterring President Milosevic from further attacks on civilians, and damaging Serbia's war capabilities. Led by Lt Gen General Michael C. Short, NATO air forces conducted over 38,000 sorties from March 24 to June 9, 1999. The campaign aimed to pressure Milosevic, target Serbian forces engaged in Kosovo, and minimize collateral damage and civilian casualties. The air campaign involved 214 strike aircraft in a phased approach against around 50 targets. The Northrop Grumman B-2 Spirit, making its combat debut, delivered 650 Joint Direct Attack Munitions (JDAMs) in 49 sorties. The scale of the operation grew to involve 563 USAF aircraft and 13,850 American Airmen deployed to 24 locations, resembling a major theater war.

By June 1999, NATO air power achieved its political and military objectives, putting an end to Serbian atrocities, stabilizing Kosovo, and undermining the Milosevic regime. However, there were challenges along the way, including political constraints, adverse weather conditions, and a refugee crisis manufactured by Serbia. Despite efforts to avoid civilian casualties, at least twenty major incidents occurred, including the accidental bombing of the Chinese Embassy.

Overall, the air campaign against Serbia reinforced the effectiveness of air and space power, despite limitations. It highlighted the precision, effectiveness, and speed of these forces. A limited air campaign was seen as the only viable option against an implacable foe. However, the experience also emphasized the costs, risks, and frustrations of gradual air campaigns. It underscored the importance of agreement between air and ground commanders on the enemy's centers of gravity and the need to avoid micromanagement for optimal military effectiveness.

Operation Enduring Freedom and Operation Iraqi Freedom

After the terrorist attacks on September 11, 2001, the U.S. Air Force played a significant role in the global war on terrorism. Operation ENDURING FREEDOM focused on Afghanistan and involved a coalition of forces, including the Air Force, to combat the Taliban government and Al Qaeda.

Air Force bombers and carrier-strike aircraft conducted military operations, Targeting Taliban air defenses and command centers. They also provided air support to the Afghan Northern Alliance. Kabul, the capital of Afghanistan, fell to coalition forces in November 2001.

Following the success in Afghanistan, President George W. Bush ordered an invasion of Iraq to remove Saddam Hussein from power. Operation IRAQI FREEDOM began in 2003, with the Air Force having gained air superiority over Iraq through previous operations. Coalition air forces conducted a strategic air campaign, targeting enemy command and control systems. Ground forces encountered resistance but were supported by superior training, tactics, and technology, as well as air power. The

success of these operations relied on long- term political and economic reconstruction efforts, rather than solely on airpower.

The Air Force also contributed to nation-building activities in Iraq and Afghanistan. This included providing humanitarian aid, civil affairs support, and training Iraqi and Afghan security forces. Joint Air Force-Army Provincial Reconstruction Teams worked on various projects in Afghanistan. The Air Force Academy also played a role in building air forces for Iraq and Afghanistan, with faculty members assisting in training programs and educational initiatives.

Evolution of New Warfighting Domains and Technology

The U.S. Air Force has embraced new technologies such as unmanned vehicles and advancements in the cyber and space domains. The use of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) began in 1959 and increased during the Vietnam War. Remotely piloted aircraft took on offensive roles during the Global War on Terror. The Air Force Academy started training cadets in UAV operations in 2010. The Air Force also recognizes the importance of cyberspace and has developed a new cyber strategy to defend against cyberattacks. The Department of War (DoW) has the largest network in the world and must take aggressive steps to secure its data and mitigate risks. In 1982, the Air Force established Air Force Space Command (AFSPC) to focus on space operations. AFSPC expanded its mission to include cyberspace and activated the 24th Air Force for cyberspace operations. The 24th Air Force evolved from a traditional numbered air force into the Air Force's primary cyber warfare organization. Established in 2009, it became Air Forces Cyber (AFCYBER) in 2010 and ultimately merged with the 25th Air Force in 2019 to create the modern 16th Air Force, which now leads the Air Force's information warfare mission.

Operation Inherent Resolve

On October 17, 2014, the Department of War established Combined Joint Task Force Operation INHERENT RESOLVE to coordinate military actions against the threat of the Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant (ISIL) in Iraq and Syria. This operation involves thirty nations working together to counter the long-term threat posed by ISIL. The mission of CJTF-OIR is threefold: to destroy ISIL military forces, to train and equip regional allies to combat ISIL, and to maximize the effectiveness of coalition contributions to the fight. The United States Air Force has played a critical role in Operation INHERENT RESOLVE through precision strike missions, intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance operations, airlift, aerial refueling, and close air support. Since the operation began in 2014, Coalition airpower has enabled the destruction of ISIS's territorial caliphate and continues to support Iraqi and Syrian partner forces in preventing the group's resurgence. Today, the mission focuses on advising and assisting local security forces while conducting targeted operations against remaining ISIS networks in Iraq and Syria. Coalition aircraft conducted more than 34,000 strikes against ISIS targets between 2014 and the defeat of the territorial caliphate.

Creation of the United States Space Force

The creation of the United States Space Force was rooted in decades of Air Force space operations under Air Force Space Command (AFSPC), which was established in 1982 to manage military space missions such as satellite operations, missile warning, space surveillance, and GPS. Operation DESERT STORM in 1991 demonstrated the vital importance of space capabilities, leading many to call it the first "space war" because of its reliance on GPS, satellite communications, weather data, and missile warning systems. As space became increasingly contested by potential adversaries, military leaders recognized the need for a dedicated service focused solely on protecting U.S. interests in space. On 20 December 2019, the United States Space Force (USSF) was established as the nation's sixth military branch within the Department of the Air Force. The Space Force organizes, trains, and equips forces to conduct military space operations and protect U.S. and allied space capabilities. Today, the USSF provides critical services including GPS, satellite communications, missile warning, and space domain awareness that enable military operations around the globe.

After the 9/11 attacks, AFSPC provided extensive space-based support to the U.S. Central Command in areas such as communications, positioning, navigation and timing, meteorology, and warning. In 2005, the Air Force expanded AFSPC's mission to include cyberspace operations. The responsibility for conducting cyberspace operations was assigned to AFSPC through the activation of Twenty-Fourth Air Force in 2009.

In 2018, the Air Force transferred the cyber mission to Air Combat Command, allowing AFSPC to focus on gaining and maintaining space superiority and staying ahead of adversaries in the space domain.

Chapter 4

Military Strategy

National Security Strategy 82
National Defense Strategy 82
The National Military Strategy 82
Air Force Operational Imperatives 83
Air Force Domains 84
Air Force Core Missions 85
Air Force Core Tenets 85
Military Spacepower Core Competencies in the Space Force 86
Spacepower Disciplines of the Space Force 86
Principles of War 87
Combatant Commands 88
Joint Mindset 89
Department of the Air Force 89
Department of the Army 90
Department of the Navy 90
Air and Space Force Major Commands 91
Air Force Forces (AFFOR) Staff & an A-Staff 93
Agile Combat Employment 95
Joint Planning Process 97

National Security Strategy

The national security strategy (NSS) is a document that outlines the United States' overarching approach to protecting its national interests and ensuring its security. The NSS provides a strategic framework for addressing emerging threats, promoting economic prosperity, and advancing American values. The strategy encompasses a wide range of issues, including defense, diplomacy, intelligence, economics, and homeland security, all underpinned with allied efforts when feasible. It guides the government's efforts in formulating policies, allocating resources, and coordinating actions to safeguard the nation's security and promote its global leadership.

National Defense Strategy

The national defense strategy is a document that outlines the United States' approach to national security and defense for civilian and military resources. It provides a strategic framework for the Department of War (DoW) to prioritize its resources, capabilities, and actions to protect the nation's interests. The strategy focuses on addressing emerging threats, such as great power competition, terrorism, cyber-attacks, and other challenges to national security. It emphasizes the need for military readiness, innovation, and technological superiority to maintain a credible deterrent and protect American interests at home and abroad. The national defense strategy also emphasizes the importance of alliances and partnerships to strengthen collective security and promote stability. It guides the DoD's efforts in shaping the force structure, developing capabilities, and conducting military operations to ensure the security and prosperity of the United States.

The National Military Strategy

The United States' national military strategy is a comprehensive plan that outlines how the country's armed forces will be employed to protect and advance its national security interests. It is a key component of the broader national security strategy and provides guidance for the military's role in addressing global challenges. The national military strategy takes into account the evolving threat landscape, geopolitical considerations, and the capabilities of the U.S. military. It outlines strategic objectives, operational concepts, and resource requirements necessary to deter aggression, defend the homeland, and support international security alliances. The strategy also emphasizes the importance of innovation, technological superiority, and interoperability with partner nations to maintain a credible and effective military force.

Air Force Operational Imperatives

(https://www.af.mil/Portals/1/documents/2023SAF/OPERATIONAL_IMPARITIVES_INFOGRAPHIC.pdf)

Secretary of the Air Force, Frank Kendall, released the Operational Imperatives in December 2022. The Air Force operational imperatives are a set of guiding principles that shape the mission and operations of the United States Air Force. These seven imperatives provide a framework for decision-making, strategic planning, and the execution of airpower in support of national security objectives.

1. Space Order of Battle
The first operational imperative is to define a resilient and effective space order of battle. More simply stated, this means ensuring resilient space-based capabilities. Both the cyber and physical security of American satellites and sensors must be maintained to ensure operational capability in a future conflict.

2. Operationally Focused Advanced Battle Management System (ABMS)
The ABMS is the Air Force's contribution to the DoD's Joint All-Domain Command & Control (JADC2) effort the DoD's larger concept to connect sensors from all of the military services into a single network. The USAF collects, analyzes, and shares the information needed to make operational decisions at the speed of mission. By incorporating the latest advancements in artificial intelligence, ABMS will revolutionize the speed of battlefield decision-making.

3. Moving Target Engagement
The USAF must achieve moving target engagement at scale of a challenging operational environment. Linked to ABMS, this process is especially critical for targets that employ the latest technology designed to evade detection, such as drones, hypersonic weapons or stealth capabilities. This new dimension of warfare necessitates more advanced targeting systems while sensors must be survivable and protected against electromagnetic and cyber attack.

4. Tactical Air Dominance
The next generation of air dominance (NGAD) system of systems will be defined by more than the development of 6th-generation fighters, this operational imperative requires the Air Force to integrate crewed aircraft with autonomous aircraft. With NGAD, future crewed aircraft can be accompanied by autonomous wingmen in battle, preserving the lives of pilots without limiting air superiority.

5. Resilient Basing
Threats to USAF operations at forward bases can deny U.S. power projection, this imperative is to develop resilient bases and communications. Antiquated method of relying on large, fixed bases, will transition to a "hub-and-spoke" arrangement that incorporates smaller, dispersed, and more mobile bases. This concept is also referred to as Agile Combat Employment (ACE). Smaller mobile bases may complicate logistics but will increase survivability in a combat environment, especially for

combat in the Indo-Pacific region.

6. Global Strike Capabilities
The USAF is defining the B-21 long-range strike family-of-systems. The B-21 Raider will serve as the backbone of America's bomber force as a highly adaptable, dual-capable penetrating strike stealth bomber capable of delivering both conventional and nuclear munitions. This multi-functional stealth bomber is designed to handle anything from gathering intelligence, to battle management, to integrating with allies and partners. This operational imperative includes the use of autonomous combat aircraft and other long-range strike aircraft alongside the B-21.

7. Readiness to Deploy and Fight
Achieving readiness for a wartime posture against a peer competitor is imperative. Moving forces into theater, and then supporting them takes the collective success of a large number of information systems and supporting logistical and industrial infrastructure. Ensuring the readiness will require effort from the entire USAF and USSF but is instrumental in deterrence.

Air Force Domains

AFH1

Air

Airpower's exceptional speed and range allow its forces to visit and revisit wide ranges of targets nearly at will. Airpower does not have to occupy terrain or remain constantly in proximity to areas of operation to bring force upon targets.

Space

Global Vigilance, Global Reach, Global Power for America

As the Nation's space force, the United States Space Force provides critical capabilities that enhance the military's ability to navigate accurately, see clearly, communicate securely, and strike precisely. Joint, interagency, and coalition forces depend on Space Force operations to perform their missions every day, on every continent, in the air, on the land, and at sea. In a dangerous and uncertain future, the ability to access and exploit space, even when others try to deny us, will be vital to our Nation's security.

Cyberspace

Cyber operations guarantee our capability to operate in any contested cyber domain to support vital land, sea, air, and space missions by developing capabilities to protect essential military cyber systems and to speed their recovery if an attack does occur. In these interdependent domains the Air Force possesses unique capabilities for ensuring global mobility, long-range strike, and intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance.

"The basic planning, development, organization and training of the Air Force mut all be well rounded, covering every modern means of waging war… The Air Force doctrine likewise must be flexible at all times and entirely uninhibited by tradition."
- General of the Air Force Henry H. "Hap" Arnold

Air Force Core Missions

Global Vigilance, Global Reach, Global Power for America

Airmen bring to the Nation's military portfolio five interdependent and integrated core missions that have endured since President Truman originally assigned airpower roles and missions to the Air Force in 1947. Although the way we do them will constantly evolve, the Air Force will continue to perform these missions so that our military can respond quickly and appropriately to unpredictable threats and challenges. Today, we call our core missions:

- Air superiority
- Intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR)
- Rapid global mobility
- Global strike
- Command and control

Air Force Core Tenets

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The application of airpower is refined by several fundamental guiding truths. These truths are known as tenets. They reflect not only the unique historical and doctrinal evolution of airpower, but also the current appreciation for the nature of airpower. The tenets of airpower complement the principles of joint operations. While the principles of war provide general guidance on the application of military forces, the tenets provide more specific considerations for the employment of airpower. The tenets of airpower are:

- Mission Command [Centralized Control & Decentralized Execution].
- Flexibility and Versatility.
- Synergistic Effects.
- Persistence.
- Concentration.
- Priority and Balance Tenets of Airpower

Military Spacepower Core Competencies in the Space Force

Space Capstone Publication – Spacepower

Space Superiority establishes and promotes stable conditions for the safe and secure access to space activities for civil, commercial, intelligence community, and multinational partners.

Combat Power Projection integrates defensive and offensive operations to maintain a desired level of freedom of action relative to an adversary. Combat Power Projection in concert with other competencies enhances freedom of action by deterring aggression or compelling an adversary to change behavior.

Space Mobility and Logistics (SML) enables movement and support of military equipment and personnel in the space domain, from the space domain back to Earth, and to the space domain.

Information Mobility provides timely, rapid and reliable collection and transportation of data across the range of military operations in support of tactical, operational, and strategic decision making.

Space Domain Awareness (SDA) encompasses the effective identification, characterization and understanding of any factor associated with the space domain that could affect space operations and thereby impact the security, safety, economy, or environment of our Nation.

Spacepower Disciplines of the Space Force

Space Capstone Publication – Spacepower

Orbital Warfare – Knowledge of orbital maneuver as well as offensive and defensive fires to preserve freedom of access to the domain. Skill to ensure United States and coalition space forces can continue to provide capability to the joint Force while denying that same advantage to the adversary.

Space Electromagnetic Warfare – Knowledge of spectrum awareness, maneuver within the spectrum, and non-kinetic fires within the spectrum to deny adversary use of vital links. Skill to manipulate physical access to communication pathways and awareness of how those pathways contribute to enemy advantage. Skill to manipulate physical access to communication pathways and awareness of how those pathways contribute to enemy advantage.

Space Battle Management – Knowledge of how to orient to the space domain and skill in making decisions to preserve mission, deny adversary access, and ultimately ensure mission accomplishment. Ability to identify hostile actions and entities, conduct combat identification, target, and direct action in response to an evolving threat environment.

Space Access and Sustainment – Knowledge of processes, support, and logistics required to maintain and prolong operations in the space domain. Ability to resource, apply, and leverage spacepower in, from, and to the space domain.

Military Intelligence – Knowledge to conduct intelligence-led, threat-focused operations based on the insights. Ability to leverage the broader Intelligence Community to ensure military spacepower has the ISR capabilities needed to defend the space domain.

Engineering and Acquisition – Knowledge that ensures military spacepower has the best capabilities in the world to defend the space domain. Ability to form science, technology, and acquisition partnerships with other national security space organizations, commercial entities, Allies, and academia to ensure the warfighters are properly equipped.

Cyber Operations – Knowledge to defend the global networks upon which military spacepower is vitally dependent. Ability to employ cyber security and cyber defense of critical space networks and systems. Skill to employ future offensive capabilities.

Principles of War

AFH1

The principles of war are fundamental aspects that tend to lead to military victory. These principles are universally true and relevant throughout the history of conflict. It is important for members of the Air Force to understand how these principles apply to all forces, but particularly to the Air Force. While the complexity and unique nature of each war prevent commanders from using these principles as a checklist for guaranteed victory, they serve as valuable tools to evaluate potential courses of action.

The principles of war are interconnected and should be considered together. They are not exhaustive, but rather provide a framework for developing strategies and doctrines for the Air Force. Airmen must be able to view these principles from a three-dimensional perspective and integrate them accordingly. When combined with the tenets of AirPower, the principles of war provide a solid foundation for the air, space, and cyber forces of the joint force in America.

Unity of Command – concentration of effort for every objective responsible commander.

Objective – direct military operations toward a defined and attainable objective that contributes to strategic, operational, and tactical aims.

Mass – concentrate the effects of combat power at the most advantageous place and time to achieve decisive results.

Maneuver – place the enemy in a position of disadvantage through the flexible application of combat power.

Surprise – attacking the enemy at a time, place, or in a manner for which they are not prepared.

Simplicity – avoid unnecessary complexity in organizing, preparing, planning, and conducting military operations.

Economy of Force – judicious employment and distribution of forces

Security – never permit the enemy to acquire unexpected advantage.

Offensive – seize, retain, and exploit the initiative.

Combatant Commands

https://www.defense.gov/Know-Your-Military/Combatant-Commands/

Geographic Combatant Commands – operate in clearly delineated areas of operation and have a distinctive regional military focus.

USAFRICOM: U.S. Africa Command, Kelley Barracks, Stuttgart, Germany
USCENTCOM: U.S. Central Command, MacDill Air Force Base, FL
USEUCOM: U.S. European Command, Patch Barracks, Stuttgart, Germany
USNORTHCOM: U.S. Northern Command, Peterson Space Force Base, CO
USPACOM: U.S. Indo-Pacific Command, Camp H.M. Smith, HI
USSOUTHCOM: U.S. Southern Command, Miami, FL
USSPACECOM: U.S. Space Command, Peterson Space Force Base, CO

Functional Combatant Commands – operate world-wide across geographic boundaries and provide unique capabilities to geographic combatant commands and the Services.

USCYBERCOM: U.S. Cyber Command, Fort George G. Meade, MD
USSOCOM: U.S. Special Operations Command, MacDill Air Force Base, FL
USSTRATCOM: U.S. Strategic Command, Offutt Air Force Base, NE
USTRANSCOM: U.S. Transportation Command, Scott Air Force Base, IL



Joint Mindset

Given [the challenges] we will be facing for the next several years it is essential we strengthen the development of Airmen and Guardians who are not only steeped in the business of Airpower, but also knowledgeable in how to optimize every component as part of a Joint Task Force (JTF). Airmen and Guardians, leveraging the same leadership used to blend joint and coalition partners into a synergized air campaign, must be ready to lead and work in JTF HQs designed to synergize all components.

Department of the Air Force

AFDD-1



The Air Force employs air, space, and cyberspace capabilities with a broader focus on theater-wide and national-level objectives. Through airpower, the Air Force provides the versatile, wide-ranging means towards achieving national objectives with the ability to deter and respond immediately to crises anywhere in the world. It includes all elements and units of the United States Air Force (USAF) and the United States Space Force (USSF). The USSF was established December 20, 2019, and is the space operations service branch.

U.S. Air Force Mission

The mission of the United States Air Force is to fly, fight and win - airpower anytime, anywhere.

U.S. Space Force Mission

Secure our Nation's interest in, from and to space.

Department of the Army

ADP-1

U.S. forces operate in the air, land, maritime, space, and cyberspace domains. The land domain is the most complex of the domains, because it addresses humanity — its cultures, ethnicities, religions, and politics. War begins and ends based upon how it affects the land domain. Air, maritime, space, and cybernetic power affect the land domain indirectly; landpower is usually the arbiter of victory. The Army provides the United States with the landpower to prevent, shape, and win in the land domain. U.S. law, Department of War directives, and the nature of landpower mold the Army's mission.

U.S. Army Mission

The Mission of the United States army is to fight and win our Nation's wars, by providing prompt, sustained, land dominance, across the full range of military operations and the spectrum of conflict, in support of combatant commanders.

Department of the Navy

NDP-1

The job of gaining and maintaining maritime superiority or supremacy of engaging in and winning battles in the maritime domain and preventing conflict through presence offshore falls almost exclusively to the Naval Service. The Naval Service comprises the Active and Reserve components and the civilian personnel of the United States Navy, the United States Marine Corps, and the United States Coast Guard. *Note: The United States Coast Guard falls under the Department of Homeland Security as a peacetime law enforcement agency.*

U.S. Navy Mission

The mission of the Navy is to maintain, train and equip combat-ready Naval forces capable of winning wars, deterring aggression and maintaining freedom of the seas.

Marine Corp Vision

The Marine Corps plays an integral role in the National Defense Strategy. Its training, capabilities and global presence ensure that the Navy-Marine Corps team remains an expeditionary force-in-readiness when responding to crises, creating decision space or winning battles.

Air and Space Force Major Commands

AFH1



Air Combat Command (ACC)

HQ: Langley AFB VA **Established:** 1 Jun 1992
Mission: To support global implementation of the NSS, ACC operates fighter, reconnaissance, battle-management and electronic-combat air-craft. ACC also provides command, control, communications and intelligence systems, and conducts global information operations.



Air Mobility Command (AMC)

HQ: Scott AFB IL **Established:** 1 Jun 1992
Mission: To provide global air mobility...right effects, right place, right time.



Pacific Air Forces (PACAF)

HQ: Hickam AFB HI **Established:** 3 Aug 1944
Mission: To provide United States Pacific Command Integrated expeditionary Air Force capabilities to defend the Homeland, promote stability, dissuade/ deter aggression, and swiftly defeat enemies.





U.S. Air Forces in Europe-Air Forces Africa (USAFE-AFAFRICA)

HQ: Ramstein AB GE **Established:** 7 Aug 1945
Mission: As the air component for both United States European Command and United States Africa Command, USAFE-Air Forces Africa executes the Air Force, United States European Command and United States Africa Command missions with forward-based airpower and infrastructure to conduct and enable theater and global operations. USAFE-Air Force Africa directs air operations in a theater. Spanning three continents, covering more than 15 million square miles, containing 104 independent states, and possessing more than one-fifth of the world's population and more than a quarter of the world's gross domestic product.



Air Education and Training Command (AETC)

HQ: Randolph AFB TX **Established:** 1 Jul 1993
Mission: Recruit, train and educate Airmen to deliver airpower for America. We take America's sons and daughters –young men and women who have volunteered to serve their country in a time of war – and develop them into Airmen.



Air Force Materiel Command (AFMC)

HQ: Wright-Patterson AFB OH **Established:** 1 Jul 1992
Mission: Delivers war-winning technology, acquisition support, sustainment, and expeditionary capabilities to the warfighter.



Air Force Special Operations Command (AFSOC)

HQ: Hurlburt Field FL **Established:** 22 May 1990
Mission: Provides Air Force special operations forces for worldwide deployment and assignment to regional unified commands. The command's special operation forces are composed of highly trained, rapidly deployable Airmen, conducting global special operations missions ranging from precision application of firepower to infiltration, exfiltration, resupply and refueling of special operation forces operational elements.



Air Force Global Strike Command (AFGSC)

HQ: Barksdale AFB LA **Established:** 7 Aug 2009
Mission: Provide strategic deterrence, global strike and combat support. Air Force Global Strike Command is responsible for maintaining and operating the United States' intercontinental ballistic missile and strategic bomber forces for global strike capabilities.



Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC)
HQ: Robins AFB GA **Established:** 17 February 1997
Mission: Provide combat-ready forces to fly, fight and win in defense of the United States and its interests.



Air National Guard (ANG)

The ANG is not a major Command, but a component in the Total Force in offensive, defensive and relief operations. It has both federal and state mission. The dual mission, a provision of the U.S. Constitution, results in each guardsman holding membership in the National Guard of their state and in the National Guard of the United States.



Space Field Commands

Combat Forces Command The primary provider of space forces and capabilities.

STAR Command Provides for the specialized education and training of the force.

Space Systems Command Is responsible for the developing, acquiring, fielding and sustaining space systems.

AIR FORCE FORCES (AFFOR) STAFF & AN A-STAFF

AFI 13-103 (November 2020)

An AFFOR staff and its air operations center (AOC) work together to perform warfighting functions and tasks and assist the air component commander to fulfill air component responsibilities to the joint force commander (JFC). The air component staffs also help commanders of Air Force service components fulfill their United States Code Title 10 responsibilities for administration and support, which include the organization of service forces, control of resources and equipment, personnel management, logistics, individual and unit training, readiness, mobilization and demobilization, and discipline.

An AFFOR staff consists of functionally oriented directorates, sometimes also called an "A-Staff," a command section, a personal staff, and any required liaisons.

Manpower, Personnel, and Services (A1). The director of manpower, personnel and services is the principal advisor to the air component commander for organizational actions, deployed manpower requirements, personnel policy, procedures, and administration, and for the force support functions (leadership, manpower, personnel,

services, education and training, equal opportunity, and airman and family readiness). The director advises on the force support capabilities (equal opportunity/human relations education, protocol, mortuary affairs, manpower management, total force accountability, personnel program operations, casualty reporting, food operations, fitness operations, lodgment of forces, recreation and resale operations, developing Airmen education and training, and airman and family readiness), which are key to combat support planning, course of action development and selection.

Intelligence Surveillance & Reconnaissance (A2). The Director of ISR is the air component's senior intelligence officer. This senior officer is responsible for overall orchestration and direction of the ISR enterprise, and the principal advisor to the Air Component Commander and staff on all ISR matters including the synchronization and orchestration of all air, cyber and national ISR assets, planning and direction, collection, processing and exploitation, analysis and production, and dissemination and integration of air component ISR capabilities in the theater. The director is responsible for integrating, synchronizing, and leading the ISR enterprise on behalf of the Air Component Commander, if the Air Component Commander is so assigned, in accordance with appropriate policy, guidance and this AFI.

Operations (A3). The director of operations serves as the primary staff advisor to the air component commander in direction and control of air forces. The A3 ensures AETF units, as well as those permanently assigned, are capable of performing operational missions to achieve effects as tasked by the AOC/OC. This includes planning in concert with the air component staff and AOC/OC personnel, monitoring unit deployments and bed down locations and ensuring combat readiness.

Logistics, Engineering, and Force Protection Directorate (A4). The director of logistics, engineering and force protection is the primary advisor to the air component commander for deployment, distribution, sustainment support, engineering, force protection and operational contract support (OCS). The A4 staff is a broad, multi-disciplined organization, generally comprised of logistics plans, munitions, fuels, vehicle management, materiel management, maintenance, distribution, combat logistics support, engineering, emergency services and force protection.

Strategy, Plans, and Requirements (A5). The director of strategy, plans and requirements is the primary staff advisor to the air component commander for development of steady state and contingency plans, to include development of force flow, service, branch and sequel plans, and security cooperation activities. Additionally, the A5 is responsible for policy, doctrine, requirement identification and prioritization.

Cyberspace Operations and Warfighter Communications (A6). The director of warfighter communications is the COMAFFOR's primary staff advisor for monitoring, protecting, integrating, and managing communication and cyberspace requirements and the AF portion of the combatant command's theater information networks.

Strategic Plans and Programs (A8). The director of programs and resources is responsible to the air component commander for developing programs and supporting the development and execution of the theater campaign plan and operation plans/ operation orders. A8 should identify and prioritize capability gaps and advocate for doctrine, organization, training, materiel, leadership & education, personnel, facilities, and policy solutions to fulfill operational requirements.

Studies, Analyses, Assessments, and Lessons Learned (A9). The director of studies, analyses, assessments and lessons learned leads the integrated analysis and assessment of all-domain operations across the AOC/OC and air component staff.

***Strategic Deterrence and Nuclear Integration (A10).** The director of strategic deterrence and nuclear integration is the primary advisor for strategic deterrence, conventional/nuclear integration, and Air Force nuclear enterprise matters. This includes nuclear force structure, Readiness, sustainability, and vulnerability data, as well as nuclear command, control and communications, and nuclear weapons employment.

*Although this A-staff position is no longer written in to the AFI 13-301, in December 2023, Air Force Global Strike Command stood up the new directorate, AFGSC/A10, the Intercontinental Ballistic Missile Modernization Directorate.
(https://www.af.mil/News/Article-Display/Article/3617053/afgsc-establishes-new-directorate/)

Agile Combat Employment

AF Doctrine Note 1-21 (August 2022)

Agile Combat Employment (ACE) is a proactive and reactive operational scheme of maneuver executed within threat timelines to increase resiliency and survivability while generating combat power. It involves the ability to rapidly disperse and reposition assets, such as aircraft, personnel, and support equipment, to different locations to ensure mission success and maintain operational readiness.

By employing ACE, the Air Force aims to reduce its reliance on traditional fixed bases and increase its ability to operate from austere or temporary locations. This concept requires a high degree of adaptability, mobility, and coordination among various units and support elements.

To provide a common lexicon with joint partners, ACE consists of five core elements: posture, C2, movement and maneuver, protection, and sustainment. The latter four align with the joint functions. Together with the remaining joint functions (information, intelligence, and fires), the five core elements form the whole of ACE's operational framework.

ACE requires a revolutionary change in how the Air Force thinks about and conducts operations within the modern operational environment. AF Doctrine Note 1-21 informs relevant and forward-looking ACE concepts and provides a mechanism to quickly evolve doctrine to adapt to an ever-changing security environment. The intent of the doctrine note is to share information and generate discussion across the force. As ACE continues to mature through employment in field operations and exercises, feedback and lessons learned will continue to feed the evolution of the emerging doctrine.

Three ACE Enablers

1. Multi-Capable Airmen (MCA). Airmen trained in expeditionary skills and capable of accomplishing tasks outside of their core Air Force specialty. Specifically, these personnel are often trained as a cross-functional team to provide support to ACE force elements. They **are enabled by cross-utilization training and can operate as part of a team in an expeditionary environment to accomplish mission objectives within acceptable levels of risk.**

2. Mission Command. An approach to C2 that empowers subordinate decision-making for flexibility, initiative, and responsiveness in the accomplishment of commander's intent. The core principles of mission command are: build teams through mutual trust, create shared understanding, provide clear commander's intent, use mission-type orders (MTO) when appropriate, exercise disciplined initiative, and accept prudent risk. Airmen execute mission command through centralized command, distributed control, and decentralized execution.

3. Tailorable Force Packages. To meet theater requirements, ACE requires tailorable force packages with the ability to execute across a range of operating locations. Force structure and unit type codes (UTCs) must be designed to enhance agility while also balancing risk to mission and force. Functional communities work with commanders to define ACE force packages that will be reflected in existing, new, or updated UTCs.

Five-Paragraph Mission Type Orders (MTO) Format. A MTO is a format for different orders contributing to the accomplishment of the total mission assigned the higher headquarters; it does not necessarily specify how tasks are to be accomplished. Mission type orders focus on the purpose of an operation rather than the details of how to accomplish it. They empower subordinates with the greatest possible freedom of action within the guidelines of commander's intent. MTOs are most applicable and effective when there is a reasonable expectation that the assumptions captured in commander's intent will remain valid during execution. MTOs should be based on higher-level headquarters priorities and intent, nested within the five-paragraph order format, which can be adapted and applied to peer and lower echelons.

USAF Modified Five-Paragraph Order Format (JP 5-0)

1. Situation
2. Mission
3. Execution
4. Force Sustainment
5. Command, Signal and Communications

Situation. Encompasses enemy and friendly forces composition, disposition, location, and capabilities.

Mission. Provide a clear concise statement of the specified, implied, and essential tasks.

Execution. Includes concept of the operations, tasks, and instructions.

Force Sustainment [Administration and Logistics]. Available rations, ammunition, billeting, and special & common equipment.

Command and Control. Communications plan, sign/ countersign, radio call signs & frequencies, and key leadership.

Joint Planning Process

JP 5-0 (July 2025)

Joint planning is the deliberate process of determining how to implement strategic guidance: how (the **ways**) to use military capabilities (the **means**) in time and space to achieve objectives (the **ends**) with
in an acceptable level of risk. Ideally, planning begins with specified national strategic objectives and military end states to provide a unifying purpose around which actions and resources are focused.

In military decision making, the joint planning process refers to the collaborative effort among multiple branches of the military to develop and execute a unified plan. It involves integrating the capabilities and resources of different services to achieve a common objective.

On the other hand, the military decision-making process (MDMP) is a systematic approach used to analyze and solve military problems. It is a framework that guides commanders and staff in making informed decisions. The MDMP encompasses several steps, including mission analysis, course of action development, course of action analysis, course of action comparison, and course of action approval.

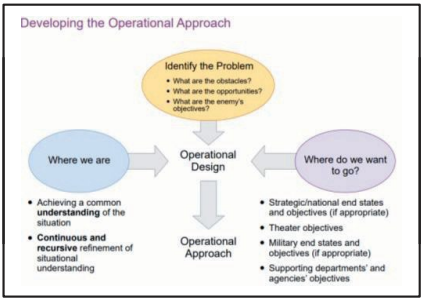
Essentially, the joint planning process is a specific aspect within the broader military decision- making process. It focuses on coordinating and synchronizing efforts across multiple military branches, while the MDMP provides a systematic procedure for decision making in general.



The commander provides guidance and expertise throughout the planning process. Planners often form teams or cross- functional teams to support the planning process. These teams usually consist of members from adjacent, supporting, or collaborating commands, as well as staff experts such as intelligence, logistics, communications, and medical planners.

In transregional and all-domain planning, when military operations exceed the authority or capabilities of a single commander, a designated commander is chosen to lead the planning effort. This decision is based on assessments from multiple commanders or a single threat assessment from a commander. The Chairman Joint Chiefs of Staff (CJCS) may oversee the activities of the combatant commands but does not have command authority.

The designated commander issues a planning directive and conducts a mission analysis to develop COAs (Courses of Action) in coordination with other commands and services. These COAs aim to mitigate operational gaps and vulnerabilities from a global perspective. Planners must consider competing requirements for limited resources and adhere to GFM (Global Force Management) policies and procedures.



Integrated planning is crucial for addressing complex threats that span multiple AORs (Areas of Responsibility) and functional responsibilities. The supported commander is responsible for integrating plans or orders from supporting commanders to ensure a cohesive mission.

Supporting plans are prepared by subordinate commands and component commanders in collaboration with the supported commander's planners. These plans describe how they intend to achieve their assigned objectives and tasks. Overall, planning in military operations requires collaboration, integration, and clear communication between commanders and their planning teams.

Planning Steps

1. **Planning Initiation** various authority levels may start the process

Planning Initiation - Joint planning begins when authority recognizes the need for military capability.

Autonomous Planning - Commanders can initiate planning on their own authority. CCDRs develop military options in combination with nonmilitary options.

Analyzing Planning Guidance - Commanders and staff analyze planning guidance, gather information about networks, and provide initial planning guidance based on the operational environment.

Continuous Planning - Planning continues throughout execution, particularly when there are changes to the mission or strategic direction.

Campaign vs Contingency Planning - Campaign planning assesses the current operational environment, while contingency planning anticipates future events.

Operational Design - Operational design helps define the problem and understand the strategic and operational environment.

2. **Mission Analysis** is a deliberate process to survey the environment and desired end state; all while ensuring to meet Command Directives

Ask the following questions:

(a) What is the purpose of the mission? (What problem is the commander being asked to solve or what change to the OE is desired?)
(b) What tasks will accomplish the mission?
(c) Will the mission achieve the desired objectives?
(d) What limitations have been placed on my own forces' actions?
(e) What forces are needed to support my operation?
(f) How will I know when the mission is accomplished successfully?
(g) How will friendly, neutral, and threat networks affect mission accomplishment?

A focused and effective mission analysis results in a Mission Analysis Briefing covering the situation, a friendly assessment, communication synchronization, objectives, effects, and task analysis, operational protection, a proposed initial commander's critical information requirements, mission (proposed mission statement, proposed commander's intent), a command relationships analysis and options, a conclusion (with potential resource shortfalls), and a mission analysis approval and commander's course of action planning guidance. (JP 5-0 III-30 lists the examples).

3. Course of Action (COA) Development A COA is a potential way (solution, method) to accomplish the assigned mission. A good COA accomplishes the mission within the commander's guidance, provides flexibility to meet unforeseen events during execution, and positions the joint force for future operations. All COAs must be suitable, feasible, acceptable, distinguishable, and complete.

COA Development Considerations:

(a) Inputs: Staff estimates, mission statement, operational approach, and CCIRs are input for COA development.

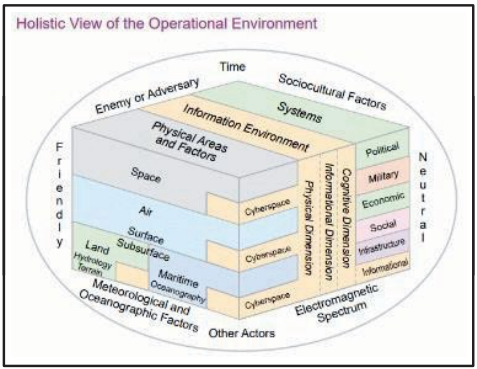
(b) Products: Potential COAs are developed, describing actions throughout the campaign or operation, including consolidation, stabilization, and transition. They consider forces, timeline, and risks, and undergo analysis and comparison.

(c) Developing Valid COAs: Despite constraints, valid COAs are crucial. JFC provides considerations to focus staff efforts and balance innovation with meeting guidance.

COAs as Conversation: COAs facilitate conversations between leaders about achievable outcomes, costs, and risks. Multiple COAs are compared.

(d) Envisioning Participant Employment: Commanders envision the employment of all participants, with success not solely dependent on external support.

Considering Enemy COAs and Operating Environment (OE) Factors: Feasible enemy COAs and operational environment factors are considered during COA development. Each COA includes an initial CONOPS with narrative and sketch, covering environment, objectives, tasks, forces, timeline, organization, concept, sustainment, communication, risk, and decision timeline.



Steps to COA Development

1. Within the limits of available forces, determine how much force will be needed in the theater at the end of the operation or campaign, what those forces will be doing, and how those forces will be postured geographically.
2. Working backwards, determine the best way to get the forces postured to their ultimate positions at the end of the operation or campaign.
3. Using the mission statement, determine the tasks the force must accomplish in the physical domains, information environment (including cyberspace), and electromagnetic spectrum to achieve the desired military end state. Ensure the force does everything the SecDef has directed the commander to do.
4. Determine the basing required to posture the force in friendly territory, and the tasks the force must accomplish to get to those bases. Sketch the deployment plan.
5. Determine if the planned force is enough to accomplish all the tasks.
6. Determine in what order the forces should be deployed into theater.
7. Consider the force categories such as combat, protection, sustainment, theater enablers, and theater opening.

4. COA Analysis and Wargaming COA analysis is the process of closely examining potential COAs to reveal details that enable the commander and staff to tentatively evaluate COA validity and identify the advantages and disadvantages of each proposed friendly COA.

1. Suitable—Can accomplish the mission within the commander's guidance.

2. Feasible—Can accomplish the mission within the established time, space, and resource limitations.

3. Acceptable—Must balance cost and risk with the advantage gained.

4. Distinguishable—Must be sufficiently different from other
5. Complete—Does it answer the questions who, what, where, when, how, and why?

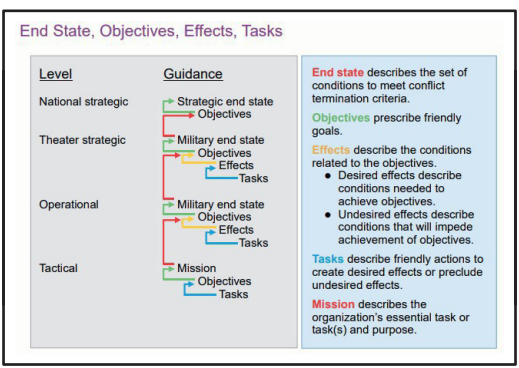
Wargaming is a conscious attempt to visualize the flow of the operation, given joint force strengths and dispositions, adversary capabilities and possible COAs, the OA, and other aspects of the OE.

Wargaming Action Steps (Ref JP 5-0):

1. Prepare for the Wargame:
2. Conduct and Assess Wargame:
3. Prepare Wargame Products:

RedCell: In wargaming, the Red Cell challenges and simulates enemy actions and strategies. They test and evaluate friendly forces' plans and apabilities.

White Cell: The White Cell facilitates and oversees wargames, ensuring smooth progress according to rules and objectives. They document and analyze actions and decisions for improvement.



5. COA Comparison COA comparison is both a subjective and objective process, whereby COAs are considered independently and evaluated/compared against a set of criteria that are established by the staff and commander. The objective is to identify and recommend the COA that has the highest probability of accomplishing the mission and is acceptable.

COA comparison facilitates the commander's decision-making process by balancing the ends, means, ways, and risk of each COA. The end product of this task is a briefing to the commander on a COA recommendation a and a decision by the commander. COA comparison helps the commander answer the following questions:

6. COA Approval the staff briefs the commander on the COA comparison and the analysis and wargaming results, including a review of important supporting information. The staff determines the preferred COA to recommend to the commander.

Chapter 5

Military Resources

Air and Space Force Inventory 105

Air Force Specialty Codes 123

Space Force Specialty Codes 124

Air Force Specialty Code Badges 125

Air and Space Force Inventory Mission Design Series

AFH1

Status Prefix (optional)
G – Permanently Grounded
J - Special Test (Temporary)
N - Special Test (permanent)
X - Experimental
Y - Prototype
Z - Planning

Modified Mission (optional)
A - Attack
C - Transport
D - Director
E - Special Electronic
F - Fighter
H - Search and Rescue
K - Tanker
L - Cold Weather
M - Multi-mission
O - Observation
P - Patrol
Q - Drone
R - Reconnaissance
T - Trainer
U - Utility
V - Staff
W - Weather

Basic Mission
A - Attack
B - Bomber
C - Transport
E - Special Electronic
F - Fighter
L - Laser
O - Observation
P - Patrol
R - Reconnaissance
S - Antisubmarine
T - Trainer
U - Utility
X – Research

Non-Standard Vehicle Type (if applicable)
G - Glider
H - Helicopter
S - Space Plane
V - VTOL/STOL
Z - Lighter-than-air

Example: NKC-135R
"N" Prefix, Special Test (Permanent)
"K" Modified Mission, Tanker
"C" Basic Mission, Transportation
"135" Design Number
"R" Model/Series

T-6A Texan II
Manufacturer: Raytheon
Function: Entry-Level Pilot Trainer
Service Date: 2001
Speed: 278 KIAS
Crew: Two
Inventory: 446
Commentary: The Joint Primary Aircraft Training System (JPATS) T-6A Texan II is based on the Swiss Pilatus PC-9 aircraft. The USAF is exploring the purchase of a light attack variant (AT-6) for deployment in coordination with allied countries.



T-1A Jayhawk
Manufacturer: Raytheon
Service Date: 1993
Function: Advanced Pilot Trainer
Speed: 467 KIAS
Crew: Three
Inventory: 178
Commentary: First delivered to Reese AFB, Texas in 1992. First pilot training began in 1993. Used for specialized training involving tanker or airlift aircraft. Seats for two students and an instructor.



T-38A/C and AT-38B Talon
Manufacturer: Northrup Grumman
Function: Advanced Jet Pilot Trainer
Service Date: 1961
Speed: 706 KIAS
Crew: Two
Inventory: 546
Commentary: Most of the T-38s service are used by AETC for advanced bomber/ fighter training track in Undergraduate Pilot Training. Some aircraft are stationed with systems for complementary training such as the B-2. The service life of the T-38 is projected beyond 2026.



A-10A/C Thunderbolt II
Manufacturer: Fairchild Republic
Function: Close Air Support, Airborne Forward Air Control
Service Date: 1977
Speed: 450 KIAS
Crew: One
Inventory: 281
Commentary: The cockpit is protected with a titanium armor "bathtub", capable of absorbing up to 23 mm rounds. A-10s were first used in combat during Desert Storm in 1991. The A-10 is projected to serve beyond 2028.



B-1B Lancer
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Long-Range, Multi-Role, Heavy Bomber
Service Date: 1985
Speed: 780+ KIAS
Crew: Four
Inventory: 62
Commentary: The B-1 was planned as a replacement for the B-52 but was canceled in 1977. The USAF revived the program in 1981. The B-1B was first used in combat against Iraq during Operation DESERT FOX in 1998.



B-2A Spirit
Manufacturer: Northrup Grumman
Function: Multi-Role Heavy Bomber
Service Date: 1993
Speed: Mach 0.85-0.95
Crew: Two Pilots
Inventory: 20
Commentary: Based on flying wing concept pioneered on Northrup test bombers YB-35 and YB-49 in the 1940s. The first use of B-2s in combat took place in 1999 in Operation ALLIED FORCE.



B-52H Stratofortress
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Heavy Bomber
Service Date: 1955
Speed: 565 KIAS
Crew: Five
Inventory: 76
Commentary: The B-52 is the largest aircraft credited with air-to-air kills (2 in Vietnam). Specially modified NB-52s support NASA and USAF test programs, acting as the launch platform for the X-15, lifting body aircraft, and other test vehicles. One B-52 unit is dedicated to the nuclear mission at all times.



C-5M Galaxy
Manufacturer: Lockheed
Function: Outsize cargo transport
Service Date: 1970
Speed: 450 KIAS
Crew: Seven
Inventory: 48
Commentary: The C-5M is the USAF's largest transport aircraft. The C-5M is capable of carrying two M1 Abrams battle tanks, six Apache helicopters, or a quarter million pounds of relief supplies.



C-17A Globemaster III
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Cargo and Troop Transport
Service Date: 1993
Speed: 450 KIAS
Crew: Three
Inventory: 222
Commentary: The first C-17 operational strategic brigade airdrop occurred in March 2003, when a formation of 15 aircraft delivered a U.S. Army brigade, complete with equipment, directly into northern Iraq.



Manufacturer: Learjet Inc.
Function: Passenger Airlift
Service Date: 1984
Speed: 460 KIAS
Crew: Two
Inventory: 19
Commentary: In January 2007, Program Budget Decision number 720 reduced C-21 operations to 40 aircraft. The C-21 can be outfitted for aeromedical evacuations, being capable of transporting one litter or five ambulatory patients.



C-32
Manufacturer: Boeing Company
Function: High-Priority Personnel Transport
Service Date: 1998
Speed: 460 KIAS
Crew: 16
Inventory: 4
Commentary: Primary user of this aircraft is the vice president, using the callsign "Air Force Two." Aircraft includes a communications center, galley, fully enclosed stateroom, and a conference and staff facility. Comes with traffic collision avoidance system and enhanced ground proximity warning system, which gives possible warning of air to ground threats. Communications equipment on board include telephones, television monitors, facsimiles and copy machines.



C-37A/B Gulfstream V
Manufacturer: Gulfstream Aerospace Corp.
Function: Special Air Missions
Service Date: 1998
Speed: 521 KIAS
Crew: Five
Production: 13 **Inventory:** 12
Commentary: Capable of cruise operations from 41,000 to 51,000 feet. Includes enhanced weather radar, autopilot and ultra-modern heads-up display. Equipped with both commercial and military communications equipment to provide both secure and non-secure communication ability.



C-40B/C Clipper
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: High-Priority Personnel Transport
Service Date: 2003
Speed: 460 KIAS
Crew: Ten
Inventory: 11
Commentary: Most common users of the C- 40B are combatant commanders and members of the Cabinet and Congress. Communication is paramount, so aircraft is equipped with broad-band data/video transmit/receive along with clear and secure voice and data communication. Also contains telephones, television monitors, fac-simile and copy machines, and a LAN connection.



C-130 Hercules
Manufacturer: Lockheed
Function: Theater Tactical Airlift
Modified Functions: Tanker, Special Operations, Reconnaissance, Airborne Command Post, Special Mission
Service Date: 1956
Speed: 318 KIAS
Crew: Five
Inventory: 428
Commentary: Basic and specialized versions of the C-130 Hercules transport operate throughout USAF, performing diverse roles in diverse situations, including airlift support, Arctic ice cap resupply, aeromedical missions, aerial spray missions (AFRC), fire-fighting duties (AFRC and ANG) for the U.S. Forest Service, gunship, special operations, and natural disaster and humanitarian relief missions.



Major Variants:
AC-130W Stinger II
AC-130U, Spooky
AC-130J Ghostrider
EC-130J Commando Solo
MC-130H Combat Talon II
MC-130J Commando II

E-3B/C/G Sentry (AWACS)
Manufacturer: Boeing, Northrup Grumman, Lockheed Martin
Function: Airborne Battle Management, Command and Control
Service Date: 1975
Speed: 313 KIAS
Crew: 17-23
Production: 34
Inventory: 31
Commentary: Heavily modified Boeing 707-320B aircraft, fitted with an extensive complement of mission avionics providing all-weather air surveillance and command, control, and communications for tactical and air defense forces.



E-4B
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Airborne Operations Center
Service Date: 1980
Speed: 523 KIAS
Crew: Up to 112
Inventory: 4
Commentary: Serves as the National Airborne Operations Center for the President, Secretary of War and the Joint Chiefs of Staff. This aircraft provides a highly survivable, command, control, and communications center to direct U.S. forces, execute emergency war orders, and coordinate actions by civil authorities.



F-15A/B/C/D Eagle
Manufacturer: McDonnell Douglas, now Boeing
Function: Tactical Fighter
Service Date: 1974
Speed: 1629 KIAS
Crew: One (A/C), Two (B/D)
Inventory: 249
Commentary: F-15 fighters deployed to Desert Storm accounted for 34 of the 37 USAF air-to- air victories, and in Iraqi Freedom F-15Cs led coalition aircraft in maintaining aerial dominance.



F-15E Strike Eagle
Manufacturer: McDonnell Douglas
Function: Air-to-Ground Attack Aircraft
Service Date: 1988
Speed: 1629 KIAS
Crew: Two
Inventory: 219
Commentary: A heavily modified, two-seat, dual-role variant of the F-15, with weapons systems integrated for all-weather deep interdiction missions and as air-to-air combat. During Desert Storm, 48 USAF F-15Es deployed to the Persian Gulf where they operated at night, hunting Scud missile launchers and artillery sites.



F-16A/B/C/D Fighting Falcon
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Multirole Fighter
Service Date: 1979
Speed: 1300 KIAS
Crew: One (A/C), Two (B/D)
Inventory: 1017
Commentary: A versatile, low-cost multi-role fighter originally designed as a daylight air superiority fighter. Later versions specialized in suppression of enemy air defenses (SEAD), and air-to-surface attack. Over 2,000 F-16 are used in 24 countries.



F-22A Raptor
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Air Dominance, Multi-Role Fighter
Service Date: 2002
Speed: Mach 2.25
Supercruise: Mach 1.82
Crew: One
Inventory: 183
Commentary: The F-22A reached IOC in December 2005, and on Jan. 21, 2006, it flew its first operational sortie from Langley AFB, Va., as part of Operation NOBLE EAGLE.



F-35 Lightning II
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Multi-role Fighter
Service Date: 2011
Speed: 1042 KIAS
Crew: One
Inventory: 96
Commentary: USAF's F-35A will replace its current force of F-16 and A-10 aircraft with a stealthy multi-role fighter that will comprise the bulk of USAF's fighter fleet for up to 50 years.



KC-135R/T Stratotanker
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Aerial Refueling/Airlift
Modified Functions: Special Mission, Reconnaissance
Service Date: 1957
Speed: 460 KIAS
Crew: Three (Tanker)
Inventory: 396
Commentary: Currently the Mainstay of the USAF tanker fleet, the long-serving KC-135 is similar in size and appearance to commercial 707 aircraft but was designed to military specifications. The size and range of the platform led to numerous variants in its 60+ years of service to include reconnaissance, observation, weather and command and controls missions.



KC-46A Pegasus
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Aerial Tanker/Transport
Service Date: 1981
Speed: 650 KIAS
Crew: 15
Inventory: 59
Commentary: The KC-46A is the first phase in recapitalizing the U.S. Air Force's aging tanker fleet. With greater refueling, cargo and aeromedical evacuation capabilities compared to the KC-135, the KC-46A will provide next generation aerial refueling support to Air Force, Navy, Marine Corps and partner-nation receivers.



VC-25 Air Force One
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Presidential Air Transport
Service Date: 1990
Speed: 547 KIAS
Crew: 26
Inventory: 2
Commentary: The VC-25 is most famous for its role as Air Force One, the call sign of any U.S. Air Force aircraft carrying the President of the United States. The two aircraft currently in U.S. service are highly modified versions of Boeing's 747-200B, with tail numbers 28000 and 29000.



CV-22A Osprey
Manufacturer: Bell Helicopter and Boeing
Function: Special Operations Long Range
Speed: 240 KIAS (cruising speed)
Crew: Four
Inventory: 49
Commentary: The USAF received its first aircraft in January 2007. IOT&E was completed by summer 2008. The first operational deployment to Africa, took place in November 2008, and the first combat deployment in summer 2009.



HH-60G Pave Hawk
Manufacturer: Sikorsky
Function: Special Operations/Personnel Recovery
Service Date: 1982
Speed: 160 KIAS
Crew: Four
Inventory: 99
Commentary: The HH-60 is a specially modified version of the H-60 Blackhawk used primarily for combat search and rescue, aeromedical evacuation, casualty evacuation, SAR, and other support missions.



UH-1N Huey
Manufacturer: Bell Helicopter/Textron Inc.
Function: Airlift
Service Date: 1970
Speed: 115 KIAS
Crew: 3
Inventory: 59
Commentary: Primarily used for airlift of emergency security forces, security and surveillance of off-base nuclear weapons convoys, and distinguished visitor airlift.



MH-139A Grey Wolf
Contractor: Boeing, Leanardo and Honeywell
Function: Intercontinental ballistic missile field security and support, DV lift, aircrew survival training
Thrust: 1,100 shaft horsepower
Range: 225 nautical miles
Crew: Two pilots, one flight engineer
Inventory: N/A, 84 planned
Commentary: The MH-139A was designed to be a direct replacement to the Air Force's aging fleet of UH-1N Huey helicopters. The Grey Wolf provides the ability to cruise 50% faster and farther than the Huey, while also having a 30% larger cabin and capability to lift 5,000 pounds more. In the interest of quality-of-life features, the MH-139A is equipped with full autopilot capability, as well as cutting-edge avionics that enhance situational awareness, reducing both pilot and crew workload.



U-2S and TR-1 Dragon Lady
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: High-Altitude Reconnaissance
Service Date: 1955
Speed: 356+ KIAS
Crew: 1
Inventory: 33
Commentary: Although the U-2 was designed initially in the 1950s, current aircraft were produced primarily in the 1980s, when the production line was reopened to produce the TR-1, a significantly larger and more capable version than the earlier aircraft.



MQ-9 Reaper
Manufacturer: General Atomics
Function: Remotely Piloted Hunter/Killer
Service Date: 2007
Speed: 200 KIAS
Crew: Two
Inventory: 93
Commentary: Officially combat operational in Afghanistan since September 2007, the MQ-9 Reaper is larger than the MQ-1, has eight times the range, and flies twice as high. An unarmed variant is deployed with the U.S. Department of Homeland Security for customs and border surveillance.



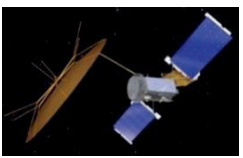
RQ-4A Global Hawk
Manufacturer: Northrup Grumman
Function: High-Altitude, Long Endurance ISR
Service Date: 2001
Speed: 310 KIAS
Inventory: 33
Commentary: The RQ-4 provides high altitude, persistent (28+ hours) remotely piloted ISR capability. The system consists of an aircraft, GCS, and an integrated sensor suite.



Ultra-High Frequency Follow-On (UFO)
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Communications (Narrowband SATCOM)
Service Date: 1993
Constellation: 11 (8 active)
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: UFO supports the Navy's global communications network, serving ships at sea and a variety of other U.S. military fixed and mobile terminals. The constellation will gradually be replaced by the Mobile User Objective System (MUOS).



Mobile User Objective System (MUOS)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin, Boeing, General Dynamics
Function: Communications (Narrowband SATCOM)
Service Date: 2012
Constellation: 5 (4 oper 1 on-orbit spare)
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: MUOS provides global narrowband connectivity to terminals, platforms, tactical operators and operations centers. It replaces the slower and less mobile UFO system.



Defense Satellite Communications System (DSCS)
Manufacturer: General Electric, Hughes
Function: Communications (Wideband SATCOM)
Service Date: 1982
Constellation: 14 (7 active)
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: DSCS satellites support globally distributed DoD and national security users. This constellation provides substantial capacity improvements through higher power amplifiers, more sensitive receivers, and additional connectivity options. DSCS is being replaced by the Wideband Global SATCOM system.



Wideband Global SATCOM (WWGS)
Manufacturer: Boeing
Function: Communications (Wideband SATCOM)
Service Date: 2007
Constellation: 10
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: Users include the Australian Defense Force and U.S. Army ground mobile terminals, U.S. Navy ships and submarines, national command authorities for the nuclear forces, and various national security/allied national forces.



Military Strategic and Tactical Relay (MILSTAR)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Communication (Protected SATCOM)
Service Date: 1994
Constellation: 6 (5 active)
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: MILSTAR provides secure, jam resistant, worldwide communications to meet the requirements of the U.S. military. Provides communications which are hard to detect and intercept, and to be survivable in the event of nuclear warfare.



Advanced Extremely High Frequency (AEHF)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Communications (Protected SATCOM)
Service Date: 2010
Constellation: 6
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: AEHF is a joint service communications satellite that will provide survivable, global, secure, protected, and jam-resistant communications for high-priority military ground, sea, and air assets. It is backward compatible with, and will replace, the older MIPSTAR system.



Global Positioning System (GPS)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin, Boeing
Function: Worldwide Positioning, Navigation, Timing (PNT) and Velocity Information
Service Date: 1978
Constellation: 72 (31 active)
Orbit: Medium Earth Orbit (MEO)
Commentary: GPS is one of the global navigation satellite systems (GNSS) that provides geolocation and time information to a GPS receiver anywhere on or near the Earth where there is an unobstructed line of sight to four or more GPS satellites. GPS is on its 3rd generation of satellites.



Defense Meteorological Satellite Program (DMSP)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Meteorology
Service Date: 1976
Constellation: 19 (3 active)
Orbit: Polar Sun-synchronous Orbit
Commentary: DMSP monitors meteorological, oceanographic, and solar-terrestrial physics for the DoD. The program is managed by the USSF, with on-orbit operations provided by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).



Space Based Infrared System (SBIRS)
Manufacturer: Lockheed Martin
Function: Missile Warning
Service Date: 2011
Constellation: 4 GEO / 2 HEO
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO) and Highly Elliptical Orbit (HEO)
Commentary: SBIRS satellites are intended to primarily provide enhanced strategic and theater ballistic missile warning capabilities. SBIRS replaced the DSP system for early warning satellites.



Defense Support Program (DSP
Manufacturer: Northrop Grumman
Function: Missile Warning
Service Date: 1970
Constellation: 4 GEO
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: DSP satellites detect missile or spacecraft launches and nuclear explosions using sensors that detect the infrared emissions from these intense sources of heat. The program is being phased out for the SBIRS program.



Geosynchronous Space Situational Awareness Program (GSSAP)
Manufacturer: Northrop Grumman
Function: Space Surveillance
Service Date: 2014
Constellation: 4
Orbit: Geosynchronous Orbit (GEO)
Commentary: GSSAP satellites collect space situational awareness data allowing for more accurate tracking and characterization of man-made orbiting objects.



Space-Based Space Surveillance (SBSS
Manufacturer: Boeing / Ball Aerospace
Function: Space Surveillance
Service Date: 2010
Constellation: 1
Orbit: Sun-synchronous Orbit
Commentary: SBSS can monitor very small objects all the way out to the GEO belt and provides the data necessary to predict the trajectories of these objects, which gives experts an idea if orbiting satellite may collide with another orbiting object, which allows time for evasive action to be taken in order to avoid collisions.



Upgraded Early Warning (UEWR)
UEWR are phased array radars designed primarily to detect and track Intercontinental Ballistic Missiles (ICBMs) and Sea Launched Ballistic Missiles (SLBM), while conducting general space surveillance and satellite tracking.



Perimeter Acquisition Radar Attack (PARCS)
PARCS is a single-faced, multi-function, phased array radar designed to keep watch for sea-launched and intercontinental ballistic missiles launched toward North America and to collect missile warning data. A secondary mission is to provide data concerning space launches and orbiting objects as a collateral sensor for the Space Surveillance Network.



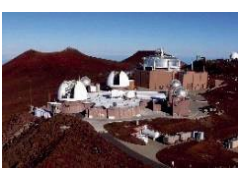
PAVE Phased Array Warning System (PAWS)
The PAVE PAWS are ground-based phased array radars located on the west and east coasts of the U.S. They are capable of detecting Submarine Launched Ballistic Missile (SLBM) attacks and conducting general space surveillance and satellite tracking.



COBRA DANE
COBRA DANE is a phased array radar which collects radar metric and signature data on foreign ballistic missile events during exo-atmospheric and early endo-atmospheric portions of flight and on selected space launches in early orbit in support of treaty monitoring, force modernization, and missile defense.



Ground-Based Electro-Optical Deep Space Surveillance System (GEODSS)
GEODSS is an optical system that uses telescopes, low-light level TV cameras, and computers to track objects in deep space. GEODSS system can track objects as small as a basketball more than 20,000 miles in space or a chair at 35,000 miles.



Space Fence
Space Fence is the world's most advanced radar providing uncued detection, tracking and accurate measurement of space objects, including satellites and orbital debris, primarily in low-earth orbit (LEO). Space Fence provides precise positional data for Space Domain Awareness to maintain a robust and accurate space object catalog, ensure orbital safety, and provide early warning for conjunction events and indications of potential threats.



Air Force Satellite Control Network (AFSCN)
The Air Force Satellite Control Network is a worldwide network of satellite control stations which uses satellite and terrestrial communication links providing connectivity to over 150 Department of War, National, Allied and Civil space vehicles.



National Security Space Launch (NSSL)
Manufacturer: United Launch Alliance (ULA)/Space Exploration Technologies Corp (SpaceX)
Function: Spacelift
Launch Vehicles: Atlas V, Delta IV Heavy
Commentary: NSSL is a contractual program intended to assure access to space for DoD and other U.S. government payloads.



Air Force Specialty Codes

Sep 2026

OPERATIONS	
10C0	Operations Commander
PILOT	
11B_	Bomber Pilot
11E_	Experimental Test Pilot
11F_	Fighter Pilot
11G_	Generalist Pilot
11H_	Rescue Pilot
11U_	Trainer Pilot
11M_	Mobility Pilot
11R_	Recce/Surv/Elect Warfare Pilot
11S_	Special Operations Pilot
11T_	Student Pilot
11U_	Remotely Piloted Aircraft (RPA) Pilot
COMBAT SYSTEMS	
12B_	Bomber Combat Systems Officer
12E_	Experimental Test Combat Systems Officer
12F_	Fighter Combat Systems Officer
12G_	Generalist Combat Systems Officer
12H_	Rescue Combat Systems Officer
12U_	Trainer Combat Systems Officer
12M_	Mobility Combat Systems Officer
12R_	Recce/Surv/Elect Warfare Combat Systems Officer
12S_	Special Operations Combat Systems Officer
12U_	Remotely Piloted Aircraft (RPA)
SPACE, NUCLEAR AND MISSILE, C2, AEROSPACE	
13A_	Astronaut
13B_	Air Battle Manager
13D_	Aerospace Physiologist
13M_	Airfield Operation
13N_	Nuclear and Missile Operations
13S0	Multi-Domain Warfare Officer
13Z_	Rated Multi-Domain Warfare Officer
13S_	Space Operations
INFORMATION OPERATIONS	
14F_	Information Operations
INTELLIGENCE	
14N_	Intelligence
OPERATIONS ANALYSIS	
15A_	Operations Analysis Officer
WEATHER	
15W_	Weather and Environmental Sciences
OPERATIONS SUPPORT	
16F_	Foreign Area Officer
16G_	Air Force Operations Staff Officer
16S_	Software Development Officer (SDO)
16P_	Political-Military Affairs Strategist
16R_	Planning & Programming
16Z_	Rated Foreign Area Officer (FAO)
CYBER OPERATIONS	
17C0	Cyberspace Warfare Operations Commander
17D_	Warfighter Communications
17S_	Cyberspace Effects Operations
17W_	Warfighter Communications & IT Systems
17Y_	Cyber Effects & Warfare Operations
REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT	
18A_	Attack Remotely Piloted Aircraft Pilot
18E_	Experimental Test RPA Pilot
18G_	Generalist Remotely Piloted Aircraft Pilot
18R_	Reconnaissance Remotely Piloted Aircraft Pilot
18S_	Special Operations RPA Pilot
SPECIAL WARFARE	
19G0_	Space Warfare Officer
19Z_	Special Warfare
LOGISTICS	
20C0	Logistics Commander
LOGISTICS	
21A_	Aircraft Maintenance
21M_	Munitions and Missile Maintenance
21R_	Logistics Readiness
SUPPORT	
30C0	Support Commander
SECURITY FORCES	
31P_	Security Forces
CIVIL ENGINEERING	
32E_	Civil Engineering
PUBLIC AFFAIRS	
35B_	Band
35P_	Public Affairs
FORCE SUPPORT OFFICER	
38F_	Force Support
MEDICAL	
40C0	Medical Commander
HEALTH SERVICES	
41AX	Health Services Administrator

BIOMEDICAL CLINICIANS	
42BX	Physical Therapist
42EX	Optometrist
42PX	Podiatric Surgeon
42QX	Physician Assistant
42RX	Audiologist
42SX	Clinical Psychologist
42UX	Clinical Social Worker
42TX	Occupational Therapist
BIOMEDICAL SPECIALISTS	
43BX	Biomedical Scientist
43DX	Dietitian
43EX	Bioenvironmental Engineer
43HX	Public Health
43PX	Pharmacist
43TX	Biomedical Laboratory
PHYSICIAN	
44AX	Chief of Medical Staff
44BX	Preventive Medicine Physician
44DX	Pathologist
44EX	Emergency Medicine Physician
44FX	Family Physician
44GX	General Practice Physician
44HX	Nuclear Medicine Physician
44JX	Medical Geneticist and Genomicist
44KX	Pediatrician
44MX	Internal Medicine Physician
44NX	Neurologist
44OX	Physician
44PX	Psychiatrist
44QX	Radiologist
44RX	Dermatologist
44SX	Radiation Oncologist
44UX	Occupational Medicine Physician
44VX	Critical Care Medicine Physician
44ZX	Allergist and Immunologist
SURGERY	
45AX	Anesthesiologist
45BX	Orthopaedic Surgeon
45DX	Ophthalmologist
45OX	Gynecologic Surgeon and Obstetrician
45OX	Otolaryngologist - Head and Neck Surgeon
45PX	Physical Medicine Physician
45SX	Surgeon
45UX	Urologist
NURSE	
46AX	Nurse Administrator
46FX	Flight Nurse
46OX	Clinical Nurse
46PX	Mental Health Nurse
46SX	Operating Room Nurse
46YX	Advanced Practice Registered Nurse (APRN)
DENTAL	
47BX	Orthodontist
47DX	Oral and Maxillofacial Pathologist
47EX	Endodontist
47GX	Dentist
47IX	Periodontist
47JX	Pediatric Dentist
47PX	Prosthodontist
47SX	Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeon
AEROSPACE MEDICINE	
48AX	Aerospace Medicine Physician Specialist
48GX	General Medical Officer (GMO), Flt Surg
48OX	Aeromedical Physician
48RX	Residency Trained Flight Surgeon
48UX	Pilot-Physician
PROFESSIONAL	
LAW	
51JX	Judge Advocate
CHAPLAIN	
52RX	Chaplain
ACQUISITION	
COMMAND	
60C0	Senior Materiel Leader-Upper Echelon
SCIENTIFIC/RESEARCH	
61CX	Chemist/Biologist
61DX	Physicist/Nuclear Engineer

DEVELOPMENTAL ENGINEERING	
62EX	Developmental Engineer
62S0	Materiel Leader
ACQUISITION	
63AX	Acquisition Manager
63G0	Senior Materiel Leader-Lower Echelon
63S0	Materiel Leader
CONTRACTING	
64PX	Contracting
FINANCE	
65FX	Financial Management
65W0	Cost Analysis
SPECIAL INVESTIGATIONS	
71SX	Special Investigations
SPECIAL DUTY IDENTIFIERS	
80C0	Commander, Cadet Squadron, USAFA
81C0	Instructor, Officer Training School
81D0	Air Force Reserve Officer Training Corps Detachment Commander and Instructor
81L0	Education and Training Leader
81T0	Instructor
82A0	Academic Program Manager
83R0	Recruiting Service
84H0	Historian
85G0	USAF Honor Guard
86O0	Operations Management
86P0	Command and Control
87G0	Wing Inspector General
87I0	Director, Wing Inspections
87O0	Director, Complaints Resolution
88A0	Aide-de-Camp
88B0	Protocol Officer
88C0	Senior Assistant Response Coordinator (SARC)
88I0	Innovation Officer
88M0	United States Air Force Medical Pinnacle Position
88X0	Operational STEM Officer
88Y0	Pathfinder
89A0	Officer Air Advisor Basic
89B0	Officer Air Advisor Basic Team Leader
89C0	Officer Air Advisor Basic Mission Commander
89D0	Officer Air Advisor Advanced
89E0	Officer Air Advisor Advanced Team Leader
89F0	Officer Air Advisor Advanced Mission Commander
89G0	Officer Combat Aviation Advisor
89H0	Officer Combat Aviation Advisor Team Leader
89I0	Officer Combat Aviation Advisor Mission Commander
89W0	Weapons of Mass Destruction Civil Support Team (WMD-CST)
REPORTING IDENTIFIERS	
90G0	General Officer
91C0	Commander
91E0	Wing Commander Equivalent
91W0	Wing Commander
92F0	Foreign Area Officer (FAO) Trainee
92J0	Nondesignated Lawyer
92J1	AFROTC Educational Delay-Law Student
92J2	Funded Legal Ed Program Law Student
92J3	Excess Leave Law Student
92M0	Health Professions Scholarship Program (HPSP) Medical Student
92M1	Uniformed Services University of Health Sciences Student
92M2	HPSP Biomedical Science Student
92P0	Physician Assistant Student
92R0	Chaplain Candidate
92S0	Student Officer Authorization
92T0	Pilot Trainee
92T1	Combat Systems Officer Trainee
92T2	Air Battle Manager Trainee
92T3	RPA Pilot Trainee
92W0	Combat Wounded Warrior
92W1	Reserved for Future Use
92W2	Combat Wounded Warrior with Exemptions
92W3	Non-Combat Wounded Warrior
92W4	Wounded Warrior-Limited Assignment Status
92W5	Wounded Warrior-Retired/Discharged
92W6	Reserved for Future Use
92W7	Reserved for Future Use
92W8	Wounded Warrior - Ambassador
92W9	Wounded Warrior – Project Planner/Officer
93P0	Patient
94D0	Nuclear Weapons Custodian
95A0	Non- Extended Active Duty USAFR Academy/CAP Liaison Officer
96A0	Disqualified Officer, Reasons Beyond Their Control
96B0	Disqualified Officer, Reasons Within Their Control
96D0	Off not Avail in awarded AFSC for cause
96U0	Unclassified Officer
96V0	Unaltered
97E0	Executive Officer
99A0	Unspecified AFSC
99G0	Gold Bar Recruiter

Space Force Specialty Codes

www.spaceforce.mil

The USSF may eventually create their own specialty code system, but for now remain under the Department of the Air Force. Current specialty codes consist of those which are organic to only the USSF and those which are shared between the two services.

Organic to USSF are those assigned to space operations.

Shared between USSF and USAF are intelligence, cyber, acquisitions, and engineers. There will be positions and people with these sets of expertise in both USAF and USSF. USSF and USAF will build capability to organize, train and equip individuals with this expertise and will be required to provide Combatant Commanders with this capability.

OPERATIONS

SPACE
13SX SPACE OPERATIONS
INTELLIGENCE
14NX INTELLIGENCE
CYBER OPERATIONS
17SX CYBER EFFECTS OPERATIONS

ACQUISISITION

DEVELOPMENTAL ENGINEERING
62EX DEVELOPMENTAL ENGINEER
ACQUISITION
63AX ACQUISITION MANAGER

Air Force Specialty Code Badges

AFH1

	
Pilot	Combat Systems Officer
	
Enlisted Aircrew	Astronaut
	
Flight Surgeon	Flight Nurse
	
Officer Aircrew	Parachutist
	
Remotely Piloted Aircraft	Sensor Operator
	
Air Battle Manager	Cyberspace Operator
	
Space Operations	Cyberspace Support

	
Command and Control	Logistics Plans
	
Judge Advocate	Paralegal
	
Acquisition and Financial Management	Intelligence
	
Historian	Freefall Parachutist
	
Operations Support	Explosive Ordinance Disposal
	
Civil Engineer	Band
	
Fire Protection	Security Police

	
Air Traffic Control	Meteorologist
	
Missile Maintenance	Missile Operations
	
Force Support	Force Protection
	
Manpower and Personnel	Chaplain Service Support
	
Weapons Director	Public Affairs
	
Transportation	Services

	
Supply Fuels	Commander
	
Chaplain Jewish	Chaplain Christian
	
Chaplain Buddhist	Chaplain Muslim
	
Readiness	Scuba Diver
	
Enlisted Medical	Biomedical Science Corps
	
Dental Corps	Nurse Corps
	
Medical Corps	Medical Services Corp

APPENDIX I

U.S. Constitution

(Constitutioncenter.org/the-constitution/full-text)

Preamble:

We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic tranquility, provide for the common defense, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America.

Article I

Section 1: Congress

All legislative Powers herein granted shall be vested in a Congress of the United States, which shall consist of a Senate and House of Representatives.

Section 2: The House of Representatives

The House of Representatives shall be composed of Members chosen every second Year by the People of the several States, and the Electors in each State shall have the Qualifications requisite for Electors of the most numerous Branch of the State Legislature.

No Person shall be a Representative who shall not have attained to the Age of twenty-five Years, and been seven Years a Citizen of the United States, and who shall not, when elected, be an Inhabitant of that State in which he shall be chosen.

Representatives and direct Taxes shall be apportioned among the several States which may be included within this Union, according to their respective Numbers, which shall be determined by adding to the whole Number of free Persons, including those bound to Service for a Term of Years, and excluding Indians not taxed, three fifths of all other Persons. The actual Enumeration shall be made within three Years after the first Meeting of the Congress of the United States, and within every subsequent Term of ten Years, in such Manner as they shall by Law direct. The Number of Representatives shall not exceed one for every thirty Thousand, but each State shall have at Least one Representative; and until such enumeration shall be made, the State of New Hampshire shall be entitled to chuse three, Massachusetts eight, Rhode-Island and Providence Plantations one, Connecticut five, New-York six, New Jersey four, Pennsylvania eight, Delaware one, Maryland six, Virginia ten, North Carolina five, South Carolina five, and Georgia three.

When vacancies happen in the Representation from any State, the Executive Authority thereof shall issue Writs of Election to fill such Vacancies.

The House of Representatives shall chuse their Speaker and other Officers; and shall have the sole Power of Impeachment.

Section 3: The Senate

The Senate of the United States shall be composed of two Senators from each State, chosen by the Legislature thereof, for six Years; and each Senator shall have one Vote.

Immediately after they shall be assembled in Consequence of the first Election, they shall be divided as equally as may be into three Classes. The Seats of the Senators of the first Class shall be vacated at the Expiration of the second Year, of the second Class at the Expiration of the fourth Year, and of the third Class at the Expiration of the sixth Year, so that one third may be chosen every second Year; and if Vacancies happen by Resignation, or otherwise, during the Recess of the Legislature of any State, the Executive thereof may make temporary Appointments until the next Meeting of the Legislature, which shall then fill such Vacancies.

No Person shall be a Senator who shall not have attained to the Age of thirty Years, and been nine Years a Citizen of the United States, and who shall not, when elected, be an Inhabitant of that State for which he shall be chosen.

The Vice President of the United States shall be President of the Senate, but shall have no Vote, unless they be equally divided.

The Senate shall chuse their other Officers, and also a President pro tempore, in the Absence of the Vice President, or when he shall exercise the Office of President of the United States.

The Senate shall have the sole Power to try all Impeachments. When sitting for that Purpose, they shall be on Oath or Affirmation. When the President of the United States is tried, the Chief Justice shall preside: And no Person shall be convicted without the Concurrence of two thirds of the Members present.

Judgment in Cases of Impeachment shall not extend further than to removal from Office, and disqualification to hold and enjoy any Office of honor, Trust or Profit under the United States: but the Party convicted shall nevertheless be liable and subject to Indictment, Trial, Judgment and Punishment, according to Law.

Section 4: Elections

The Times, Places and Manner of holding Elections for Senators and Representatives, shall be prescribed in each State by the Legislature thereof; but the Congress may at any time by Law make or alter such Regulations, except as to the Places of chusing Senators.

The Congress shall assemble at least once in every Year, and such Meeting shall be on the first Monday in December, unless they shall by Law appoint a different Day.

Section 5: Powers and Duties of Congress

Each House shall be the Judge of the Elections, Returns and Qualifications of its own Members, and a Majority of each shall constitute a Quorum to do Business; but a smaller Number may adjourn from day to day, and may be authorized to compel the Attendance of absent Members, in such Manner, and under such Penalties as each House may provide.

Each House may determine the Rules of its Proceedings, punish its Members for disorderly Behaviour and, with the Concurrence of two thirds, expel a Member.

Each House shall keep a Journal of its Proceedings, and from time to time publish the same, excepting such Parts as may in their Judgment require Secrecy; and the Yeas and Nays of the Members of either House on any question shall, at the Desire of one fifth of those Present, be entered on the Journal.

Neither House, during the Session of Congress, shall, without the Consent of the other, adjourn for more than three days, nor to any other Place than that in which the two Houses shall be sitting.

Section 6: Rights and Disabilities of Members

The Senators and Representatives shall receive a Compensation for their Services, to be ascertained by Law, and paid out of the Treasury of the United States. They shall in all Cases, except Treason, Felony and Breach of the Peace, be privileged from Arrest during their Attendance at the Session of their respective Houses, and in going to and returning from the same; and for any Speech or Debate in either House, they shall not be questioned in any other Place.

No Senator or Representative shall, during the Time for which he was elected, be appointed to any civil Office under the Authority of the United States, which shall have been created, or the Emoluments whereof shall have been encreased during such time; and no Person holding any Office under the United States, shall be a Member of either House during his Continuance in Office.

Section 7: Legislative Process

All Bills for raising Revenue shall originate in the House of Representatives; but the Senate may propose or concur with Amendments as on other Bills.

Every Bill which shall have passed the House of Representatives and the Senate, shall, before it become a Law, be presented to the President of the United States; If he approve he shall sign it, but if not he shall return it, with his Objections to that House in which it shall have originated, who shall enter the Objections at large on their Journal, and proceed to reconsider it. If after such Reconsideration two thirds of that House shall agree to pass the Bill, it shall be sent, together with the Objections, to the other House, by which it shall likewise be reconsidered, and if approved by two thirds of that House, it shall become a Law. But in all such Cases the Votes of both Houses shall be determined by yeas and Nays, and the Names of the Persons voting for and against the Bill shall be entered on the Journal of each House respectively. If any Bill shall not be returned by the President within ten Days (Sundays excepted) after it shall have been presented to him, the Same shall be a Law, in like Manner as if he had signed it, unless the Congress by their Adjournment prevent its Return, in which Case it shall not be a Law.

Every Order, Resolution, or Vote to which the Concurrence of the Senate and House of Representatives may be necessary (except on a question of Adjournment) shall be presented to the President of the United States; and before the Same shall take Effect, shall be approved by him, or being disapproved by him, shall be repassed by two thirds of the Senate and House of Representatives, according to the Rules and Limitations prescribed in the Case of a Bill.

Section 8: Powers of Congress

The Congress shall have Power To lay and collect Taxes, Duties, Imposts and Excises, to pay the Debts and provide for the common Defence and general Welfare of the United States; but all Duties, Imposts and Excises shall be uniform throughout the United States;

To borrow Money on the credit of the United States;

To regulate Commerce with foreign Nations, and among the several States, and with the Indian Tribes;

To establish a uniform Rule of Naturalization, and uniform Laws on the subject of Bankruptcies throughout the United States;

To coin Money, regulate the Value thereof, and of foreign Coin, and fix the Standard of Weights and Measures;

To provide for the Punishment of counterfeiting the Securities and current Coin of the United States;

To establish Post Offices and post Roads;

To promote the Progress of Science and useful Arts, by securing for limited Times to Authors and Inventors the exclusive Right to their respective Writings and Discoveries;

To constitute Tribunals inferior to the supreme Court;

To define and punish Piracies and Felonies committed on the high Seas, and Offences against the Law of Nations;

To declare War, grant Letters of Marque and Reprisal, and make Rules concerning Captures on Land and Water;

To raise and support Armies, but no Appropriation of Money to that Use shall be for a longer Term than two Years;

To provide and maintain a Navy;

To make Rules for the Government and Regulation of the land and naval Forces;

To provide for calling forth the Militia to execute the Laws of the Union, suppress Insurrections and repel Invasions;

To provide for organizing, arming, and disciplining, the Militia, and for governing such Part of them as may be employed in the Service of the United States, reserving to the States respectively, the Appointment of the Officers, and the Authority of training the Militia according to the discipline prescribed by Congress;

To exercise exclusive Legislation in all Cases whatsoever, over such District (not exceeding ten Miles square) as may, by Cession of particular States, and the Acceptance of Congress, become the Seat of Government of the United States, and to exercise like Authority over all Places purchased by the Consent of the Legislature of the State in which the Same shall be, for the Erection of Forts, Magazines, Arsenals, dock-Yards, and other needful Buildings;–And To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by this Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof.

Section 9: Powers Denied Congress

The Migration or Importation of such Persons as any of the States now existing shall think proper to admit, shall not be prohibited by the Congress prior to the Year one thousand eight hundred and eight, but a Tax or duty may be imposed on such Importation, not exceeding ten dollars for each Person.

The Privilege of the Writ of Habeas Corpus shall not be suspended unless when in Cases of Rebellion or Invasion the public Safety may require it.

No Bill of Attainder or ex post facto Law shall be passed.

No Capitation, or other direct, Tax shall be laid, unless in Proportion to the Census or enumeration herein before directed to be taken.

No Tax or Duty shall be laid on Articles exported from any State.

No Preference shall be given by any Regulation of Commerce or Revenue to the Ports of one State over those of another: nor shall Vessels bound to, or from, one State, be obliged to enter, clear, or pay Duties in another.

No Money shall be drawn from the Treasury, but in Consequence of Appropriations made by Law; and a regular Statement and Account of the Receipts and Expenditures of all public Money shall be published from time to time.

No Title of Nobility shall be granted by the United States: And no Person holding any Office of Profit or Trust under them, shall, without the Consent of the Congress, accept of any present, Emolument, Office, or Title, of any kind whatever, from any King, Prince, or foreign State.

Section 10: Powers Denied to the States

No State shall enter into any Treaty, Alliance, or Confederation; grant Letters of Marque and Reprisal; coin Money; emit Bills of Credit; make any Thing but gold and silver Coin a Tender in Payment of Debts; pass any Bill of Attainder, ex post facto Law, or Law impairing the Obligation of Contracts, or grant any Title of Nobility.

No State shall, without the Consent of the Congress, lay any Imposts or Duties on Imports or Exports, except what may be absolutely necessary for executing it's inspection Laws: and the net Produce of all Duties and Imposts, laid by any State on Imports or Exports, shall be for the Use of the Treasury of the United States; and all such Laws shall be subject to the Revision and Controul of the Congress.

No State shall, without the Consent of Congress, lay any Duty of

Tonnage, keep Troops, or Ships of War in time of Peace, enter into any Agreement or Compact with another State, or with a foreign Power, or engage in War, unless actually invaded, or in such imminent Danger as will not admit of delay.

Article II

Section 1

The executive Power shall be vested in a President of the United States of America. He shall hold his Office during the Term of four Years, and, together with the Vice President, chosen for the same Term, be elected, as follows:

Each State shall appoint, in such Manner as the Legislature thereof may direct, a Number of Electors, equal to the whole Number of Senators and Representatives to which the State may be entitled in the Congress: but no Senator or Representative, or Person holding an Office of Trust or Profit under the United States, shall be appointed an Elector.

The Electors shall meet in their respective States, and vote by Ballot for two Persons, of whom one at least shall not be an Inhabitant of the same State with themselves. And they shall make a List of all the Persons voted for, and of the Number of Votes for each; which List they shall sign and certify, and transmit sealed to the Seat of the Government of the United States, directed to the President of the Senate. The President of the Senate shall, in the Presence of the Senate and House of Representatives, open all the Certificates, and the Votes shall then be counted. The Person having the greatest Number of Votes shall be the President, if such Number be a Majority of the whole Number of Electors appointed; and if there be more than one who have such Majority, and have an equal Number of Votes, then the House of Representatives shall immediately chuse by Ballot one of them for President; and if no Person have a Majority, then from the five highest on the List the said House shall in like Manner chuse the President. But in chusing the President, the Votes shall be taken by States, the Representation from each State having one Vote; A quorum for this Purpose shall consist of a Member or Members from two thirds of the States, and a Majority of all the States shall be necessary to a Choice. In every Case, after the Choice of the President, the Person having the greatest Number of Votes of the Electors shall be the Vice President. But if there should remain two or more who have equal Votes, the Senate shall chuse from them by Ballot the Vice President.

The Congress may determine the Time of chusing the Electors, and the Day on which they shall give their Votes; which Day shall be the same throughout the United States.

No Person except a natural born Citizen, or a Citizen of the United States, at the time of the Adoption of this Constitution, shall be eligible to the Office of President; neither shall any Person be eligible to that Office who shall not have attained to the Age of thirty five Years, and been fourteen Years a Resident within the United States.

In Case of the Removal of the President from Office, or of his Death, Resignation, or Inability to discharge the Powers and Duties of the said Office, the Same shall devolve on the Vice President, and the Congress may by law provide for the Case of Removal, Death, Resignation or Inability, both of the President and Vice President, declaring what Officer shall then act as President, and such Officer shall act accordingly, until the Disability be removed, or a President shall be elected.

The President shall, at stated Times, receive for his Services, a Compensation, which shall neither be encreased nor diminished during the Period for which he shall have been elected, and he shall not receive within that Period any other Emolument from the United States, or any of them.

Before he enter on the Execution of his Office, he shall take the following Oath or Affirmation:– I do solemnly swear (or affirm that I will faithfully execute the Office of President of the United States, and will to the best of my Ability, preserve, protect and defend the Constitution of the United States.

Section 2

The President shall be Commander in Chief of the Army and Navy of the United States, and of the Militia of the several States, when called into the actual Service of the United States; he may require the Opinion, in writing, of the principal Officer in each of the executive Departments, upon any Subject relating to the Duties of their respective Offices, and he shall have Power to grant Reprieves and Pardons for Offences against the United States, except in Cases of Impeachment.

He shall have Power, by and with the Advice and Consent of the Senate, to make Treaties, provided two thirds of the Senators present concur; and he shall nominate, and by and with the Advice and Consent of the Senate, shall appoint Ambassadors, other public Ministers and Consuls, Judges of the supreme Court, and all other Officers of the United States, whose Appointments are not herein otherwise provided for, and which shall be established by Law: but the Congress may by Law vest the Appointment of such inferior Officers, as they think proper, in the President alone, in the Courts of Law, or in the Heads of Departments.

The President shall have Power to fill up all Vacancies that may happen during the Recess of the Senate, by granting Commissions which shall expire at the End of their next Session.

Section 3

He shall from time to time give to the Congress Information of the State of the Union, and recommend to their Consideration such Measures as he shall judge necessary and expedient; he may, on extraordinary Occasions, convene both Houses, or either of them, and in Case of Disagreement between them, with Respect to the Time of Adjournment, he may adjourn them to such Time as he shall think proper; he shall receive Ambassadors and other public Ministers; he shall take Care that the Laws be faithfully executed, and shall Commission all the Officers of the United States.

Section 4

The President, Vice President and all civil Officers of the United States, shall be removed from Office on Impeachment for, and Conviction of, Treason, Bribery, or other high Crimes and Misdemeanors.

Article III

Section 1

The judicial Power of the United States, shall be vested in one supreme Court, and in such inferior Courts as the Congress may from time to time ordain and establish. The Judges, both of the supreme and inferior Courts, shall hold their Offices during good Behaviour, and shall, at stated Times, receive for their Services, a Compensation, which shall not be diminished during their Continuance in Office.

Section 2

The judicial Power shall extend to all Cases, in Law and Equity, arising under this Constitution, the Laws of the United States, and Treaties made, or which shall be made, under their Authority;—to all Cases affecting Ambassadors, other public Ministers and Consuls;—to all Cases of admiralty and maritime Jurisdiction;—to Controversies to which the United States shall be a Party;—to

Controversies between two or more States;—between a State and Citizens of another State,—between Citizens of different States,—between Citizens of the same State claiming Lands

under Grants of different States, and between a State, or the Citizens thereof, and foreign States, Citizens or Subjects.

In all Cases affecting Ambassadors, other public Ministers and Consuls, and those in which a State shall be Party, the supreme Court shall have original Jurisdiction. In all the other Cases before mentioned, the supreme Court shall have appellate Jurisdiction, both as to Law and Fact, with such Exceptions, and under such Regulations as the Congress shall make.

The Trial of all Crimes, except in Cases of Impeachment, shall be by Jury; and such Trial shall be held in the State where the said Crimes shall have been committed; but when not committed within any State, the Trial shall be at such Place or Places as the Congress may by Law have directed.

Section 3

Treason against the United States, shall consist only in levying War against them, or in adhering to their Enemies, giving them Aid and Comfort. No Person shall be convicted of Treason unless on the Testimony of two Witnesses to the same overt Act, or on Confession in open Court.

The Congress shall have Power to declare the Punishment of Treason, but no Attainder of Treason shall work Corruption of Blood, or Forfeiture except during the Life of the Person attainted.

Article IV

Section 1

Full Faith and Credit shall be given in each State to the public Acts, Records, and judicial Proceedings of every other State. And the Congress may by general Laws prescribe the Manner in which such Acts, Records and Proceedings shall be proved, and the Effect thereof.

Section 2

The Citizens of each State shall be entitled to all Privileges and Immunities of Citizens in the several States.

A Person charged in any State with Treason, Felony, or other

Crime, who shall flee from Justice, and be found in another State, shall on Demand of the executive Authority of the State from which he fled, be delivered up, to be removed to the State having Jurisdiction of the Crime.

No Person held to Service or Labour in one State, under the Laws thereof, escaping into another, shall, in Consequence of any Law or Regulation therein, be discharged from such Service or Labour, but shall be delivered up on Claim of the Party to whom such Service or Labour may be due.

Section 3

New States may be admitted by the Congress into this Union; but no new State shall be formed or erected within the Jurisdiction of any other State; nor any State be formed by the Junction of two or more States, or Parts of States, without the Consent of the Legislatures of the States concerned as well as of the Congress.

The Congress shall have Power to dispose of and make all needful Rules and Regulations respecting the Territory or other Property belonging to the United States; and nothing in this Constitution shall be so construed as to Prejudice any Claims of the United States, or of any particular State.

Section 4

The United States shall guarantee to every State in this Union a Republican Form of Government, and shall protect each of them against Invasion; and on Application of the Legislature, or of the Executive (when the Legislature cannot be convened) against domestic Violence.

Article V

The Congress, whenever two thirds of both Houses shall deem it necessary, shall propose Amendments to this Constitution, or, on the Application of the Legislatures of two thirds of the several States, shall call a Convention for proposing Amendments, which, in either Case, shall be valid to all Intents and Purposes, as Part of this Constitution, when ratified by the Legislatures of three fourths of the several States, or by Conventions in three fourths thereof, as the one or the other Mode of Ratification may be proposed by the Congress; Provided that no Amendment which may be made prior to the Year One thousand eight hundred and eight shall in any Manner affect the first and fourth Clauses in the Ninth Section of the first Article; and that no State, without its Consent, shall be deprived of its equal Suffrage in the Senate.

Article VI

All Debts contracted and Engagements entered into, before the Adoption of this Constitution, shall be as valid against the United States under this Constitution, as under the Confederation.

This Constitution, and the Laws of the United States which shall be made in Pursuance thereof; and all Treaties made, or which shall be made, under the Authority of the United States, shall be the supreme Law of the Land; and the Judges in every State shall be bound thereby, any Thing in the Constitution or Laws of any State to the Contrary notwithstanding.

The Senators and Representatives before mentioned, and the Members of the several State Legislatures, and all executive and judicial Officers, both of the United States and of the several States, shall be bound by Oath or Affirmation, to support this Constitution; but no religious Test shall ever be required as a Qualification to any Office or public Trust under the United States.

Article VII

The Ratification of the Conventions of nine States, shall be sufficient for the Establishment of this Constitution between the States so ratifying the Same.

First Amendment
Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the freedom of speech, or of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the Government for a redress of grievances.

Second Amendment
A well regulated Militia, being necessary to the security of a free State, the right of the people to keep and bear Arms, shall not be infringed.

Third Amendment
No Soldier shall, in time of peace be quartered in any house, without the consent of the Owner, nor in time of war, but in a manner to be prescribed by law.

Fourth Amendment
The right of the people to be secure in their persons, houses, papers, and effects, against unreasonable searches and seizures, shall not be violated, and no Warrants shall issue, but upon probable cause, supported by Oath or affirmation, and particularly describing the place to be searched, and the persons or things to be seized.

Fifth Amendment
No person shall be held to answer for a capital, or otherwise infamous

crime, unless on a presentment or indictment of a Grand

Jury, except in cases arising in the land or naval forces, or in the Militia, when in actual service in time of War or public danger; nor shall any person be subject for the same offence to be twice put in jeopardy of life or limb; nor shall be compelled in any criminal case to be a witness against himself, nor be deprived of life, liberty, or property, without due process of law; nor shall private property be taken for public use, without just compensation.

Sixth Amendment

In all criminal prosecutions, the accused shall enjoy the right to a speedy and public trial, by an impartial jury of the State and district wherein the crime shall have been committed, which district shall have been previously ascertained by law, and to be informed of the nature and cause of the accusation; to be confronted with the witnesses against him; to have compulsory process for obtaining witnesses in his favor, and to have the Assistance of Counsel for his defence.

Seventh Amendment

In Suits at common law, where the value in controversy shall exceed twenty dollars, the right of trial by jury shall be preserved, and no fact tried by a jury, shall be otherwise re-examined in any Court of the United States, than according to the rules of the common law.

Eighth Amendment

Excessive bail shall not be required, nor excessive fines imposed, nor cruel and unusual punishments inflicted.

Ninth Amendment

The enumeration in the Constitution, of certain rights, shall not be construed to deny or disparage others retained by the people.

Tenth Amendment

The powers not delegated to the United States by the Constitution, nor prohibited by it to the States, are reserved to the States respectively, or to the people.

Eleventh Amendment

The Judicial power of the United States shall not be construed to extend to any suit in law or equity, commenced or prosecuted against one of the United States by Citizens of another State, or by Citizens or Subjects of any Foreign State.

Twelfth Amendment

The Electors shall meet in their respective states and vote by ballot for President and Vice-President, one of whom, at least, shall not be an inhabitant of the same state with themselves; they shall name in

their ballots the person voted for as President, and in distinct ballots the person voted for as Vice-President, and they shall make distinct lists of all persons voted for as President, and of all persons voted for as Vice-President, and of the number of votes for each, which lists they shall sign and certify, and transmit sealed to the seat of the government of the United States, directed to the President of the Senate;–the President of the Senate shall, in the presence of the Senate and House of Representatives, open all the certificates and the votes shall then be counted;–The person having the greatest number of votes for President, shall be the President, if such number be a majority of the whole number of Electors appointed; and if no person have such majority, then from the persons having the highest numbers not exceeding three on the list of those voted for as President, the House of Representatives shall choose immediately, by ballot, the President. But in choosing the President, the votes shall be taken by states, the representation from each state having one vote; a quorum for this purpose shall consist of a member or members from two-thirds of the states, and a majority of all the states shall be necessary to a choice. [And if the House of Representatives shall not choose a President whenever the right of choice shall devolve upon them, before the fourth day of March next following, then the Vice-President shall act as President, as in case of the death or other constitutional disability of the President.–] The person having the greatest number of votes as Vice-President, shall be the Vice-President, if such number be a majority of the whole number of Electors appointed, and if no person have a majority, then from the two highest numbers on the list, the Senate shall choose the Vice-President; a quorum for the purpose shall consist of two-thirds of the whole number of Senators, and a majority of the whole number shall be necessary to a choice. But no person constitutionally ineligible to the office of President shall be eligible to that of Vice-President of the United States.

Thirteenth Amendment

Section 1

Neither slavery nor involuntary servitude, except as a punishment for crime whereof the party shall have been duly convicted, shall exist within the United States, or any place subject to their jurisdiction.

Section 2

Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Fourteenth Amendment

Section 1

All persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of the United States and of the State wherein they reside. No State shall make or enforce any law which shall abridge the privileges or immunities of citizens of the United States; nor shall any State deprive any person of life, liberty, or property, without due process of law; nor deny to any person within its jurisdiction the equal protection of the laws.

Section 2

Representatives shall be apportioned among the several States according to their respective numbers, counting the whole number of persons in each State, excluding Indians not taxed. But when the right to vote at any election for the choice of electors for President and Vice-President of the United States, Representatives in Congress, the Executive and Judicial officers of a State, or the members of the Legislature thereof, is denied to any of the male inhabitants of such State, being twenty-one years of age, and citizens of the United States, or in any way abridged, except for participation in rebellion, or other crime, the basis of representation therein shall be reduced in the proportion which the number of such male citizens shall bear to the whole number of male citizens twenty-one years of age in such State.

Section 3

No person shall be a Senator or Representative in Congress, or elector of President and Vice-President, or hold any office, civil or military, under the United States, or under any State, who, having previously taken an oath, as a member of Congress, or as an officer of the United States, or as a member of any State legislature, or as an executive or judicial officer of any State, to support the Constitution of the United States, shall have engaged in insurrection or rebellion against the same, or given aid or comfort to the enemies thereof. But Congress may by a vote of two-thirds of each House, remove such disability.

Section 4

The validity of the public debt of the United States, authorized by law, including debts incurred for payment of pensions and bounties for services in suppressing insurrection or rebellion, shall not be questioned. But neither the United States nor any State shall assume or pay any debt or obligation incurred in aid of insurrection or rebellion against the United States, or any claim for the loss or emancipation of any slave; but all such debts, obligations and claims shall be held illegal and void.

Section 5

The Congress shall have the power to enforce, by appropriate legislation, the provisions of this article.

Fifteenth Amendment

Section 1

The right of citizens of the United States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of race, color, or previous condition of servitude–

Section 2

The Congress shall have the power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Sixteenth Amendment

The Congress shall have power to lay and collect taxes on incomes, from whatever source derived, without apportionment among the several States, and without regard to any census or enumeration.

Seventeenth Amendment

The Senate of the United States shall be composed of two Senators from each State, elected by the people thereof, for six years; and each Senator shall have one vote. The electors in each State shall have the qualifications requisite for electors of the most numerous branch of the State legislatures.

When vacancies happen in the representation of any State in the Senate, the executive authority of such State shall issue writs of election to fill such vacancies: Provided, That the legislature of any State may empower the executive thereof to make temporary appointments until the people fill the vacancies by election as the legislature may direct.

This amendment shall not be so construed as to affect the election or term of any Senator chosen before it becomes valid as part of the Constitution.

Eighteenth Amendment

Section 1

After one year from the ratification of this article the manufacture, sale, or transportation of intoxicating liquors within, the importation thereof into, or the exportation thereof from the United States and all territory subject to the jurisdiction thereof for beverage purposes is hereby prohibited.

Section 2

The Congress and the several States shall have concurrent power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Section 3

This article shall be inoperative unless it shall have been ratified as an amendment to the Constitution by the legislatures of the several States, as provided in the Constitution, within seven years from the date of the submission hereof to the States by the Congress.

Nineteenth Amendment

The right of citizens of the United States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of sex.

Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Twentieth Amendment

Section 1

The terms of the President and the Vice President shall end at noon on the 20th day of January, and the terms of Senators and Representatives at noon on the 3d day of January, of the years in which such terms would have ended if this article had not been ratified; and the terms of their successors shall then begin.

Section 2

The Congress shall assemble at least once in every year, and such meeting shall begin at noon on the 3d day of January, unless they shall by law appoint a different day.

Section 3

If, at the time fixed for the beginning of the term of the President, the President elect shall have died, the Vice President elect shall become President. If a President shall not have been chosen before the time fixed for the beginning of his term, or if the President elect shall have failed to qualify, then the Vice President elect shall act as President until a President shall have qualified; and the Congress may by law provide for the case wherein neither a President elect nor a Vice President elect shall have qualified, declaring who shall then act as President, or the manner in which one who is to act shall be selected, and such person shall act accordingly until a President or Vice President shall have qualified.

Section 4

The Congress may by law provide for the case of the death of any of the persons from whom the House of Representatives may choose a President whenever the right of choice shall have devolved upon them, and for the case of the death of any of the persons from whom the Senate may choose a Vice President whenever the right of choice shall have devolved upon them.

Section 5

Sections 1 and 2 shall take effect on the 15th day of October following the ratification of this article.

Section 6

This article shall be inoperative unless it shall have been ratified as an amendment to the Constitution by the legislatures of three-fourths of the several States within seven years from the date of its submission.

Twenty-First Amendment

Section 1

The eighteenth article of amendment to the Constitution of the United States is hereby repealed.

Section 2

The transportation or importation into any State, Territory, or possession of the United States for delivery or use therein of intoxicating liquors, in violation of the laws thereof, is hereby prohibited.

Section 3

This article shall be inoperative unless it shall have been ratified as an amendment to the Constitution by conventions in the several States, as provided in the Constitution, within seven years from the date of the submission hereof to the States by the Congress.

Twenty-Second Amendment

Section 1

No person shall be elected to the office of the President more than twice, and no person who has held the office of President, or acted as President, for more than two years of a term to which some other person was elected President shall be elected to the office of the President more than once. But this Article shall not apply to any person holding the office of President when this Article was proposed by the Congress, and shall not prevent any person who may be holding the office of President, or acting as President, during the term within which this Article becomes operative from holding the office of President or acting as President during the remainder of such term.

Section 2

This article shall be inoperative unless it shall have been ratified as an amendment to the Constitution by the legislatures of three-fourths of the several States within seven years from the date of its submission to the States

by the Congress.

Twenty-Third Amendment

Section 1

The District constituting the seat of Government of the United States shall appoint in such manner as the Congress may direct:

A number of electors of President and Vice President equal to the whole number of Senators and Representatives in Congress to which the District would be entitled if it were a State, but in no event more than the least populous State; they shall be in addition to those appointed by the States, but they shall be considered, for the purposes of the election of President and Vice President, to be electors appointed by a State; and they shall meet in the District and perform such duties as provided by the twelfth article of amendment.

Section 2

The Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Twenty-Fourth Amendment

Section 1

The right of citizens of the United States to vote in any primary or other election for President or Vice President, for electors for President or Vice President, or for Senator or Representative in Congress, shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or any State by reason of failure to pay any poll tax or other tax.

Section 2

The Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Twenty-Fifth Amendment

Section 1

In case of the removal of the President from office or of his death or resignation, the Vice President shall become President.

Section 2

Whenever there is a vacancy in the office of the Vice President, the President shall nominate a Vice President who shall take office upon confirmation by a majority vote of both Houses of Congress.

Section 3

Whenever the President transmits to the President pro tempore of the Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives his written

declaration that he is unable to discharge the powers and duties of his office, and until he transmits to them a written declaration to the contrary, such powers and duties shall be discharged by the Vice President as Acting President.

Section 4

Whenever the Vice President and a majority of either the principal officers of the executive departments or of such other body as Congress may by law provide, transmit to the President pro tempore of the Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives their written declaration that the President is unable to discharge the powers and duties of his office, the Vice President shall immediately assume the powers and duties of the office as Acting President.

Thereafter, when the President transmits to the President pro tempore of the Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives his written declaration that no inability exists, he shall resume the powers and duties of his office unless the Vice President and a majority of either the principal officers of the executive department or of such other body as Congress may by law provide, transmit within four days to the President pro tempore of the Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives their written declaration that the President is unable to discharge the powers and duties of his office. Thereupon Congress shall decide the issue, assembling within forty-eight hours for that purpose if not in session.

If the Congress, within twenty-one days after receipt of the latter written declaration, or, if Congress is not in session, within twenty-one days after Congress is required to assemble, determines by two-thirds vote of both Houses that the President is unable to discharge the powers and duties of his office, the Vice President shall continue to discharge the same as Acting President; otherwise, the President shall resume the powers and duties of his office.

Twenty-Sixth Amendment

Section 1

The right of citizens of the United States, who are eighteen years of age or older, to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of age.

Section 2

The Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

Twenty-Seventh Amendment

No law, varying the compensation for the services of the Senators and Representatives, shall take effect, until an election of Representatives shall have intervened.


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